

TECHNICAL MANUAL

MX60 Mobile Mapping

Why the system behaves the way it does, and how we know. The evidence base for the SOP and the two How To guides.

TRIMBLE MX60 · TRIMBLE BUSINESS CENTER 2026.10

This manual explains; it does not require. It sets out what the MX60 and Trimble Business Center actually do, and how that is known. What Parametrix requires is in the SOP. Every section ends with an **In Plain Language** recap written for a surveyor who is new to mobile mapping.

CAUTION Data loss, an irreversible operation, a lost result, or safety	IMPORTANT Gets the job wrong if ignored	WHY THIS MATTERS The reason behind a behaviour or a requirement
IN PLAIN LANGUAGE What the section means, why it matters, what to remember	TRIMBLE METHOD Trimble documents this — NOT NECESSARILY A REQUIREMENT	OBSERVED IN THE SOFTWARE Seen in the software; not stated by Trimble
SET BY THE PROJECT No single company-wide answer. The project decides, and records it	NO PUBLISHED FIGURE No published number exists. Judgement, and the evidence on the job	

1 Purpose and Scope

1.1 What this manual does

It explains **what the Trimble MX60 and Trimble Business Center are actually doing, and how we know.** It is the technical reference from which the SOP and the two How To guides are derived.

Three specific jobs:

1. **Preserve the technical knowledge.** Mobile mapping at Parametrix is new. What is understood about it today lives in this manual, not in the heads of the people who worked it out.
2. **Preserve the evidence.** Every statement about the software is traceable to a Trimble topic or manual page. When Trimble changes something, the change can be found and its consequences traced.
3. **Make the other three documents derivable.** A requirement in the SOP, or a step in a How To guide, should be traceable to an explanation here.

1.2 What it assumes

The reader is a **competent survey professional**. Control networks, datums, geoids, residuals, least squares adjustment and check points are taken as known and are not taught here.

No prior mobile mapping experience is assumed. Trajectories, SBETs, GNSS/INS integration, boresight calibration, scan generation, registration and mobile LiDAR QC are explained from the beginning.

Where conventional survey practice and mobile mapping differ, the difference is explained **at the point where it matters**. Nearly all of those differences reduce to one thing, and §2 is about it: the instrument never stops, so everything it measures is referenced to a computed path rather than to an occupied point.

1.3 Scope

In scope — the MX60 system and its sensors; TMI and TBC as they apply to mobile mapping; POSpac where the workflow depends on it; the technical basis of every stage from project setup to archive; the evidence base and its limits.

Out of scope — basic land surveying; establishing the control network, which is conventional survey work; feature extraction and CAD production downstream of the point cloud; static terrestrial scanning, UAS and aerial workflows except where TBC behaviour is shared; vehicle operation, traffic control and site safety.

1.4 What this manual is not

IMPORTANT

It is not a procedure, and nothing in it is a Parametrix requirement.

Where this manual describes what Trimble's software does, that is a statement of fact about the software — not an instruction to do it. Where it describes a technique, that is an explanation of how the technique works — not a decision that Parametrix uses it.

Requirements live in the SOP. Steps live in the How To guides.

Where a Parametrix decision would resolve an open question, this manual **names the decision** — **D-n** — and moves on. It does not propose an answer.

1.5 The four documents

QUESTION	DOCUMENT
Why does it work this way?	This manual
Must I?	MX60 Mobile Mapping SOP
How do I do it in the field?	MX60 Field How To
How do I do it in the office?	MX60 Office How To

Cross-references use four fixed forms:

For technical background, see **Technical Manual §X.X**. For the required company procedure, see **SOP §X.X**. For step-by-step field instructions, see **Field How To §X.X**. For processing instructions, see **Office How To §X.X**.

1.6 How to read this manual

IF YOU ARE...	START AT
New to mobile mapping	§2, then §3, then the In Plain Language boxes end to end
Looking up one behaviour	The contents, or Appendix A — the Trimble source index
Checking a number	Appendix B — the reference dataset is the authority for numbers

IF YOU ARE...	START AT
Deriving a requirement	The relevant Part IV section, then the SOP clause it supports
Reviewing after a TBC update	Appendix A — the source index, topic by topic

The In Plain Language boxes are a complete document in themselves. Read end to end, with nothing else, they describe the whole workflow in ordinary language. That is deliberate — a reviewer or project manager can get a true picture without working through the technical detail.

1.7 Evidence base and its limits

Trimble help topics captured and classified	38
MX60, TMI and accessory manuals and bulletins	7
Release notes	2025.21, 2026.10
Software documented	TBC 2026.10 · TMI Rev L

Three limits, stated plainly

Trimble's help describes dialogs, options and outputs. It does not exhaustively enumerate file formats — LAS header fields and VLR content in particular. Where this manual says a behaviour is not documented, that is a statement about Trimble's documentation, not a claim that the software lacks the capability (§30).

Twenty-four questions require testing rather than reading. They are not gaps in the research; they are questions no documentation would answer.

Sixteen questions require Trimble, and remain open with them.

Source ingestion is complete for the purposes of this manual. Every export and publish path available to an MX60 has been read, and the remaining uncertainty is about software behaviour that Trimble does not document.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

What we just did. We set out what this manual is for — explaining how the system works and recording how we know — and, just as importantly, what it is not: it decides nothing and requires nothing.

Why it matters. Mobile mapping produces enormous, convincing datasets very quickly. A point cloud with a hundred million points looks authoritative whether or not the path underneath it was ever checked. The only thing between "looks right" and "is right" is understanding what the software actually did — which is what this manual is for — and a procedure that says what must be verified, which is the SOP's job.

What can go wrong. Reading a description here as an instruction. This manual explains that TBC can register a run from a single control point. That is true, and it is not a recommendation — it is a fact about the software with a warning attached. If you find yourself citing this manual as authority for doing something, you want the SOP.

What good looks like. You can point at any technical statement in this manual and answer in one sentence: *who says so, and where?* Every one of them carries a citation. If one does not, that is a defect worth reporting.

2 Mobile Mapping in Plain Terms

This section is for the reader who knows surveying and has never operated a mobile mapping system. Everything else in this manual depends on the ideas here.

2.1 The one difference that explains all the others

A total station or a static scanner measures from a **known, stationary point**. You occupy, you orient, you shoot. The instrument's position is fixed and separately determined, so the quality of any measurement is a question about that measurement.

The MX60 never stops. It measures continuously from a vehicle moving at highway speed, and it has no occupied point at all. Instead it computes, for every instant, **where the sensor head was and which way it was pointing** — a continuous record called the **trajectory**.

Every point in a mobile mapping cloud is the sum of two things: a range and angle measured by the scanner, and the position and attitude of the scanner at the instant of that measurement. The scanner part is excellent and nearly constant. **The trajectory part is where the error lives.**

This single fact drives the rest of the document:

- Why initialization matters, and why it is not a formality (§13)
- Why GNSS conditions dominate the accuracy conversation (§15, §27)
- Why everything downstream of the trajectory has to be recomputed when it changes (§18, §21)
- Why the office work is largely about improving the trajectory, not the points (§17, §21)
- Why proving *which trajectory* produced a deliverable turns out to be hard (§30)

2.2 What the trajectory is, and how it is computed

The trajectory is a time series: position (X, Y, Z) and attitude (roll, pitch, heading) at a high rate, for the whole mission. It is produced by combining two sensor types that fail in opposite ways.

	GNSS	INERTIAL (IMU)
Measures	Absolute position	Change in orientation and velocity

	GNSS	INERTIAL (IMU)
Error behaviour	Bounded but noisy — it does not drift, but it jumps and can be lost entirely	Smooth and precise instant to instant, but drifts without limit over time
Fails when	Sky is obstructed — trees, buildings, bridges, tunnels	Always, gradually, by its nature

Neither alone is adequate. Combined, each covers the other's weakness: GNSS anchors the inertial solution and stops the drift; the IMU carries the solution smoothly through the gaps when GNSS is degraded or absent.

The combination is done by a filter, and for surveying work it is done **twice** — once forward through time and once backward — then merged. The merged result is called a **Smoothed Best Estimate of Trajectory**, universally abbreviated **SBET**.

The backward pass is why the end of a mission matters as much as the beginning. A gap in the middle of the drive is bracketed by good data on both sides, and the smoother can bridge it from both directions. A gap at the *end* has good data on one side only. This is the practical reason the field procedure requires a proper closing sequence (§14), and it is the single most commonly skipped step in mobile mapping.

Two supporting sensors appear throughout this document:

- **GAMS** — a second GNSS antenna. Two antennas a known distance apart give a direct heading measurement, which is otherwise the hardest attitude component to determine. It speeds up initialization considerably (*TBC 25943*)
- **DMI** — a distance measuring indicator on a wheel. It provides an independent along-track distance, which constrains the inertial solution when GNSS is poor (*TBC 25943*)

2.3 What the office actually does

A surveyor coming from static scanning expects office work to mean registration of scans to each other and to control. Mobile mapping is different in an instructive way.

STAGE	WHAT IS BEING IMPROVED
Trajectory processing (§17)	The trajectory itself, from raw observations and base station data
Scan generation (§18)	Nothing — this applies the trajectory to produce the cloud
Calibration (§20)	The fixed angular offsets between sensors. Periodic, not per-job

STAGE	WHAT IS BEING IMPROVED
Registration (§21)	The trajectory again, now using surveyed control or overlapping cloud
Update Scans (§19)	Nothing — this reapplies the improved trajectory to produce a new cloud

Three of the five stages improve the trajectory. Two of them just recompute points.

This is the shape of mobile mapping office work, and it is why the phrase "registering the point cloud" is misleading. You are not moving points. You are improving the path the sensor took, and then recomputing where the points must therefore have been.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

What we just did. We established the one idea the rest of this manual rests on: a mobile mapping system has no occupied point. It computes where it was, continuously, and every point it collects is hung off that computed path. The path is called the trajectory, and it is the job.

Why it matters. Think of it as a very long, very fast resection that never stops — except that instead of resecting from known points, the system is dead-reckoning with an inertial sensor and correcting itself with satellites whenever the sky allows. When the sky does not allow, it keeps going on inertial alone and quietly gets worse. Almost everything the office does later is an attempt to improve that path, not to move the points around.

What can go wrong. The thing that catches people is that the office work does not look like registration in the static scanning sense. Three of the five office stages improve the trajectory; two of them just recompute points from it. A processor who thinks they are moving a point cloud will eventually be surprised by something — most often by discovering that a registration they performed never reached the data (§19).

What good looks like. You can say, for any point in a delivered cloud, which trajectory put it there and what the quality of that trajectory was at that instant. §30 is about how far that is currently possible.

3 How Error Behaves

This is where a surveyor's intuition needs adjusting, and it is worth being precise. The three properties below explain most of what is unusual about mobile mapping QC.

3.0 Error is not uniform across the dataset

This is where a surveyor's intuition needs adjusting, and it is worth being precise.

Error is not uniform across the dataset. It varies along the corridor with GNSS quality, and it varies within a single scan line with range.

3.1 Attitude error multiplies with range

An error in the *position* of the sensor head displaces every point by the same amount. An error in the *attitude* — which way it was pointing — displaces points by an amount proportional to how far away they are.

The relationship is simple geometry: lateral displacement is range multiplied by the angular error in radians. A given attitude error therefore costs five times as much at 50 m as at 10 m.

This is arithmetic, not a specification. **No Trimble source in the set publishes an attitude error budget for the MX60**, so the useful range for a given tolerance has to be established from the manufacturer's accuracy statement for the configuration Parametrix owns (§7.3), or by test.

WHY THIS MATTERS

This is why *useful range* is a shorter distance than *maximum range*. The scanner can return a point at its maximum range; whether that point is good enough to measure from is a different question, and the answer depends on the attitude accuracy of the trajectory at that instant. Two clouds collected on the same day with the same instrument can have quite different useful ranges if one was collected under open sky and the other in an urban canyon.

3.2 Error is correlated in time, not scattered

Conventional survey errors tend to be independent — one shot's error tells you little about the next. Mobile mapping error is **strongly correlated over seconds and minutes**, because it is dominated by the state of a filter that evolves smoothly.

The practical consequence: a bad stretch of trajectory produces a whole *region* of cloud that is consistently displaced, not a scatter of bad points. It will look internally consistent and perfectly clean. **It will simply be in the wrong place**, and only comparison against independent control will reveal it.

That is the most important thing in this section. **Mobile mapping data does not look wrong when it is wrong.**

3.3 Why this changes the QC method

The three properties above have direct consequences, and each has its own section later:

PROPERTY	CONSEQUENCE	§
Error is not uniform	A mission is not "good" or "bad" — it has stretches. QC produces a list, not a verdict	24
Attitude error scales with range	Useful range is shorter than maximum range , and varies with the trajectory quality at that instant	16
Error is correlated in time	Spot-checking does not work. A bad stretch shorter than the sampling interval passes every sample	25

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

What we just did. We looked at how mobile mapping gets things wrong, which is not how a total station gets things wrong.

Why it matters. Conventional survey errors tend to be independent — one shot's error tells you little about the next, so a scatter of bad values stands out. Mobile mapping error is dominated by a filter that evolves smoothly over seconds and minutes, so it arrives in **runs of consistently displaced data** rather than in scattered bad points.

What can go wrong. The consequence people find hardest to accept: **bad mobile mapping data does not look bad.** If the trajectory drifted through a tree-lined stretch, the cloud from that stretch is still crisp, still dense, still internally consistent — and sitting several centimetres from where it should be. There is no noise, no scatter, no visual tell. You find it by checking against control you surveyed independently, or you do not find it at all.

What good looks like. A dataset where you know *where* the weak stretches are, because you looked at the trajectory quality before you ever generated a point cloud (§24), and where independent check points in those specific stretches came back in the same range as the ones in the open.

4 The Workflow, End to End

Every stage, in order, with what it produces and where it is. **Read this once and the rest of the document has a shape.**

	STAGE	WHAT IT PRODUCES	§
Plan	Project setup and control	A CRS, a control network that brackets the job, designated check points	5
	Mission planning	A route, a pass pattern, mapped GNSS-hostile stretches and a mitigation for each	6
Field	Preparation and preflight	A mounted, calibrated, measured system	7
	Acquisition	A mission: raw scanner, imagery and navigation data	8
	Field QC	Confirmation the data exists and is complete — not that it is good	9
	Transfer	A verified copy, in two places	10
	Import	An index in TBC. Still no point cloud	11
Office	Trajectory processing	The SBET — the computed path. <i>The accuracy ceiling is set here</i>	12
	Generate Scans	The point cloud, by applying the trajectory to the raw scanner data	13
	<i>(Calibration)</i>	Sensor boresight angles. Periodic — most projects skip this	14
	Registration	A better trajectory , fitted to surveyed control. <i>The cloud has not moved</i>	15, 16
	Update Scans	A new point cloud , on the registered trajectory. Without this the registration reaches nothing	13.6
	QC	Residuals, independent checks, and a visual inspection	17, 18, 19
	<i>(Degraded GNSS)</i>	A branch, if QC fails — and two of its three remedies had to be arranged in the field	20
	<i>(Cleanup)</i>	A light project with one answer. Destructive and not undoable	21
Deliver	Export	The deliverable — which may not identify the trajectory that produced it	22, 23

STAGE	WHAT IT PRODUCES	§
Final QA/QC	Ten layers of verification, before it leaves	24
Archive	The records that let the work be defended later	25

Three things to carry out of that table:

1. **The trajectory is computed once and improved twice** — at §17, then at §21. Everything else either applies it or checks it.
2. **Registration and Update Scans are two steps.** Doing the first without the second leaves the deliverable unadjusted, and it looks identical.
3. **Bracketed stages are conditional.** Calibration is periodic. The degraded-GNSS branch and Cleanup happen only when the job calls for them.

4.1 Frozen stage names

The stage names in the table above are **frozen**. They are used identically in this manual, the SOP, both How To guides, every checklist and form, and future training material.

- Project setup · Mission planning · Field preparation · Acquisition · Field QC · Transfer
- Intake · Trajectory processing · Scan generation · Calibration · Registration · Update Scans
- QC · Degraded-GNSS handling · Cleanup · Export · Final QA/QC · Archive
- **Provenance** — cross-cutting rather than a stage

A stage is not a command. *Registration* is the stage; **Register a Run**, **Register a Mission** and **Register Run to Run** are three commands that perform it (§21). **Update Scans** is unusual in being both a stage name and a command name, and that is Trimble's doing.

The authoritative list, with the synonyms that are not to be used, is the glossary at §6.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

What we just did. We laid out every stage from planning to archive on one page, with what each produces.

Why it matters. Read once, it gives the rest of the manual a shape. The three things worth carrying away are in the table's closing notes: the trajectory is computed once and improved twice; registration and Update Scans are two separate steps; and several stages are conditional rather than routine.

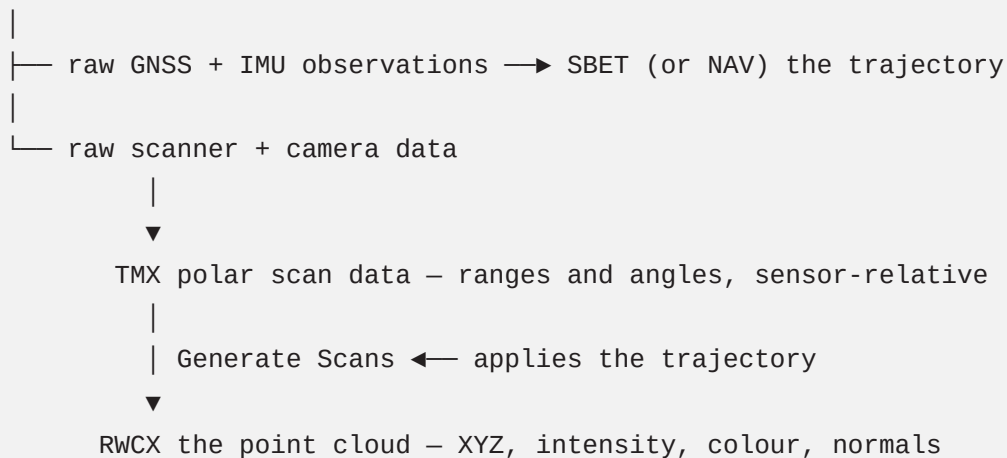
What can go wrong. Treating the conditional stages as routine, or the routine ones as optional. Calibration is periodic — most projects skip it. Cleanup is destructive — some projects should skip it. Update Scans is neither, and skipping it silently undoes a registration.

What good looks like. Anyone on the team using the same word for the same stage. That sounds trivial until two people are discussing "registration" and one means the adjustment while the other means the whole office process.

5 The Data Chain

The names in this section matter because TBC's commands are named after them. A processor who does not know which object a command acts on will eventually act on the wrong one — and several of the commands are not undoable.

5.1 The chain, once



Two things are worth stating now and are returned to in §18.

The MX60 converts TMX to RWCX in one step. Older MX9 and MX90 systems go through an intermediate stage requiring a range-ambiguity correction called MTA.

The MX60 workflow has no MTA stage, which removes a whole category of setup and a whole category of failure (*TBC 22503*).

The trajectory is applied at scan generation, not at collection. The raw scan data is sensor-relative. It becomes a georeferenced point cloud only when combined with a trajectory — which is why improving the trajectory later means regenerating the cloud (§19, §21).

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 22503)

MX50 and MX60 convert **TMX** → **RWCX in one step**. MX9 and MX90 go RXP → TMX → RWCX in two, and the intermediate stage requires **MTA** (Multiple Times Around) range-ambiguity correction.

The MX60 has no MTA configuration and no MTA failures. If you encounter TBC documentation about configuring a GPU driver for MTA correction (*TBC 23856*), it does not apply to this system. It is mentioned here only because it is prominent in the TBC help and causes confusion.

5.2 The mission on disk

What the system writes in the field:

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 20736-1, 22503, 22554, 25943)

```
TMX<serial>-<mission id>/
├─ Backup/
├─ Base/ base station RINEX, if collected.YYo.YYn.YYg
├─ Camera_1 ... Camera_4/ imagery
├─ Laser_1, Laser_2/ raw scanner data
├─ NavProc_01/ navigation processing outputs
├─ POS_1/
│ └─ raw/ raw IMU + GNSS – posl_*.000,.001,.002 ...
│ └─ realtime/
├─ Extcal.json the calibration file
├─ readme_*.txt
├─ <mission>.mxdb the mission database – this is what you import
├─ <mission>.tridb
└─ <mission>_*.log
```

Three observations about this structure that matter operationally:

The `.mxdb` is an index, not the data. It is small. Copying it alone copies nothing useful. Everything the chain depends on sits in the sibling folders, which is why the transfer requirement is the whole mission folder and not a file.

CAUTION

Do not clear a data disk until a verified copy exists in at least two locations and the `.mxdb` has been confirmed to open.

A cleared disk is not recoverable, and a mobile mapping mission is not re-drivable at reasonable cost.

`Extcal.json` travels with the mission. The calibration state that produced the data is recorded alongside the data rather than held only in the software. This is the single most useful provenance artifact in the chain and is discussed in §30.

`POS_1/raw/` is the irreducible original. Every trajectory the office ever computes — the first SBET, a LiDAR QC refinement, a PFI second pass, a registered variant — derives from those files. They are the only thing in the mission that cannot be recomputed.

5.3 The mission in Project Explorer

What the same mission looks like after import into TBC:

```

Mobile Mapping
├── <mission id>
│   ├── Capture Devices Camera 3 Back Down, Camera 4 360°, Laser Left, Laser Right
│   └── Run 0, Run 1, Run 2 ...
│       ├── Sbet the imported trajectory
│       └── (scans appear here after Generate Scans)

```

Note the shape. Scans are children of a trajectory, not of a run.

That is the structural fact that makes tree position meaningful evidence of which trajectory a cloud was built on (§30) — and it is why a run with two trajectories has two independent sets of scans beneath it.

A run that has been registered therefore does not *replace* its scans. It gains a second trajectory node, and after **Update Scans** (§19) a second set of scans hanging off it. Both sets remain in the project, look identical in plan, and are distinguishable only by their position in the tree and by the `_reg_####` suffix on the newer stations. Everything difficult about MX60 provenance follows from that one sentence.

5.4 What each object can and cannot be regenerated from

OBJECT	REGENERATED FROM	LOST IF DELETED
SBET	<code>POS_1/raw/</code> + base data, through POSPac	Recoverable — but the processing settings that produced <i>this</i> SBET are not recorded in the file
Registered SBET	The parent SBET + the registration + surveyed control	Recoverable only if the picked targets survive (<code>Targets.csv</code> , §21)
TMX	<code>Laser_1</code> , <code>Laser_2</code> raw	Recoverable
RWCX	TMX + a trajectory	Recoverable — against whichever trajectory is selected at the time , which is not necessarily the one that produced the original
Picked targets	Nothing. A human picked them	Not recoverable. Re-picking produces different points
<code>POS_1/raw/</code>	Nothing	Not recoverable. Re-collect the mission

CAUTION

Read the middle rows carefully. Most of the chain is reproducible, which makes it tempting to treat any individual file as disposable. The two rows that are not reproducible — raw observations and human target picks — are also the two most likely to be discarded, because one is large and the other is small enough to overlook.

5.5 Where each stage's quality is decided

The chain is worth reading a second time as a sequence of irreversible commitments:

STAGE	WHAT IS FIXED HERE	WHAT CAN STILL BE FIXED LATER
Field collection	Geometry, coverage, GNSS conditions, initialization quality	Nothing. This is the only stage with no office remedy
Trajectory processing	Which corrections and which base data were used	Reprocess — cheap, as long as the raw data is intact
Scan generation	Filters applied, colorization	Regenerate — cheap in effort, expensive in time
Registration	The fit to surveyed control	Register again, or re-pick. But adjustments stack (§21)
Export	What the client receives	Re-export, if the project still exists in the state that produced it (§29, §30)

WHY THIS MATTERS

Every stage after the first is recoverable, and the first is not. That asymmetry is the reason this manual spends more of its length on field method than the office's share of the schedule would suggest. An office error costs hours. A field error costs a mobilisation.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

What we just did. We named the four things the data passes through — the mission database, the trajectory, the polar scan data, and the point cloud — and said which command turns each one into the next.

Why it matters. Nearly every confusing thing in the office workflow makes sense once you know that the point cloud is *computed*, not *collected*. The scanner measured ranges and angles from a sensor that was moving. The trajectory says where that sensor was. Multiply the two together and you get coordinates. That is what **Generate Scans** does, and it is why changing the trajectory later means doing it again.

What can go wrong. Two things, both common. The first is copying the `.mxd` and thinking you have the mission — you have the table of contents. The second is looking at a run in Project Explorer, seeing two sets of scans, and assuming one is a duplicate to be tidied away. They are the same raw data computed against two different trajectories, and which one you keep is a decision about the accuracy of the deliverable, not about disk space.

What good looks like. You can point at any point cloud in the project and say which trajectory produced it, without guessing. If you cannot, §30 explains how to work it out and how far that evidence actually goes.

6 Terminology

This section is the authoritative glossary for all four Parametrix MX60 deliverables. The SOP, the Field How To and the Office How To carry at most a short list of essential abbreviations and point here. Where a term appears to be defined twice, this section governs.

Terms are grouped by where you meet them rather than alphabetically, because most of the confusion in this subject is between two terms that sit next to each other in the workflow — boresight and lever arm, Register a Run and Register a Mission, Global and Local.

6.1 Five words that do not mean what they usually mean

Ordinary survey usage and TBC usage diverge on a small number of words. Every one of them has caused a real mistake, and they are collected here so that the divergence is seen once rather than discovered five sections apart.

WORD	ORDINARY SURVEY USAGE	WHAT IT MEANS HERE
Target	A physical panel or prism you place and observe	A point picked in the point cloud by the operator, which is then paired with a surveyed GCP TBC 22905; §21
Registration	Bringing scans into a common frame by moving them	Adjusting a trajectory. It does not move points, and does not touch the cloud at all until Update Scans runs (§19)
Calibration	A broad word covering any instrument check	In TBC, specifically boresight estimation — the angular offset between sensor and inertial frame. Lever arms are <i>not</i> estimated (§20)
Local	Nearby, or a local coordinate system	An adjustment method that interpolates between control points and does not extrapolate beyond the outermost one TBC 22905; §21
Station	An occupied instrument setup	One instant of imagery capture along a run. A mobile mapping system occupies nothing

"Target" is the trap that catches people first. A checkerboard panel is one kind of feature you might pick, but so is the corner of a painted road marking, or a manhole rim. The physical thing in the field is the **GCP**. The thing in TBC's Targets pane is a *pick*.

6.2 The trajectory and navigation

TERM	MEANING
Trajectory	The computed position and attitude of the sensor head over time. Everything the system collects is referenced to it (§2.1)
SBET	Smoothed Best Estimate of Trajectory — the post-processed trajectory, computed forward and backward through time and merged. The normal input for survey work
NAV	The real-time trajectory computed in the vehicle. A fallback, not an option (§17.1)
POSPac MMS	Applanix software that computes the SBET. A licence is required for both the external route and TBC's in-application command (§10.3)
IN-Fusion+ Single Base	POSPac computation mode using corrections from a local base station
IN-Fusion+ PP-RTX	POSPac computation mode using Trimble RTX corrections, with no local base
GNSS/INS integration	Combining satellite positioning with inertial sensing so each covers the other's failure mode (§8)
IMU	Inertial Measurement Unit. Precise instant to instant, drifts without limit over time
GAMS	GNSS Azimuth Measurement System — a second antenna giving a direct heading measurement. Speeds initialization (<i>TBC 25943</i>)
DMI	Distance Measuring Indicator — a wheel sensor giving independent along-track distance. Scale factor sign depends on the mounting side (<i>TBC 25943</i>)
Initialization	The static period, straight run and dynamic manoeuvres that let the filter resolve attitude and sensor bias (§13)
<code>smrmsg_XXX.out</code>	POSPac file describing position, orientation and velocity RMS after smoothing. The source of the trajectory's RMS colouring (<i>TBC 27248</i>)
ITRF00 path	Where POSPac does not recognise the project datum and epoch, the SBET is computed in ITRF00 and then transformed — indicated by the filename <code>sbet_[mission]_[frame].out</code> <i>TBC 25943; §12.3</i>

6.3 Missions, runs and data objects

TERM	MEANING
Mission	One deployment. The <code>.mxd</code> and everything beneath it

TERM	MEANING
Run	One continuous stretch of collection within a mission. A mission has many
Station	One instant of imagery capture along a run
<code>.mxd</code>	The mission database written in the field. The file you import
TMX	Polar scan data — ranges and angles, sensor-relative. Not georeferenced
RWCX	The point cloud — XYZ, intensity, colour, normals. Produced by applying the trajectory to TMX
MTA	Multiple Times Around — range-ambiguity correction. Not part of the MX60 workflow TBC 22503; §18.1
<code>Extcal.json</code>	The calibration file written with the raw mission data
Capture Devices	The TBC node listing the sensors: for the MX60, Camera 3 Back Down, Camera 4 360° , and the two lasers

6.4 Processing commands

TERM	MEANING
Process Raw Trajectory Data	Computes an SBET inside TBC. Requires POSPac 8.6+ and a licence (TBC 25943)
Generate Scans	Applies the trajectory to raw scanner data, producing the point cloud (§18)
Update Scans	Recomputes scans against a different trajectory. How a registration reaches the point cloud. No Filters pane TBC 22638; §19
Recover Mobile Mapping Scans	Recovery for failed or interrupted scan generation (TBC 28155)
LiDAR QC	Uses scan data as an aiding sensor, SLAM-like, to refine the trajectory. Runs inside trajectory processing TBC 28972; §11
PFXGenerate POSPac Position Fixes	Projects GCP-to-target offsets back into the navigation solution for a second POSPac pass TBC 24460; §27.5
Cleanup Mobile Mapping Mission	Keeps the most recent registration and removes the rest. Destructive and not undoable TBC 26466; §28

6.5 Calibration

TERM	MEANING
Boresight	The fixed angular offset between a sensor and the inertial reference frame. This is what a calibration estimates
Lever arm	The fixed distance offset between two sensors. Known from manufacture and measurement — not estimated TBC 24886; §20.2
Installation Matrix	Parameters before calibration — the as-built values (TBC 22920)
Refinement Matrix	Parameters after calibration (TBC 22920)
Boresight installation / Boresight refinement	The same distinction as it appears in TBC's sensor properties (TBC 24868)
Vehicle frame	+X forward, +Y right, +Z downward. Governs lever arms and boresight angles TBC 25943; §7.6

6.6 Registration

TERM	MEANING
Registration	Adjusting a trajectory to fit surveyed control, or to fit another run. It does not move points (§21.1)
Register a Run	GCPs matched to picked targets, one run (TBC 22905)
Register a Mission	The same, across a set of runs, with each GCP reusable (TBC 26473)
Register Run to Run	Cloud-to-cloud against a fixed Reference Run. Uses no surveyed control TBC 25096; §21.10
Reference Run	In run-to-run, the run whose trajectory does not change
Run to Adjust	The run optimised to the Reference Run
GCP	Ground control point — "an accurately surveyed coordinate location for a physical feature that can be identified on the ground" (TBC 22905)
Target	In TBC's registration sense: a point picked in the point cloud. Not a physical panel (§21.2)
Validation point (VP)	A GCP set As Check — paired and measured, but excluded from the adjustment TBC 22905; §22.2
Use XY · Use Z · As Check	The three independent per-point choices in the Control Points list (§22.2)

TERM	MEANING
Global	A shift of the whole trajectory, without rotation (<i>TBC 22905</i>)
Local	Local adjustment interpolating between control points. Does not extrapolate beyond them <i>TBC 22905; §21.5</i>
Global, and then Local	Global first, then Local. No separate selection guidance published
Target-Bundle Adjustment	Checked = 250 m intervals (coarser); unchecked = 70 m <i>TBC 22905; §21.7</i>
Point Cloud Smart Picking	The picking tool. Types: Default, Intersected Plane, Road Mark (<i>TBC 22905</i>)
<code>Targets.csv</code>	Where picked targets are saved when Registration Auto-Saving is on. Emptied permanently by answering "No" to the reload prompt (<i>TBC 22905</i>)
<code>sbet_<date>_reg_####.out</code>	The registered SBET on disk, incrementing per registration (<i>TBC 22905</i>)
<code>_reg_####</code> suffix	Carried by scan stations updated against a registered trajectory (<i>TBC 22638</i>)
Reg. Trajectory · RegTrajectory	The adjusted trajectory node, from Register a Run and Register a Mission respectively

6.7 Quality

TERM	MEANING
Tangential / Orthogonal / Vertical	TBC's three-axis agreement convention: along travel, across travel, and up. Diagnostic, not just descriptive (§23.3)
Overall Overlap	Percentage of points used against those generated, in calibration (<i>TBC 24886</i>)
The RMS asymmetry	Good RMS does not prove success; bad RMS proves failure; a visual check is necessary (<i>TBC 24886, 25096</i>)
Cutting Plane View	Profile view across a plane, used to check agreement between overlapping data. Set rendering to Scan Color or two offset surfaces read as one thick one (§25.1)
Scan Color	Rendering mode giving one colour per scan. Part of the QC method, not a display preference
<code>No overlap</code>	In run-to-run Results, a timestamp where the two runs do not overlap. Informative, not noise (§21.15)
Undefined RMS colour	How registered trajectory segments render, having lost their match to the <code>smrmsg</code> file (<i>TBC 27248</i>)

TERM	MEANING
Mission Report	Capture devices, runs, trajectories, generated scans, and per-sensor calibration with date (<i>TBC 23991_1, 24868</i>)

6.8 Export and delivery

TERM	MEANING
Mobile Mapping tab	Export pane tab holding the run-aware exporters
Point Cloud tab	Export pane tab holding the generic exporters. Selects by region or drawn rectangle — not by run <i>TBC 11769; §29.4</i>
Export to LAS (Trajectory Split)	The classified-regions exporter. Splits by distance; carries no trajectory (<i>TBC 27279</i>)
Scaling: Grid	Projected coordinates with the combined scale factor. Writes a <code>.txt</code> sidecar naming the CRS and scale factor (<i>TBC 11769</i>)
Scaling: Ground	Ground coordinates. Does not expose the scale factor used (<i>TBC 11769</i>)
ECEF export	Ground-scaled LAS/LAZ including the project's global CRS (<i>TBC 11769</i>)
Export timestamps	Not merely an attribute toggle. Set to Yes, "the exported scans are reprocessed from the raw data" <i>TBC 23339, 22501; §29.3</i>
Publish to TRCPS	Upload to Trimble Connect. Point cloud and trajectories are exported by default (<i>TBC 29527</i>)
TRCPS	Trimble Reality Capture Platform Service — an extension of Trimble Connect
TDU	Trimble Desktop Utility, installed with TBC, which performs the upload

6.9 Evidence tags

These tags appear throughout all four deliverables. They are the mechanism that keeps verified Trimble behaviour separate from proposed Parametrix practice, and they are load-bearing: a statement's tag is part of its meaning.

6.10 Terms deliberately not defined here

TERM	WHY NOT
Accuracy classes, tolerance bands, pass/fail thresholds	No numerical acceptance criterion is defined in this manual. Trimble publishes no MX60 acceptance tolerance, and inventing one would be worse than leaving it open (§23, master register)
Ordinary survey terms — <i>resection, least squares, geoid, combined scale factor</i>	Assumed knowledge. This manual teaches mobile mapping to surveyors, not surveying (§1.2)

7 MX60 System Architecture

7.1 The units

The MX60 is a vehicle-roof-mounted mobile mapping system. Its components, as they appear in this document and in TMI:

COMPONENT	FUNCTION
Sensor Unit	The roof-mounted head: scanners, cameras, GNSS antenna, IMU. 24–28 kg depending on configuration (<i>MX60 UG Rev B</i>) — a two-person lift
Control Unit	In-vehicle computer, data storage, power management. IP30 — not waterproof , and lives inside the vehicle <i>MX60 UG Rev B</i> , p.53
Exchangeable data disk	Removable storage inside the Control Unit
Mounting rack	Attaches the Sensor Unit to the vehicle
GAMS antenna (<i>optional</i>)	Second GNSS antenna for direct heading
DMI (<i>optional</i>)	Wheel-mounted distance measuring indicator

7.2 The sensors

SENSOR	COUNT	NOTES
Laser scanner	2	One per side, mounted at opposing oblique angles
Spherical camera	1	360° panoramic
Rear-downward camera	1	Pavement-facing

The two-scanner arrangement is the reason Register Run to Run can work on a single run, and the reason most exports produce a pair of files — *Laser Left* and *Laser Right* — rather than one (*TBC 22501, 23339*).

7.3 The three configurations

Three: **Core**, **Pro**, **Premium** MX60 UG Rev B, p.12. They differ in the 360° camera and in the GNSS/IMU grade.

	CORE	PRO	PREMIUM
Panoramic image size	8192 × 4096 px	12288 × 6144 px	12288 × 6144 px
Side / planar image size	4096 × 3008 px	4096 × 3008 px	4096 × 3008 px

(TBC 22501, 23888 — the panorama figures; these are the sizes TBC writes at export)

SET BY THE PROJECT — .: WHICH CONFIGURATION IS THE PARAMETRIX SYSTEM, AND IS IT FITTED WITH GAMS AND DMI? STATED AND TRACKED IN THE SOP §12; SEE ALSO THE MASTER REGISTER.

7.4 Specification discrepancies to be aware of

Two unresolved conflicts sit in the source documents. Neither blocks work, but neither should be quoted to a client without checking.

	SOURCE A	SOURCE B	STATUS
Scanner field of view	~346° beam deflection MX60 UG Rev B, p.54	Full 360° (<i>Spec sheet, p.2</i>)	NOT DOCUMENTED BY TRIMBLE — matters for occlusion geometry
Mounting rack	MX SCAN Roof Rack, 18 kg	MX Shock Absorbing Mounting Rack, 28 kg	SET BY THE PROJECT — which is fitted. The published GAMS corner offsets apply to the standard rack only MX60 UG Rev B, p.68

(Recorded as CONFLICT-002 and CONFLICT-003 in reference/mx60-reference-data.csv .)

7.5 The vehicle frame

Every offset and every angle in this system is expressed in one convention, and it is worth fixing in mind once because it is not the convention most surveyors carry around.

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 25943, 24886)

- **Positive X = forward driving direction**
- **Positive Y = right side of the vehicle**
- **Positive Z = downward**

WHY THIS MATTERS — Z is down

A sensor mounted **above** the reference point has a **negative Z** in this convention. Getting the sign wrong puts twice the offset into the solution, in the wrong direction — and it will not present as a sign error downstream. It will present as a height problem, which people reasonably attribute to the geoid, the antenna model or the base station.

The same convention governs every boresight angle in §20: **roll about X, pitch about Y, heading about Z**, with Z pointing down.

7.6 Lever arms and boresight angles — the two kinds of offset

The system has to know where each sensor is relative to the inertial reference point, and how each sensor is oriented relative to it. These are two different quantities, determined in two different ways, and conflating them is the most common conceptual error in this subject.

	LEVER ARM	BORESIGHT
What it is	The distance offset between two sensor frames — a three-dimensional vector	The angular offset between a sensor and the inertial reference frame
How it is determined	Measured. Known from manufacture and from installation measurement	Estimated. This is what a calibration solves (§20)
Changes when	The hardware is remounted or the rack changes	Thermal cycling, vibration, remounting — it drifts
Error behaviour	A constant offset, the same at every range	Multiplies with range (§3.1)

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 25943)

"**Lever Arm** refers to the displacement between two body coordinate frames... expressed as a three-dimensional vector."

TBC's laser scanner calibration solves angles only TBC 24886; §20.2. If a lever arm is wrong, no amount of calibration will find it — the adjustment has no parameter for it. It will be absorbed partly into the boresight estimate, which then compensates for a translation with a rotation, and the compensation is only correct at the range where it was determined.

CAUTION

Changing the rack, the roof bars, the vehicle, or the Sensor Unit's position on the rack invalidates the lever arms and may invalidate the calibration. None of those changes announces itself in the data, and the resulting error is systematic rather than noisy.

Where the values live

`Extcal.json`, written alongside the raw mission data, carries the calibration state that produced that mission (§5.2). TBC distinguishes the values **before** calibration from the values **after**:

TERM	MEANING
Installation Matrix	Parameters before calibration — the as-built values (TBC 22920)
Refinement Matrix	Parameters after calibration (TBC 22920)
Boresight installation / Boresight refinement	The same distinction as it appears in TBC's sensor properties (TBC 24868)

7.7 The optional sensors, and why fitment is a live question

GAMS and DMI are both optional. Whether this system has them changes the field procedure, the office procedure, and what the data is capable of — which is why their fitment sits in the master register as a blocking item rather than a detail.

	FITTED	NOT FITTED
GAMS	Direct heading from a two-antenna baseline. Initialization is faster and heading is better determined throughout (§9.1)	Heading must be solved from motion. Straight driving during initialization matters more, not less TBC 25943; §13

	FITTED	NOT FITTED
DMI	Independent along-track distance, constraining the solution through GNSS gaps (§9.2)	The inertial sensor carries the gaps alone

SET BY THE PROJECT — : /. WHICH CONFIGURATION IS THE PARAMETRIX SYSTEM, AND IS

it fitted with GAMS and DMI?* The vendor can confirm from the serial number. Tracked in the **SOP §12** and in the master register; it is the single decision that unblocks the most other items.

7.8 Power

The Control Unit manages vehicle power. The specifications below are what the installation has to satisfy; the installation procedure itself is the **Field How To §6**.

TRIMBLE METHOD

| Value | Source

---|---|---

Input voltage | **12–16 V DC** | MX60 UG Rev B

Current at startup | **25 A at 12.8 V** (320 W) | MX60 UG Rev B

Current in operation | 12 A (160 W) | MX60 UG Rev B

Supply rating required | 30 A or more | MX60 QSG Rev B, p.4

Direct-connection fuse | **35 A**, close to the battery | MX60 UG Rev B

Data storage | 2 × 4 TB removable SSD | MX60 Spec Sheet, p.3

An auxiliary battery as a backup power source is recommended

MX60 QSG Rev B, p.4.

WHY THIS MATTERS

The startup draw is twice the operating draw. A supply sized for the operating figure will brown out at every power-on, and the symptom — a system that starts unreliably — does not look like a supply problem.

7.9 The protection that ends a run

The Control Unit manages vehicle power, and it protects the vehicle's battery rather than the mission. That priority is correct and worth knowing about in advance.

CAUTION**Battery Protect** MX60 UG Rev B, p.27:

Event | Trigger

---|---

Audible warning | Supply below **10.5 V for longer than 12 seconds**

Power cut | Supply below **10.5 V for more than 90 seconds**

Recovery | Voltage rises above **12.0 V within that 90 seconds**

The alarm leaves roughly **78 seconds** to restore charge — that figure is the arithmetic of the two sourced timings, not a separately published one.

An interrupted run loses the closing sequence with it.

WHY THIS MATTERS

The consequence is not "the system switched off." It is that the mission ended without a closing sequence, so the backward filter pass has no anchor at the end of the data (§14). The cost is paid at the end of the trajectory, which is often the most recent and most important part of the day's work.

The practical response is to keep the engine running while the system is operating, and to treat the audible warning as an instruction to restore charge immediately rather than as information.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

What we just did. We took the system apart on paper: two laser scanners, two cameras, a GNSS/inertial unit, and optionally a second antenna and a wheel sensor — plus the conventions that describe where each of them sits.

Why it matters. Almost every number in the rest of this manual depends on two things about this particular vehicle: which configuration it is, and what is fitted to it. The Core configuration writes a panoramic image a quarter the size of the Pro and Premium ones. Without GAMS, the heading has to be solved out of the vehicle's motion, which changes how you drive the first two minutes of every mission. These are not details to look up later — they change the procedure.

What can go wrong. The offset signs. Z is **down** in this convention, so a sensor on the roof has a negative Z. And a lever arm is measured while a boresight is estimated, so a wrong lever arm cannot be calibrated out — the calibration has no parameter for it, and will quietly absorb part of the error into an angle instead, which then only works at one range.

What good looks like. The configuration, the fitment and the measured offsets are written down somewhere a processor can find them, and somebody has checked them against the vehicle rather than against the last project's paperwork. These values are entered once and used on every mission afterwards, so an error in them is systematic, invisible, and permanent until someone re-measures.

8 GNSS/INS Integration

§2 said the trajectory is the job. This section says how the trajectory is computed, because almost everything the field procedure asks for is an attempt to give this computation what it needs.

8.1 Two sensors that fail in opposite ways

The trajectory is a time series: position (X, Y, Z) and attitude (roll, pitch, heading) at a high rate, for the whole mission. It is produced by combining two sensor types whose failure modes are complementary.

	GNSS	INERTIAL (IMU)
Measures	Absolute position	Change in orientation and velocity
Error behaviour	Bounded but noisy — it does not drift, but it jumps and can be lost entirely	Smooth and precise instant to instant, but drifts without limit over time
Fails when	Sky is obstructed — trees, buildings, bridges, tunnels	Always, gradually, by its nature
Rate	Low	High

Neither is adequate alone. Combined, each covers the other's weakness: GNSS anchors the inertial solution and stops the drift; the IMU carries the solution smoothly through the gaps when GNSS is degraded or absent.

WHY THIS MATTERS

This is the whole reason mobile mapping works, and also the whole reason it fails quietly. The integration is *designed* to keep producing a plausible answer when one of its inputs stops. It does not stop, warn, or degrade visibly. It keeps going, and the error grows in a way that is smooth, continuous and invisible in the point cloud (§3).

8.2 What the filter does with them

The combination is done by a filter that maintains an estimate of the system's state — position, velocity, attitude, and the sensor errors themselves — and updates it as observations arrive.

Three consequences follow from the way such a filter works, and all three show up in the field procedure:

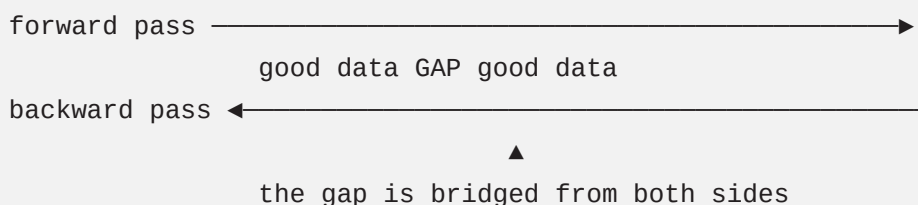
It estimates sensor errors, not just position. Gyro and accelerometer biases are part of what the filter solves for. That is why a period of good observations early in the mission improves the whole mission, and why initialization is a procedure rather than a warm-up.

Some states are only observable under motion. Heading, in particular, cannot be separated from a gyro bias when the vehicle is stationary and moving in a straight line at constant speed. It becomes observable when the vehicle accelerates, decelerates and turns. This is why initialization requires manoeuvres and not merely time (§13).

It weights each observation by an assumed accuracy. Those assumptions are settings — multipath level, DMI scale factor standard deviation, GAMS baseline standard deviation (§17.3). A setting that overstates an input's accuracy pulls the solution toward a measurement it should have discounted.

8.3 Forward, backward, and the smoother

For survey work the filter is run **twice** — once forward through time and once backward — and the two passes are merged. The merged result is the **Smoothed Best Estimate of Trajectory**, universally abbreviated **SBET**. The real-time solution computed in the vehicle is the **NAV**, which is a fallback and not an option for survey deliverables (§17.2).



The backward pass is why the end of a mission matters as much as the beginning.

A gap in the middle of the drive is bracketed by good data on both sides, and the smoother can bridge it from both directions. A gap at the **end** has good data on one side only — the forward pass arrives at it already degraded, and there is no backward pass to meet it. The same is true in reverse at the start.

This is the practical reason the field procedure requires a proper closing sequence (§14), and it is the single most commonly skipped step in mobile mapping. It is also why the degraded stretches at the two ends of a trajectory are worse than an identical stretch in the middle, and why control and check points at the ends are worth more than control in the middle (§22).

8.4 What the filter cannot do

Three limits are worth stating explicitly, because a good deal of misplaced confidence comes from assuming otherwise.

It cannot create information that was not collected. A long GNSS outage is bridged by propagating an inertial solution that is drifting. The smoother makes the bridge as good as the surrounding data allows; it does not make it as good as observed data.

It cannot tell you that it struggled, in the point cloud. The output of a degraded stretch is a clean, dense, internally consistent cloud in the wrong place (§3.2). The evidence of the struggle lives in the trajectory's RMS record, not in the points (§24).

It cannot distinguish a systematic error in its inputs from the truth. A wrong antenna model, a mis-keyed base station coordinate, a DMI scale factor for the wrong wheel: each is a consistent error that the filter will happily absorb and propagate. Nothing in the RMS will look wrong, because nothing in the internal consistency of the solution *is* wrong (§23).

8.5 Where each remedy acts

It helps to see the whole set of remedies as acting at different points on this diagram, because they are not interchangeable and their costs are different (§27):

REMEDY	ACTS ON	NEEDS
Better acquisition	The observations themselves	Planning, and a second mobilisation if discovered late
Reprocessing with better base data	The GNSS side of the filter	Raw data intact, better corrections available
LiDAR QC	Adds the scan data as a third aiding sensor	Overlapping runs, a large workstation (§11)
PFIX	Injects surveyed control into a second POSPac pass	POSPac licence, surveyed control, picked targets (§27)
Registration	Bends the finished trajectory to fit control	Surveyed control, and it acts after the fact (§21)

The first four improve the *solution*. Registration improves the *fit*. That distinction matters because a registered trajectory has been adjusted to agree with the control it was given, and its agreement with that control is therefore no longer evidence of anything (§23).

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

What we just did. We looked inside the thing that produces the trajectory: two sensors that fail in opposite ways, a filter that combines them, and a second pass run backwards through time so that gaps are bridged from both ends.

Why it matters. Every odd-sounding requirement in the field procedure comes from this. Why sit still for a few minutes at the start — because the filter is solving for sensor biases and needs quiet observations to do it. Why drive straight, then vary speed, then turn — because heading is not observable until the vehicle accelerates and turns. Why finish the mission the same way you started it — because the backward pass needs good data at the end, and a gap at the end of a drive has good data on one side only.

What can go wrong. The filter never stops producing an answer. That is the point of it and it is also the trap. Drive under half a kilometre of tree cover and the solution keeps coming, smooth and confident, drifting the whole way. Nothing in the point cloud from that stretch looks different from the good data on either side of it.

What good looks like. Continuous observations, short well-bracketed gaps, a proper start and a proper finish. Then the RMS record of the trajectory — which you can look at before any point cloud exists (§24) — tells you where the solution was strong and where it was not, which is exactly where to put your control and your check points.

9 GAMS and DMI

Both are optional. Both change what the system is capable of, and both change the field procedure. Whether this system has them is an open item (/ , §7.7).

9.1 GAMS — a second antenna, and therefore a heading

GAMS is the GNSS Azimuth Measurement System: a second GNSS antenna mounted a known distance from the primary one. Two antennas a known distance apart give a **direct heading measurement**.

That matters because heading is the hardest attitude component to determine. Roll and pitch are anchored by gravity — an accelerometer knows which way is down. Nothing anchors heading. Without a second antenna, heading has to be solved out of the vehicle's motion, which requires the vehicle to move in ways that make it observable (§13).

TRIMBLE METHOD — MX60 UG REV B, P.67

GAMS reduces initialization time and eliminates the special driving manoeuvres otherwise required.

Read the second half of that sentence. It says, by implication, that **the manoeuvres are required when GAMS is not fitted**. Trimble's Quick Start Guide states the same thing from the other direction: **straight driving is more important if a GAMS antenna is not used** MX60 QSG Rev B, p.12. The field procedure is therefore not the same on a system with GAMS and a system without, and knowing which one this is precedes writing it down (§13).

What GAMS requires to work

TRIMBLE METHOD — MX60 UG REV B, PP.67–68

Requirement | Value

---|---

Offset accuracy, **collection only** | 10 cm or better

Offset accuracy, **post-processing** | **on the order of a few millimetres**

Minimum baseline, post-processing | **2.0 m** between primary and secondary antennas

Antenna matching | Primary and secondary **must be the same type**. Do not mix

Measured to | The **L1 antenna phase centre** of the secondary antenna

Re-measure | **Every time GAMS is re-installed** on the roof for a new mission

The two accuracy figures are two orders of magnitude apart, and survey work is on the tight one. All Parametrix mobile mapping is post-processed, so the requirement is millimetres, not centimetres. A GAMS offset good enough to navigate with is not good enough to survey with.

TRIMBLE METHOD — MX60 UG Rev B, p.68

Known offsets from the **top-left front corner of the standard Trimble Roof Rack** to the external reference point: **X +1.006 m · Y -0.469 m · Z +0.025 m.**

CAUTION

Those published offsets apply to the **standard roof rack only** — not to the shock-absorbing mounting rack. Which rack is fitted is an open conflict in the source documents (`CONFLICT-003` , \$7.4). Using the published corner offsets on the wrong rack puts a fixed, systematic error into the GAMS baseline and therefore into heading.

NOT DOCUMENTED BY TRIMBLE

The **Trimble GAMS Antenna Kit Installation & Operation Manual** (*referenced MX60 UG p.43*) is not held. It is needed to complete the installation procedure if GAMS is fitted.

What GAMS is worth

TRIMBLE METHOD — MX60 UG REV B, P.56

Heading accuracy, all configurations: **0.015°**, with the GAMS option and a 2 m baseline.

Apply §3.1 to that figure to see what it means in the cloud: an angular error acts through range, so the same heading error produces a proportionally larger position error the further the feature is from the vehicle.

9.2 DMI — an independent measure of distance travelled

A **DMI** (Distance Measuring Indicator) is a wheel-mounted sensor giving an independent along-track distance. It constrains the inertial solution when GNSS is poor: the IMU can drift in along-track scale, and the DMI does not.

TRIMBLE METHOD — MX60 UG REV B, P.46; TMI UG REV L, P.21

- The DMI wheel must be a **non-steering** wheel
- The lever arm is measured to **the centre of the tread where the DMI wheel contacts the road**
- TMI requires the lever arm in metres, the **mounting position — left or right, taking the driving direction as reference** — and the **wheel diameter**, which is to be measured "with great care"

Two signs that point in opposite directions

This is the single most error-prone detail in the installation, and it is worth setting out side by side because both quantities are entered by hand, both depend on the mounting side, and they carry **opposite** signs.

QUANTITY	MOUNTED LEFT	MOUNTED RIGHT	SOURCE
Lever arm Y (vehicle frame: +Y is right)	negative	positive	MX60 UG Rev B, p.46
Scale factor (trajectory processing, §17.3)	positive	negative	(TBC 25943)

CAUTION

A left-mounted DMI has a **negative Y lever arm** and a **positive scale factor**. They are different quantities describing different things — one is a position, one is a correction to a measured distance — and their signs are not related. Anyone who reasons "it's on the left, so both are the same sign" will get one of them wrong.

The lever arm is entered in the field, in TMI. The scale factor is entered in the office, in TBC. **Record which side the DMI is on at installation**, because the processor cannot see the vehicle.

The 5 % that is an assumption, not a measurement

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 25943)

DMI scale factor standard deviation: **default 5 %**. "Increase the setting if the scale factor is not known with 5% accuracy, and **set it to 100% if it is not known at all.**"

NO PUBLISHED FIGURE

The 5 % default is only correct if the wheel diameter was actually measured. If the value came out of a manual for a nominal tyre, 5 % is an assertion of accuracy that nobody verified, and the filter is weighting the DMI accordingly. Trimble provides the honest escape hatch — set it to 100 % if unknown. Determine which case applies before trusting the default.

NOT DOCUMENTED BY TRIMBLE

The **Trimble MX Distance Measuring Indicator Installation & Operation Manual** (*referenced MX60 UG p.42*) is not held. It contains the scale-factor value for the measured wheel diameter, which trajectory processing needs (§17.3).

9.3 The failure mode both share

OBSERVED IN THE SOFTWARE — / TRIMBLE METHOD — TMI UG REV L, P.21

"If an aiding navigation sensor is not activated in Vehicle Settings its data will **not** be logged — even though all connections may have been made properly."

CAUTION

This applies to both DMI and GAMS. The hardware can be correctly installed, correctly wired and physically present, and log nothing, because a checkbox in Vehicle Settings is off. There is no cabling fault to find and nothing looks wrong.

In the office the symptom is the corresponding pane in **Process Raw Trajectory Data** appearing **dimmed** — TBC dims the GAMS and DMI settings when the sensor was disabled during acquisition TBC 25943; §17.3. By then the mission is collected.

Two consequences: the preflight check on a system with either sensor fitted has to confirm activation and not merely presence, and the office intake check has to look at whether those panes are dimmed and say so, while a re-collection is still cheap.

9.4 Summary — what each contributes

	GAMS	DMI
Gives the filter	A direct heading observation	An independent along-track distance
Most valuable	At initialization, and wherever heading is weakly determined	Through GNSS outages, where inertial along-track scale drifts
Without it	Heading is solved from motion; straight driving and manoeuvres matter more QSG p.12	The inertial solution carries outages unaided
Configured	In TMI Vehicle Settings, field	Lever arm in TMI, field; scale factor in TBC, office
Silent failure	Not activated in Vehicle Settings → not logged	Not activated → not logged; or scale factor from a nominal, unmeasured wheel

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

What we just did. We looked at the two optional sensors: a second GNSS antenna that measures heading directly, and a wheel sensor that measures how far the vehicle actually travelled.

Why it matters. Heading is the attitude component nothing else pins down. Gravity tells the system which way is down, so roll and pitch have an anchor; nothing tells it which way is north. With a second antenna it gets that directly. Without one it has to work it out from how the vehicle moves, which is why the driving manoeuvres at the start of a mission exist and why Trimble says straight driving matters *more* when GAMS is absent. The DMI does a different job: it keeps the along-track scale honest through a tunnel or under tree cover, where the inertial sensor alone will quietly stretch or compress the distance travelled.

What can go wrong. Three things, all of them silent. A sensor that is installed but not activated in Vehicle Settings logs nothing at all. A DMI scale factor taken from a manual rather than a measured wheel is a guess wearing a 5 % accuracy label. And the DMI's two signs run opposite ways — left-side mounting means a negative lever-arm Y and a positive scale factor — which catches people who assume the two must agree.

What good looks like. Somebody knows which sensors are fitted, the offsets were measured to millimetres rather than centimetres because this is post-processed survey work, the activation was confirmed before driving, and the mounting side is written down somewhere the office can find it.

10 TMI, TBC and POSPac

10.1 Trimble Mobile Imaging — the field software

TMI is the browser-based field software. It runs in **Chrome** against the Control Unit.

Capture interface	<code>http://tmi.mx-scan.net</code>
Administration	<code>http://admin.mx-scan.net</code>
Modules	TMI.Capture, TMI.AI

(TMI UG Rev L)

TMI is a web application served by the vehicle, not a cloud service. It does not need internet access, and the addresses above resolve only on the Control Unit's network.

MX60 support arrived in TMI in **December 2024** TMI UG Rev L, p.2, which is why documents older than that — including the TBC Technical Notes of October 2022 — do not mention the MX60 at all.

NOT DOCUMENTED BY TRIMBLE

Which TMI version is on the Parametrix system, and how are firmware updates distributed? One documented behaviour differs between versions: the Quick Start Guide describes two separate MX60 laser controls (*Measurement Prog* and *Line Speed*), where TMI Rev L describes a single combined **Laser Mode** MX60 QSG p.10; TMI UG Rev L p.29. (`CONFLICT-005`)

10.2 Trimble Business Center — the office software

TBC with the **mobile mapping module**. The captured documentation is **TBC 2026.10** (§1.6).

Where the mobile mapping commands live

RIBBON LOCATION	COMMANDS
Mobile Mapping ► Processing	Register a Run, Register a Mission, Register Run to Run

RIBBON LOCATION	COMMANDS
Mobile Mapping ► Reports	Mobile Mapping Report, Trajectory Plots
Mission node context menu	Generate Scans, Update Scans, Process Raw Trajectory Data, Generate POSPac Position Fixes, Import/Export Calibration, Cleanup Mobile Mapping Mission
Capture Devices node context menu	Manual Camera Calibration
Point Clouds ► Regions	Extract Classified Point Cloud
Point Clouds ► View	Cutting Plane View
Home ► Data Exchange ► Export	Mobile Mapping tab and Point Cloud tab — different exporters
Home ► Data Exchange	Publish to TRCPS

(TBC 22905, 26473, 25096, 23991_1, 27415, 26466, 25943, 24460, 22920, 20728, 27279, 11769, 29527)

IMPORTANT

The Export dialog has two tabs that both export point clouds, and they behave differently. The **Mobile Mapping** tab holds the run-aware exporters; the **Point Cloud** tab holds the generic ones, which select by region or by a rectangle drawn in a view rather than by run (TBC 11769). §29 covers the distinction. Choosing the wrong tab is an easy and consequential mistake.

Version-dependent behaviour

Two behaviours in this document depend on TBC version. Both are legacy.

BEHAVIOUR	BOUNDARY	RELEVANCE
Laser scanners and cameras calibrated outside TBC and imported as JSON	"up to the 5.21 version" (TBC 24886, 24868)	5.21 predates 5.70, the oldest release Trimble publishes notes for. Any recent installation calibrates in TBC
Select RMS File prompt on a registration with no RMS file	"typically a project saved in TBC prior to version 5.80" (TBC 27248)	Affects inherited legacy projects only

TBC renumbered from 5.x to YYYY.MM after 5.90.1; releases run 2023.10 through 2026.10 (TBC RN 2025.21).

NOT DOCUMENTED BY TRIMBLE

Which TBC version is installed on the Parametrix workstation? This manual documents **2026.10**. Several behaviours it describes were introduced in 2025.21 or 2026.10, and an older installation will not have them. It is a one-line answer that nobody has written down.

Licensing

RELEASE	REQUIRES WARRANTY OR SUBSCRIPTION VALID TO
2025.21	1 November 2025 or later
2026.10	1 June 2026 or later

(*TBC RN 2025.21, 2026.10*). Visible at **Support ► License Manager**.

OBSERVED IN THE SOFTWARE

From TBC 2026.10, **Trimble ID sign-in requires two-step verification** — a code by email each time (*TBC RN 2026.10*). Anyone signing in to TBC or Trimble Connect needs access to the account's email at that moment. Worth knowing before it stops a session.

10.3 POSPac MMS — and the licence gate that shapes the whole workflow

Applanix POSPac MMS computes the SBET from raw GNSS and inertial observations. Whether Parametrix holds a licence determines which office workflow is even available.

TRIMBLE METHOD

TBC's **Process Raw Trajectory Data** command computes an SBET inside TBC — but "the requirement to run the feature is to have the Applanix's POSPac MMS application (**from version 8.6 and a valid license**) installed alongside TBC" (*TBC 25943*).

Generate POSPac Position Fixes — the documented remedy for corridors with no usable GNSS — also requires POSPac, and a second processing pass in it (*TBC 24460*).

FUNCTION	NEEDS POSPAC 8.6+ AND A LICENCE?
Import <code>.mxd</code> , apply SBET or NAV	No

FUNCTION	NEEDS POSPAC 8.6+ AND A LICENCE?
Generate Scans · Update Scans	No
Register a Run / Mission / Run-to-Run	No
Calibrate laser scanners and cameras	No
Cleanup, Mission Report, Trajectory Plots	No
Export and Publish	No
Process Raw Trajectory Data	Yes
Generate POSPac Position Fixes (PFIX)	Yes
LiDAR QC Processing	Not stated — see below

SET BY THE PROJECT — ∴ DOES PARAMETRIX HOLD A POSPAC MMS 8.6+ LICENCE, AND WHERE IS IT INSTALLED? STATED AND TRACKED IN THE SOP §13; SEE ALSO THE MASTER REGISTER.

10.4 Trimble Connect and TRCPS

Publish to TRCPS uploads point cloud data, trajectories and images from TBC to a **Trimble Connect** project, through the **Trimble Desktop Utility (TDU)** installed alongside TBC. It requires a Trimble ID, and uploads consume the account's Trimble Connect storage quota (*TBC 29527*).

It matters to this document for a reason beyond delivery convenience: **it is one of only two paths that carries the trajectory out of TBC with the data** (§29, §30).

10.5 Reference documents

The full list is §1.6. Two gaps:

NOT DOCUMENTED BY TRIMBLE

Trimble GAMS Antenna Kit Installation & Operation Manual (*referenced MX60 UG p.43*) and **Trimble DMI Installation & Operation Manual** (*referenced MX60 UG p.42*) are both needed to complete the lever-arm procedure (§7.6, and the **Field How To**), **if those accessories are fitted**. Neither is held.

Note that the MX60 User Guide requires millimetre-level GAMS offsets and a **≥ 2.0 m baseline** where navigation data will be post-processed (*p.68*) — which is all survey-grade work.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

What we just did. We inventoried the hardware and the three pieces of software, and identified the two questions that decide what the office workflow can even look like: which configuration of MX60 this is, and whether Parametrix has a POSPac licence.

Why it matters. Most equipment sections are reference material you never read twice. This one contains a fork in the road. If there is no POSPac licence, the trajectory has to be computed somewhere else and one of the three fixes for bad GNSS is simply unavailable — and you want to know that before you quote a job through a tree-lined corridor, not during it. The configuration question is similar: Core and Premium differ by a factor of four in image resolution, so a promise about imagery deliverables made without knowing which one is on the roof is a promise made blind.

What can go wrong. The quiet failure here is the Export dialog having two tabs that both produce point clouds. The Mobile Mapping tab knows about runs; the Point Cloud tab does not, and lets you export a rectangle drawn across a view. Both produce a plausible LAS file. Only one of them was selected with any awareness of which data it was taking. \$29 comes back to this.

What good looks like. Before the first production job, someone should be able to state, on one page: the configuration and serial number, whether GAMS and DMI are fitted, which rack is on the vehicle, the TMI version, the TBC version, and whether a POSPac licence exists and where it lives. None of that is known today. All of it is a phone call to the dealer.

11 LiDAR QC

11.1 What it is, and what it costs to run

LiDAR QC Processing uses the scan data itself as an aiding sensor to improve the trajectory where GNSS is poor — similar in principle to SLAM (*TBC 28972*). It is the only documented remedy for degraded GNSS that needs **neither POSPac nor additional ground control** (§27).

It needs a workstation well beyond an ordinary one.

	MINIMUM	RECOMMENDED
CPU	Intel Core i7 or i9	Intel XEON
RAM	128 GB	256 GB
TEMP storage	1 TB SSD on the PCI bus	2 TB SSD M.2 on the PCI bus
Virtual memory	+1 TB SSD always available	+2 TB SSD M.2, or 4 TB combined
Paging file	—	initial = installed RAM, maximum = 6 × installed RAM
Also required	MATLAB Runtime R2024b (24.2) , installed after TBC	

(*TBC 28972*)

SET BY THE PROJECT — ∴ STATED AND TRACKED IN THE SOP §13; SEE ALSO THE MASTER REGISTER.

NOT DOCUMENTED BY TRIMBLE

Does LiDAR QC have its own POSPac dependency? Trimble does not state one, but it is an Applanix technology and the topic directs configuration questions to the **Applanix Support Team** (*TBC 28972*).

11.2 What it actually computes

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 28972)

"LiDAR QC is an advanced trajectory processing technology that, **similar to LiDAR SLAM**, is using scan data as an aiding sensor to improve georeferencing accuracies in areas of poor GNSS coverage or in areas where overlapping scans are not perfectly matching. Based on a robust and iterative least square adjustment, LiDAR QC generates 3D Voxels that are matched in overlap scan regions. The result of this iterative process is solving the constant IMU boresight angles and making corrections to the post-processed trajectory (position and orientation)."

Enabled by the **LiDAR QC (Refine with scans)** checkbox in Process Raw Trajectory Data, which adds a LiDAR QC tab. Requires **MATLAB Runtime R2024b (24.2)** and a substantial workstation (§11.1).

11.3 Settings

SETTING	VALUES	DEFAULT
Range	Minimum and maximum LiDAR measurement distance used	3 m to 100 m
Noise	5, 10, 50, 80, 100, 200 mm	5 mm for MX50/MX60; 10 mm for MX9/MX90
Lasers	Left · Right · All	All

NO PUBLISHED FIGURE

— **the 3–100 m range.** The MX60's useful range and the range over which scan geometry usefully aids a trajectory solution are different questions. 100 m may include returns too noisy to help.

— **Lasers = All.** Trimble's own text beside the setting says using both "can increase computation time without significantly improving the accuracy, as it compares the left versus right laser of isolated runs." **The default contradicts the guidance printed next to it.**

11.4 Running it

Select runs from the Project Tree **with overlap — parallel runs, or crossing runs** — click **Add**, set the parameters, **Compute** (*TBC 28972*).

11.5 The acquisition geometry it needs

Trimble prescribes a specific acquisition geometry for LiDAR QC:

ELEMENT	REQUIREMENT
Area	"a structured scene such as a residential area with detached houses and objects within the LiDAR sensor's maximum range"; "open sky terrain for good GNSS satellite visibility"
Strips	"two perpendicular strips. Each strip will consist of two runs (one in each direction) "
Strip length	250–300 m

(*TBC 28972*)

This is materially the same geometry the laser scanner calibration requires (§20.3) — four runs, two orthogonal pairs, both directions. **One site can serve both**, which matters because establishing a calibration site is a real piece of work (the **SOP §15**).

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

What we just did. We looked at a way of improving the trajectory using the scan data itself. Instead of relying only on GNSS and the inertial sensor, LiDAR QC matches overlapping scans to each other and works backwards to a better path — the same idea a SLAM system uses, applied after the fact to data you already have.

Why it matters. It is the only remedy for poor GNSS that needs neither a POSpac licence nor additional surveyed control (§27). If you have overlapping runs — and the recommended pass pattern gives you overlapping runs anyway — the information needed to improve the solution is already sitting in the dataset.

What can go wrong. It is not free. The hardware requirement is a serious workstation, not a good laptop: 128 GB of RAM at minimum, 256 GB recommended, plus a separate MATLAB runtime. If the machine cannot meet that, the capability does not exist for us regardless of what the checkbox says. And it needs genuine overlap — running it on isolated passes that do not see the same ground gives it nothing to match.

What good looks like. Overlapping runs, a structured scene with buildings and hard edges rather than open field, and a machine that can hold the problem in memory. Note that the acquisition geometry LiDAR QC wants is nearly the same one the laser scanner calibration wants (§20), so one site can serve both purposes.

12 Coordinate Systems, Datums and Epochs

12.1 What this section covers

Coordinate systems, datums, projections and geoid models are ordinary survey knowledge and this manual does not teach them. What it does cover is the handful of places where **mobile mapping uses them differently from conventional survey work**, and where that difference has caused real errors:

- The project coordinate system must be set **before** the mission is imported, not after (§12.2)
- The trajectory is computed in a frame chosen by POSpac, which may not be the project's, and the only outward sign is a filename (§12.3)
- Epoch matters more than usual, because the trajectory's reference frame and the project's control may be realised at different epochs (§12.4)
- Grid and ground scaling behave asymmetrically at export — one writes down what it did, the other does not (§12.5)

Everything else about datums and projections is assumed.

12.2 Set the project coordinate system before importing

TRIMBLE METHOD

"Create a VCE project and if necessary, change the coordinate system so that it matches the coordinate system for the mobile mapping data to import." (*TBC 24886, 24460*)

CAUTION

Set the project coordinate system before importing the mission.

Changing it afterwards is possible in TBC generally, but by then every derived product — scans, registrations, exports — was computed in the previous frame.

Treat it as irreversible in practice.

The database

TRIMBLE METHOD

The **Coordinate System Database v115** ships with TBC 2026.10. Selecting a predefined geoid model now enters the vertical datum name automatically (*TBC RN 2026.10*).

Two v115 entries relevant to US work: a grid transformation from **CSRN2025 (NAD83 2011) to CA SRS Epoch 2017.50** for California zones 1–6, and a **beta** Canadian **NATRF2022(CSRS)** with SGEOID2022-beta2.

12.3 The frame the trajectory is computed in

The trajectory is produced by POSPac, not by TBC (§17), and POSPac has its own view of the project's coordinate system.

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 25943)

Condition | SBET filename

---|---

Datum and epoch **known** by POSPac | `sbet_[mission name].out`

Datum and epoch **unknown** by POSPac | `sbet_[mission name]_[frame].out`
— computed "first in ITRF00 and then in the datum and epoch of the project"

The filename is a processing-path indicator and nothing more (§17.4, and Layer 3 of the layered verification — the **SOP §16**). It tells you an additional transformation occurred. It does not tell you the parameters were right, that the project CRS is set up correctly, or that the result is accurate. The plain form is equally not proof of correctness.

NO PUBLISHED FIGURE

Establish which of Parametrix's normal coordinate systems POSPac recognises directly, and which trigger the ITRF00 path. Answerable once, then known — and it determines whether an extra transformation is routine on Parametrix work or exceptional.

Computation mode and the reference frame

SET BY THE PROJECT — ∴ STATED AND TRACKED IN THE SOP §6; SEE ALSO THE MASTER REGISTER.

12.4 Epoch

TRIMBLE METHOD

From TBC 2026.10: "When working with a time-dependent datum, you can now work at a specific epoch that is not the default reference epoch for the selected datum... **Note that this feature is intended for experienced users, as incorrect settings may lead to inaccurate results.**" (*TBC RN 2026.10*)

Set by the project:. Stated and tracked in the **SOP §6**; see also the master register.

12.5 Grid, ground, and what the deliverable carries

Decided at export (§29.5), but it belongs in project setup because the client agreement depends on it.

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 11769, 27279)

Option | Behaviour

---|---

Scaling: Grid | Points in the current projected CRS with the combined scale factor. **An associated `.txt` file specifies the coordinate system and scale factor used.** Trimble warns that re-importing it "may cause some inconsistencies due to a **double-scaling effect**"

Scaling: Ground | Ground coordinates scaled from the 0,0 origin by the average combined scale factor. **"The scale factor is not exposed during export"**

ECEF export | LAS or LAZ in ground-based scaling "that includes the project's global coordinate system information"

IMPORTANT

A ground-scaled export does not record the scale factor it used. The recipient cannot convert without being told. Grid writes a sidecar; ECEF embeds the global CRS. Agree with the client which they are receiving, and make sure the file can say so.

Set by the project:. Stated and tracked in the **SOP §6**; see also the master register.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

What we just did. We went through the four places where mobile mapping treats coordinate systems differently from a conventional survey: when the CRS has to be set, what frame the trajectory was actually computed in, why epoch matters, and what a grid or ground export carries with it.

Why it matters. In conventional work the coordinate system is something you can change your mind about — the observations are raw and the reductions are repeatable. Here the coordinate system is baked into everything downstream the moment the mission is imported, because the trajectory, the scans, the registration and the exports are all computed products. Change the CRS afterwards and you have not reprojected your data; you have orphaned it.

What can go wrong. The one that is hardest to catch is the trajectory frame. POSPac may not recognise the project's datum and epoch, in which case it computes in ITRF00 and then transforms — and the only thing that tells you so is an extra word in the SBET filename. That is not an error, and the result may be perfectly correct. But it means an extra transformation happened that nobody chose, and if the parameters were wrong it will look like a small systematic shift rather than like a mistake.

What good looks like. The CRS, datum, epoch and geoid are set and written down before the first mission is imported. Somebody has looked at the SBET filename and knows which path it took. And the client agreement says grid or ground in writing, because a ground-scaled export does not record the scale factor it used and the recipient cannot recover it from the file.

13 Initialization

Initialization looks like a warm-up. It is not. It is a short observation campaign designed to make quantities observable that are not observable at rest or at constant velocity, and the quality of everything collected afterwards depends on it.

The operational step list lives in the **Field How To**. This section explains what each step is for, so that a crew that has to improvise — a site with no open sky, a route that cannot be driven straight for 20 m — knows which part of the sequence they are trading away.

13.1 The sequence Trimble documents

TRIMBLE METHOD — MX60 QSG REV B, PP.13–14; MX60 UG REV B

1. **Park in an open-sky area** with good GNSS visibility and PDOP, avoiding high buildings and obstructions
2. Start the mission in TMI
3. **Log 2–3 minutes of static data** before driving
4. **Drive straight ahead for approximately 20 m**, with no larger dynamic steering. The navigation status switches on completing this
5. **Drive straight at varying speed** — accelerate then decelerate — **and perform dynamic steering manoeuvres**. An example profile: **0 → 50 → 20 → 50 → 20 km/h**
6. Navigation status progresses **red** → **orange** → **green**. Green means the user accuracies for the navigation system are met
7. **Allow up to 10 further minutes of settling before logging data that matters**

IMPORTANT

Navigation alignment must be completed before data logging is allowed (MX60 QSG Rev B). The system enforces this — it is not a matter of operator discipline. What is **not** enforced is step 7.

13.2 What the static period does

Two separate things, and both are worth knowing because they fail differently.

It lets the GNSS receiver resolve a clean solution. A continuous set of observations from a stationary antenna under open sky is the best conditions the receiver will see all day.

It gives the inertial filter a constraint it can exploit: the vehicle's true velocity is zero. Anything the motion sensors report while parked is therefore **pure error** — measurable, and removable. This is how the filter gets its first estimate of the gyro and accelerometer biases, which it then carries forward through the whole mission (§8.2).

WHY THIS MATTERS

A static period under tree cover satisfies the clock and not the physics. The zero-velocity constraint still applies, so some of the benefit survives; the GNSS half does not. If open sky is genuinely unavailable at the start point, the honest response is to drive to open sky *before* starting the mission, not to start it where the vehicle happens to be parked.

13.3 What the manoeuvres do

At constant velocity in a straight line, a small attitude error and a sensor bias produce **the same signature** in the observations. The filter cannot separate them, because nothing in the data distinguishes them. Change speed and change direction and they stop looking alike — the two quantities affect the observations differently under acceleration — so the filter can tell them apart.

MANOEUVRE	WHAT IT MAKES OBSERVABLE
Straight run, ~20 m	Initial heading from the direction of travel. This is the step the navigation status is waiting on
Varying speed	Along-track accelerometer bias, and the separation of bias from pitch
Dynamic steering	Heading — the hardest component, and the reason the turns exist

Heading is the hardest attitude component for the reason given in §9.1: gravity anchors roll and pitch, and nothing anchors heading. The manoeuvres are how a system without GAMS obtains it, and they still help a system with GAMS.

TRIMBLE METHOD — MX60 QSG REV B, P.12; MX60 UG REV B, P.67

Straight driving is more important if a GAMS antenna is not used. GAMS reduces initialization time and eliminates the special driving manoeuvres otherwise required.

Perform the full sequence either way. It costs a few minutes, the static period is doing work that GAMS does not replace, and whether this system has GAMS is not yet established (, §7.7).

13.4 Why green is not finished

IMPORTANT

Green means the solution met the accuracy thresholds — not that it has finished converging. That is why Trimble asks for up to ten more minutes before recording anything that matters (*MX60 QSG Rev B*).

The first data after the light turns green is the weakest data of the day. Do not spend it on the most important part of the corridor.

This is the one part of the sequence the system does not enforce, which makes it the one part that gets skipped. It is also the part that costs nothing but patience.

WHY THIS MATTERS

There is a natural but wrong mental model in which the status light is a pass/fail gate: red means not ready, green means ready, and the moment it turns green the system is as good as it is going to get. What is actually happening is that an estimate is converging, and the threshold was crossed somewhere on the way. Ten minutes later the same estimate is better. The light does not change again, so nothing tells you.

13.5 What a weak initialization costs, and where it shows

A weak initialization does not produce an obviously bad dataset. It produces one where the attitude solution is carrying more error than it should, everywhere, and §3.1 says that error acts through range — so it is worst on the features furthest from the vehicle, which are often the ones the client cares about.

It also cannot be repaired in the office in any general way:

REMEDY	DOES IT HELP?
Reprocessing the trajectory	Only if better base data or corrections are available. The observation geometry is what it is
LiDAR QC	Possibly — it solves boresight angles and corrects the trajectory using scan overlap (§11)
Registration	It will fit the control it is given, absorbing some of the error at the control and leaving it between (§21)
Re-collection	Always works. Costs a mobilisation

This is the asymmetry from §5.5 in its most concrete form. Five minutes at the start of the mission, or a decision later about how much residual error to accept in a deliverable.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

What we just did. We took the start-of-mission routine apart and said what each piece is for: the two or three minutes parked, the straight run, the speed changes, the turns, and the ten minutes of patience after the light goes green.

Why it matters. The system is not warming up. It is solving for things it cannot see any other way. Parked, it knows its true speed is zero, so everything the motion sensors report is error it can measure and subtract. Driving straight at a steady speed, an attitude error and a sensor bias look exactly alike — it is only when you speed up, slow down and turn that the two stop resembling each other and the filter can separate them.

What can go wrong. Green gets read as finished. It is not: green means the estimate crossed a threshold on its way to converging, and ten minutes later it is better. Nothing tells you that, because the light does not change again. So the first data after the light goes green is the weakest data of the day, and if that is where the important part of the corridor is, that is where the weakest data ends up.

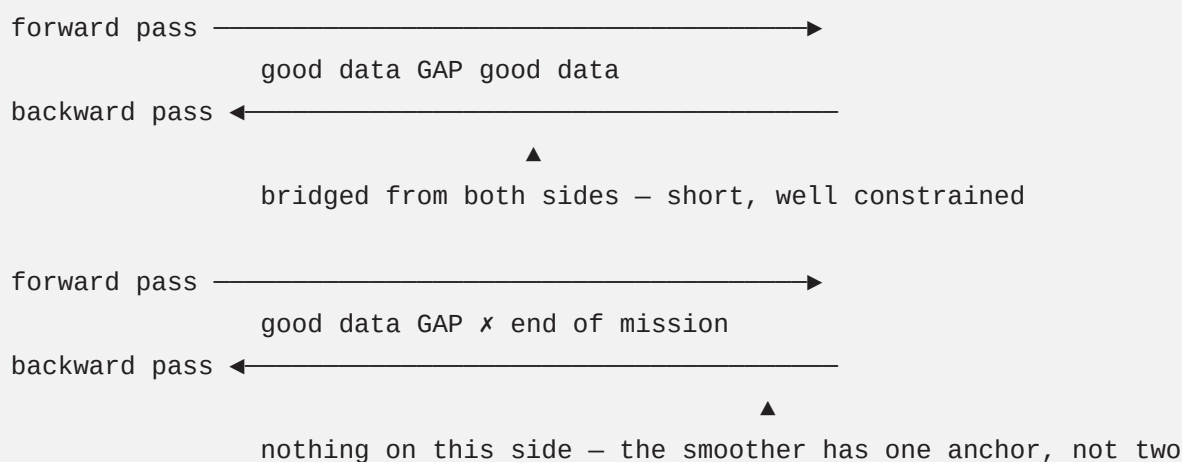
What good looks like. Open sky, the full sequence performed even if GAMS is fitted, and the first ten minutes spent on something that does not matter much — a drive to the site, a throwaway pass, the least critical end of the corridor. It costs five minutes and there is no office procedure that buys it back.

14 The Closing Sequence

The closing sequence is the most commonly skipped step in mobile mapping. It takes about five minutes, it cannot be added afterwards, and it is the cheapest quality improvement available in the entire workflow. This section explains why it exists at all, because a crew that understands the reason will not skip it and a crew that does not will skip it every time it is raining.

14.1 The reason: the trajectory is computed twice

For survey work the navigation filter is run **forward through time and backward through time**, and the two passes are merged into the SBET (§8.3).



A degraded stretch in the **middle** of a mission is bracketed by good data on both sides. The smoother bridges it from both directions, and the two estimates constrain each other.

A degraded stretch at the **end** has good data on one side only. The forward pass arrives there already carrying whatever error it accumulated, and there is no backward pass to meet it. The same is true in reverse at the start of the mission, which is what initialization addresses (§13).

The closing sequence is the reverse pass's anchor. Without it, the backward pass begins from the system's least converged state and propagates that weakness into the end of the mission — which is exactly where the smoother has nothing to compensate with.

14.2 The sequence

TRIMBLE METHOD — MX60 QSG REV B, P.13; MX60 UG REV B

1. Finish the last run
2. Drive to an open-sky location
3. **Dynamic steering manoeuvres**
4. **Vary the speed**
5. **Drive straight**
6. **Remain stationary for 2–3 minutes**, logging static data
7. Close the mission in TMI
8. Wait for the Control Unit power button light to go out — **up to 90 seconds**

Steps 3–6 are the initialization sequence run in reverse order

MX60 QSG Rev B, p.13 — manoeuvres, then speed variation, then straight, then static, where the start was static, straight, speed variation, manoeuvres (§13.1). That is not a coincidence or a mnemonic. The backward pass runs through the data in reverse, so what it encounters first is what the forward pass encountered last, and the sequence is arranged so that the backward pass meets the same conditioning the forward pass was given.

IMPORTANT

Navigation logging stops the instant the mission is closed. Closing the mission and *then* driving to open sky achieves nothing. The manoeuvres have to be inside the logged data to be of any use to the smoother.

14.3 Why it cannot be added later

There is no office operation that supplies what the closing sequence supplies. The remedies in §27 all act on data that exists:

REMEDY	WHY IT DOES NOT SUBSTITUTE
Reprocess the trajectory	Reprocesses the same observations. The end of the mission is still unconstrained
Better base station data	Improves the GNSS side where GNSS was observed. It was not observed after the mission closed
LiDAR QC	Needs overlapping scan data at the location concerned (§11)

REMEDY	WHY IT DOES NOT SUBSTITUTE
PFIX or registration	Fits the trajectory to surveyed control. Real, but it costs surveyed control at the end of every corridor, and it acts on the fit rather than the solution (§8.5)

CAUTION

The post-processed trajectory is computed **forward and backward** and merged. A degraded stretch mid-mission is bracketed by good data on both sides. **A degraded stretch at the end has good data on one side only.**

The closing sequence is the reverse pass's anchor. It cannot be added later.

Once the mission is closed the opportunity is gone, and the data at the end of the mission is permanently weaker than it needed to be. A crew that returns to site the next day cannot append it — a new mission is a new trajectory.

14.4 Where the weakness shows up

The end of a mission is not an abstract place. It is a specific stretch of corridor, and it is often a significant one, because crews naturally finish where the work finishes.

Three practical consequences, all of them reasons to look at the trajectory before the point cloud (§24):

- **A check point near each end of the delivered extent is worth more than one in the middle**, because the ends are where the smoother had one anchor rather than two (§22)
- **A Local registration stops adjusting at the outermost control point** (§21), so the end of a corridor is simultaneously the weakest trajectory and the place registration helps least unless control brackets it
- **RMS colouring shows the degradation at the ends directly** — if the last stretch of the trajectory is a different colour from the rest, that is the closing sequence talking

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

What we just did. We explained why the end of a mission gets its own five-minute routine, and why that routine is the start-of-mission routine performed backwards.

Why it matters. The trajectory is computed twice, once forwards through time and once backwards, and then the two are blended. Anywhere in the middle of the drive, a bad patch has good data on both sides of it and the two passes meet in the middle. At the very end of the drive there is no "other side" — the forward pass arrives carrying whatever error it picked up, and nothing is coming the other way to correct it. The closing sequence gives the backward pass something solid to start from.

What can go wrong. Two things, and both are ordinary human behaviour. The crew finishes the last run, closes the mission, and then drives to somewhere convenient — but logging stopped when the mission closed, so the drive contributed nothing. Or it is raining, the work is done, and five minutes of driving in circles feels like nonsense. It is not recoverable afterwards. There is no office procedure that buys it back.

What good looks like. Finish the last run, drive out to open sky with the mission still running, do the turns, vary the speed, drive straight, park for two or three minutes, and only then close the mission and wait for the light to go out. Then look at the trajectory's RMS colouring in the office: if the last stretch is the same colour as the rest of the job, the closing sequence did its job.

15 GNSS Environment and Outage Duration

15.1 Duration, not length

The quantity that determines how much a GNSS-hostile stretch costs is **how long the vehicle is inside it**, not how long it is on the map. The inertial solution drifts as a function of time.

A 300 m tunnel at 80 km/h is **13 seconds**. The same tunnel at 20 km/h in traffic is nearly a **minute**. Same tunnel, materially different problem.

This has a planning consequence that is easy to miss: a hostile stretch in congested traffic is worse than the same stretch on a clear road, and neither the route length nor the aerial imagery shows it. The time of day is part of the GNSS assessment.

15.2 The 60-second boundary in the specification

TRIMBLE METHOD — MX60 UG REV B, P.56

Trimble publishes positioning performance at **no outage** and after a **60-second GNSS outage**, and nothing in between or beyond:

Condition | Core / Pro | Premium

---|---|---

No outage (*all configurations, post-processed with POSPac, with the DMI option*)

| X,Y < 0.01 m · Z 0.01 m | X,Y < 0.01 m · Z 0.01 m

After 60 s GNSS outage | X,Y **0.12 m** · Z **0.1 m** | X,Y **0.1 m** · Z **0.07 m**

Two things in that table are worth dwelling on.

The no-outage figure is stated with the DMI option. The published best-case accuracy assumes a sensor that is optional and whose fitment on this system is not established (§9.2).

One minute of outage costs an order of magnitude. Under 1 cm becomes 10–12 cm. That is not a gentle degradation; it is the difference between a survey-grade deliverable and something else.

IMPORTANT

Trimble publishes nothing beyond 60 seconds. A two-minute outage is not "twice as bad as one minute" — inertial drift is not linear in time, and beyond the published figure you are extrapolating past the manufacturer's stated envelope.

Treat outages materially longer than 60 seconds as a **planning** problem, not a driving problem: additional control, planned overlap for LiDAR QC, a DMI if one is available, or a different acquisition method for that segment (§27.7).

15.3 The environments, and what each does

ENVIRONMENT	WHAT HAPPENS	TYPICAL DURATION
Tunnel, long underpass	Total loss. The solution is purely inertial	Computable from length and speed
Urban canyon	Not loss but multipath — reflected signals producing plausible, wrong ranges	Sustained over the whole stretch
Heavy canopy	Intermittent loss and re-acquisition, with poor geometry between	Sustained, and worse when wet
Deep cut, retaining walls	Reduced sky, degraded geometry, high PDOP	Sustained
Overhead structures, sign gantries	Brief interruptions	Seconds

Urban canyon is the one that misleads. A total outage is honest: the filter knows GNSS is absent and propagates inertially, and the RMS record says so. Multipath supplies *observations* that are wrong, and the filter has no way to know they are wrong. The TBC **Multipath** setting exists to tell it how much to distrust them (§17.3), and the appropriate setting for Parametrix's normal environments is untested .

15.4 What can be known before mobilising

Satellite geometry is predictable. The route is known. Both of the things that determine GNSS quality are therefore knowable in advance, which makes a poor window an avoidable problem rather than a discovered one.

KNOWABLE IN ADVANCE	HOW
Satellite geometry and PDOP through the window	Almanac
Which stretches are hostile, and roughly how hostile	Aerial and street-level imagery
How long the vehicle will be in each	Length ÷ realistic speed, including traffic
Where initialization can be done	Imagery — and scout two , because a lot that is fenced, occupied or under trees costs twenty minutes at the worst moment of the day

NO PUBLISHED FIGURE

No Trimble source relates a *predicted* PDOP or canopy condition to an *achieved* trajectory RMS for this system. The relationship is establishable by driving a known route and comparing the prediction against the RMS colouring afterwards (§24), and it is the thing that would turn GNSS planning from judgement into estimate.

15.5 What it changes downstream

A GNSS assessment made before mobilising is not a formality; it determines four later decisions.

PREDICTED DEGRADATION	CONSEQUENCE
Where the solution will be weak	Where control is worth most, and where check points belong (§22)
How long each weak stretch is	Whether the smoother can bridge it, or whether a remedy is needed (§8.3, §27)
Whether overlap is available there	Whether LiDAR QC is even possible — it needs overlapping runs (§11.5)
Whether any segment is beyond remedy	Whether mobile mapping is the appropriate acquisition method for that segment at all (§27.7)

That last row is the one people avoid. It is easier to collect a corridor and discover the problem in the office than to say before mobilising that a particular 400 m of it should be collected another way. The office discovery costs a remobilisation and, sometimes, a conversation with the client about accuracy that nobody wants to have.

Set by the project: *Base station strategy — own base on project control, VRS, RTX, or CORS post-processing, and at what maximum baseline?* This interacts with (§12.3): **IN-Fusion+ Single Base** requires a local base station, **IN-Fusion+ PP-RTX** does not (*TBC 25943*). The decision determines field logistics on every mission. Stated and tracked in the **SOP §8**; see also the master register.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

What we just did. We looked at what the sky does to the job: which environments hurt, how much, and what Trimble actually publishes about it.

Why it matters. The number that matters is seconds, not metres. The inertial sensor drifts with time, so a tunnel you pass through in thirteen seconds and the same tunnel crawled through in a minute are different problems. And the published numbers are stark: under a centimetre with good GNSS, ten to twelve centimetres after one minute without it. That is the whole range from a survey deliverable to something you would not hand over.

What can go wrong. Extrapolating. Trimble publishes a figure at sixty seconds and stops there, and the temptation is to assume two minutes is twice as bad. Drift does not work that way, and past the published figure you are guessing on the manufacturer's behalf. The other trap is urban canyon: an outage at least tells the truth about itself, whereas multipath hands the filter wrong measurements that look like right ones.

What good looks like. The hostile stretches were identified on imagery before anyone mobilised, each one has a duration estimate at a realistic speed for that time of day, and the segments that cannot be done well were named before collection rather than discovered after. Two initialization sites were scouted, not one.

16 Point Density and Useful Range

Two questions come up on every project — *how dense will the cloud be?* and *how far out is it good for?* — and they have different answers from different parts of the system. Density is geometry and settings. Useful range is trajectory quality.

16.1 The instrument's own numbers

TRIMBLE METHOD — MX60 UG REV B, PP.54–55

| Value

---|---

Laser pulse repetition rate, **per scanner** | 500 kHz / 1000 kHz selectable

Scan speed, profiles per second, **per scanner** | 120 Hz / 200 Hz selectable

Maximum measurement range | 150 m at the lower rate 120 m at the higher rate

Minimum range | 0.6 m

Range accuracy | 2 mm, one sigma under test conditions

CAUTION · two ways of quoting the same instrument

The MX60 specification sheet quotes **1000 / 2000 kHz** and **240 / 400** profiles per second. Those are **system totals across both scanners**. The User Guide figures above are **per scanner**, and TMI's own **Measurement Prog** and **Line Speed** settings use the per-scanner labelling (SPEC-004 , SPEC-005 , SPEC-011 ; QSG-008, QSG-009).

Do not put the system-total figures into a field instruction. A crew told to set 2000 kHz will not find it on the screen.

The higher rate costs range. 1000 kHz per scanner gets 120 m; 500 kHz gets 150 m. That is a direct trade, made at the instrument, and it is the first of the three levers below.

16.2 The three levers on density

Point density along a corridor is set by three things, and only three:

LEVER	EFFECT	WHERE IT IS SET
Pulse repetition rate	More pulses per second → more points, at the cost of maximum range	TMI, field

LEVER	EFFECT	WHERE IT IS SET
Scan speed (profiles/s)	More profiles per second → profiles closer together along the direction of travel	TMI, field
Vehicle speed	Slower → profiles closer together along the corridor	The driver

Vehicle speed is the lever that changes most between projects and the one with the least guidance attached to it.

TRIMBLE METHOD — (MX60 UG REV B)

| Value

---|---

Recommended maximum with the system operating | 80 km/h (50 mph)

Absolute maximum, operating or not | 110 km/h (68 mph)

Set by the project:. *What collection speed, by deliverable type?* Trimble publishes a recommended maximum and an absolute maximum and **no guidance relating speed to deliverable quality**. Stated and tracked in the **SOP §9**; see also the master register.

Imagery follows the same logic on its own clock: the spherical camera captures at up to **10 fps** and the down camera at up to **9 fps**, by distance or by time

MX60 Spec Sheet, p.2. Capture by distance decouples image spacing from vehicle speed; capture by time does not.

NOT DOCUMENTED BY TRIMBLE

Does the Lateral Range Limit affect accuracy, or is it purely a data-volume tool? TMI offers a lateral range limit at acquisition. If it only discards returns beyond a distance, it is a file size control and nothing else. If it changes what the scanner does, it belongs in this section as a fourth lever. The documentation held does not say which.

16.3 Geometry does more than settings

Two effects change density more than any setting, and neither is adjustable.

Density falls with range. The angular spacing between pulses is fixed, so the distance between adjacent returns grows with range. A façade at 60 m is sampled far more coarsely than the road surface at 6 m, on the same pass with the same settings.

Density falls with incidence angle. A surface hit obliquely is sampled across a stretched footprint. Road markings ahead of and behind the vehicle are hit at a grazing angle, which is why a painted stop-bar corner is a good horizontal target and a poor vertical one (§22.3).

These two effects are why *a second pass in the opposite direction* improves a dataset more than any setting change: it converts grazing incidence into direct incidence and long range into short range for the far side of the corridor.

16.4 The range specification is a laboratory figure

TRIMBLE METHOD — MX60 UG REV B, P.55

The maximum range figures apply to **flat targets larger than the beam diameter, at perpendicular incidence, with 23 km atmospheric visibility.** Range is **shorter in bright sunlight than under overcast.**

Every one of those conditions is optimistic relative to a corridor survey. Real targets are small, oblique, and frequently wet or dark. The published maximum is the ceiling, not the working distance.

16.5 Useful range is a different question, with a different answer

The scanner can return a point at 150 m. Whether that point is good enough to measure from is a question about the **trajectory**, not the scanner.

From §3.1: an attitude error displaces a point by the range multiplied by the angular error in radians. Range accuracy is 2 mm and does not change with distance. Attitude error does not change with distance either — but its *effect* does, in direct proportion.

	AT 10 M	AT 50 M	AT 100 M
Range error contribution	2 mm	2 mm	2 mm
Attitude error contribution	×1	×5	×10

This is arithmetic, not a specification. No Trimble source in the set publishes an attitude error budget for the MX60 point cloud. The published attitude figures — roll and pitch 0.005° Core/Pro, 0.0025° Premium, heading 0.015° with GAMS MX60 UG Rev B, p.56 — are trajectory accuracies under stated conditions, not point cloud accuracies at range. Converting one into the other requires assumptions this manual does not make.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Useful range is not a property of the instrument. It is a property of the job. Two clouds collected on the same day with the same instrument and the same settings have different useful ranges if one was collected under open sky and the other in an urban canyon, because the attitude solution was better in one than the other. That is why there is no single number to publish, and why the honest answer to "how far out is this good for?" begins with looking at the trajectory RMS for that stretch (§24).

This is where comes from. Because no attitude error budget is published, a useful range for a given tolerance cannot be derived from the documentation — so an acceptance criterion cannot be calculated either. It has to be **tested**, or **decided**. The decision Parametrix faces meanwhile is set out in the **SOP §17.2**; this manual does not propose an answer to it.

NO PUBLISHED FIGURE

Establishing a working useful range for Parametrix deliverables is a test, not a calculation. Survey features conventionally at a spread of ranges from the vehicle path, collect over them under known GNSS conditions, and compare. The result would give a defensible range statement for each deliverable class — which is currently the largest gap between what this manual can say and what a project manager needs to promise a client.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

What we just did. We separated two questions that get asked as if they were one: how many points you get, and how far out you can trust them.

Why it matters. Density you control — pulse rate, scan speed, how fast you drive. Faster pulses give more points but less range; driving slower puts the profiles closer together. None of that is subtle and all of it is decided before or during collection. Useful range is a different animal. The scanner will happily return a point at 150 m. Whether that point is where it says it is depends on how well the system knew which way it was pointing at that instant, and a pointing error acts through distance — the same error that is invisible at 10 m is ten times as large at 100 m.

What can go wrong. Quoting the maximum range as if it were a working range. The published figure assumes flat targets bigger than the beam, hit square on, in clear air, and says range is shorter in bright sun. A wet oblique kerb line at 120 m is none of those things. The other trap is the specification sheet's system-total pulse rates, which are double the numbers the crew will see on the screen in TMI.

What good looks like. Nobody promises a range figure without knowing what the trajectory was doing over that stretch. A second pass in the opposite direction, which fixes the far side of the corridor better than any setting will. And eventually a tested range statement per deliverable class, because right now that number is the biggest thing this manual cannot give you.

17 Trajectory Processing

This is where the accuracy of the whole dataset is decided. Everything after it either applies the trajectory or improves it — nothing else creates it.

17.1 The three routes, and the licence that chooses between them

ROUTE	WHERE IT RUNS	REQUIRES
POSPac MMS, externally	A workstation with POSPac	A POSPac licence
Process Raw Trajectory Data, inside TBC	TBC	POSPac MMS 8.6+ installed alongside TBC, with a valid licence (<i>TBC 25943</i>)
Real-time NAV	Already computed in the vehicle	Nothing — but see the Office How To

Both post-processing routes require POSPac. TBC's in-application command is a convenience wrapper, not an alternative to owning the software. There is no route to a survey-grade trajectory that does not involve a POSPac licence somewhere.

Set by the project:. Stated and tracked in the **SOP §13**; see also the master register.

17.2 What Process Raw Trajectory Data does

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 25943)

"The feature enables you to compute a Smoothed Best Estimate of Trajectory (SBET) within TBC using the raw inertial, GNSS satellites, and base station data, without having to use the Applanix's POSPac MMS application and to import the trajectory into TBC."

Run from the **Mission** node context menu. TBC loads the raw POS data automatically.

Inputs

INPUT	WHERE IT COMES FROM	NOTES
Raw POS data	POS_1/raw/ — posl_*.000, .001, .002 ...	Selected automatically. "TBC will sequentially process the entire series of valid POS logged data files starting from the first file selected"
Base station RINEX	Base/ — the .YYo observation file	Must be imported into TBC before running the command

CAUTION

Import the observation file only. The Base/ folder also contains .YYn and .YYg ephemeris files. Trimble states: **"Do not import the ephemeris files into TBC."** (TBC 25943)

17.3 Settings — with Trimble's stated defaults

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 25943)

"TBC automatically fills the below fields with the information found in the POS logged files, like GNSS/Inertial/DMI Sensors Lever Arms and GAMS Baselines settings which are set in the vehicle before the data collection. **Double check the settings values and if needed modify them.**"

Computation Mode

MODE	WHAT IT USES
IN-Fusion+ Single Base	"high-accuracy GNSS positioning using corrections from a nearby local base station"
IN-Fusion+ PP-RTX	"high-accuracy GNSS positioning globally using Trimble's satellite or internet-based RTX corrections, without the need for a local base station "

No default is stated.

SET BY THE PROJECT — ∴ STATED AND TRACKED IN THE SOP §13; SEE ALSO THE MASTER REGISTER.

The rest

SETTING	VALUES	DEFAULT
Time Start / Time End	GPS seconds of the start week	—
Initialization Mode	VNAV Gyro-compassing · GAMS · GAMS and Gyro-Compassing	Gyro-compassing
Multipath	Low (good coverage) Medium · High (urban canyon, narrow streets, dense foliage)	Medium
Antenna Manufacturer / Type	Read from the RINEX automatically	—
GAMS	On/off, with a lever arm and a standard deviation	Dimmed if GAMS was disabled during acquisition
DMI	Lever arm, standard deviation, scale factor, scale factor SD	Dimmed if DMI was disabled during acquisition
LiDAR QC (Refine with scans)	On/off	Off — see §11
Generate QC Report	On/off	—

The MX60 antenna model — check this one

TRIMBLE METHOD

"the rover antenna model should be **Tallysman/33-3970 GNSS** for an MX9 (or MX50) system and **Trimble 112735 GNSS for a MX90 (or MX60) system.**" (*TBC 25943*)

IMPORTANT

This is retrieved automatically from the RINEX file, which means it can be retrieved *wrongly* if the RINEX carries a different antenna descriptor. **Verify it reads Trimble 112735 before computing.**

An antenna model defines the phase-centre offsets and variations the solver applies. An incorrect model can therefore **introduce a systematic antenna-height and reference error into the trajectory solution**. The evidence supports that statement and no more precise characterisation of the resulting bias.

The practical point is enough: **the mistake occurs upstream, it is a single field nobody looks at, and it can contaminate everything derived from that trajectory** — the point cloud, the registration that partially absorbs it, and the deliverable.

DMI settings, if fitted

SETTING	TRIMBLE'S STATEMENT
Scale factor sign	"DMI installed on the left side of the vehicle: scale factor is positive ... right side: scale factor is negative "
Scale factor value	From "the Trimble MX Distance Measuring Indicator Installation & Operation Manual, in the DMI Scale Factor section" — a manual Parametrix does not hold (§10.5)
Scale factor SD	Default 5 % . "Increase the setting if the scale factor is not known with 5% accuracy, and set it to 100% if it is not known at all "

NO PUBLISHED FIGURE

The 5 % default is only correct if the wheel diameter was actually measured. If the value came out of a manual for a nominal tyre, 5 % is an assertion of accuracy nobody verified, and the solution is weighting the DMI accordingly.

Trimble provides the honest escape hatch — set it to 100 % if unknown. Determine which case applies before trusting the default.

Multipath

NO PUBLISHED FIGURE

Medium is the default and is described as being for degraded coverage.

Trimble's own descriptions place Low with "good GNSS coverage" and Medium/High with "a degraded GNSS coverage, such as in urban canyon, narrow streets, dense foliage."

Running Medium on an open-sky rural corridor may be a harmless conservatism or an unnecessary de-weighting of good observations. Untested.

Lever arms and the vehicle frame

TRIMBLE METHOD

"**Lever Arm** refers to the displacement between two body coordinate frames... expressed as a three-dimensional vector."

Measured in the vehicle frame, from the external reference point to the DMI wheel contact patch or the GAMS antenna phase centre, in metres along three axes:

- **Positive X = forward driving direction**
- **Positive Y = right side of the vehicle**
- **Positive Z = downward**

(TBC 25943)

The same convention governs every boresight angle in §14. Roll about X, pitch about Y, heading about Z, with Z pointing down. It is worth fixing in mind once.

17.4 Outputs, and a filename that means something

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 25943)

Condition | Output filename

---|---

Datum and epoch **known** by POSPac | `sbet_[mission name].out`

Datum and epoch **unknown** by POSPac | `sbet_[mission name]_[frame].out`

— "created, **first in ITRF00 and then in the datum and epoch of the project**"

IMPORTANT · this is the trap in this section

The second filename is an indicator, and nothing else surfaces it.

It tells you POSPac did not recognise the project's datum and epoch, computed the solution in ITRF00, and then transformed it into the project frame. That is a **processing-path indicator**, and it is the only one the software gives.

Be precise about what it does and does not tell you:

It tells you | It does **not** tell you

---|---

That POSPac used the frame-transformation workflow | That the transformation parameters were right

That an additional transformation step occurred | That the project CRS is set up correctly

Where to direct scrutiny | That the final point cloud is accurate

A plain `sbet_[mission].out` is equally not proof of correctness — it means only that POSPac recognised the datum and epoch it was given, which may still be the wrong ones.

Look at the SBET filename after every computation, and treat it as a flag for review rather than as a verdict.

NO PUBLISHED FIGURE

Establish which of Parametrix's normal coordinate systems POSPac recognises directly, and which trigger the ITRF00 path. This is answerable once and then known. (§12)

Where the outputs go

OUTPUT	LOCATION
SBET	NAVPROC/Export/ under the project folder
Processing report	NAVPROC/Report/
Backup SBET Next to MXDB (option)	Copies the SBET and a log containing the frame and epoch information used to create it into the raw data folder beside the .mxd

This manual states no Parametrix procedure. A practice covering this is proposed in the **SOP §13** ; it is not decided here.

The SBET is coloured by its own quality

TRIMBLE METHOD

"The created SBET trajectory file will be **colored according to the values of the computed RMS**." (TBC 25943)

The RMS comes from `smrmsg_XXX.out`, a file POSPac produces that "describes the accuracy of the post-processed solution and contains the position, orientation and velocity RMS after smoothing" (TBC 27248).

Colour settings are at **Mobile Mapping ► Trajectory Settings**, where **Rendering Settings** can be set to **Default** (a flat colour — red for real-time, green for processed) or to **RMS values**, with user-defined ranges and colours. Settings are persistent.

This is the single most useful QC view in the entire workflow and it costs nothing.

Switch the trajectory to RMS colouring and look at the corridor. The stretches where the solution struggled are drawn in a different colour, in plan, before any point cloud exists. That tells you where to concentrate control (§22), where to expect trouble at registration, and whether a degraded-GNSS remedy (§27) is going to be needed — while there is still time to do something about it.

OBSERVED IN THE SOFTWARE

A registered trajectory no longer matches its `smrmsg` file, so adjusted stretches lose their RMS colour and render as **Undefined RMS** (TBC 27248). §24 quotes the behaviour in full and makes a QC technique out of that side effect.

17.5 Trajectory Plots

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 27415)

"After computing a SBET with the Process Raw Trajectory Data command, the resulting plots open **only once**. The **Trajectory Plots** feature lets you open the plots without running again the command."

At **Mobile Mapping ► Reports ► Trajectory Plots**, or the command `MissionTrajectoryPlots`. It is greyed out until an SBET has been computed, and opens plots per mission where several exist.

FIELD TIP

The plots open once and then vanish, which is why people think they are gone. They are not — but a processor who does not know this command exists will re-run a multi-hour computation to get them back.

17.6 Datum and epoch

§12 covers the coordinate system decisions. Two things belong here because they are specific to trajectory processing.

The ITRF00 path (§17.4) is the practical expression of an epoch mismatch, and the filename is its only symptom.

Dynamic datum epoch selection, added in TBC 2026.10:

TRIMBLE METHOD

"When working with a time-dependent datum, you can now work at a specific epoch that is not the default reference epoch for the selected datum... **Note that this feature is intended for experienced users, as incorrect settings may lead to inaccurate results.**" (TBC RN 2026.10)

Set by the project:. *Which datum and epoch does Parametrix work in for mobile mapping, and who sets it?* Stated and tracked in the **SOP §13**; see also the master register.

17.7 LiDAR QC

Trajectory processing can take the **scan data itself** as an additional aiding sensor, through the **LiDAR QC (Refine with scans)** checkbox in this same dialog. It is a capability with a substantial hardware requirement and its own acquisition geometry,

and it is treated on its own in §11.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

What we just did. We took the raw GNSS and inertial observations the vehicle recorded, combined them with base station data, and computed the path the sensor head actually followed — forward through time, backward through time, and merged. That path is the SBET, and every point in the finished cloud will be hung off it.

Why it matters. This is the step that sets the accuracy ceiling for the job. Nothing later improves the raw measurements; registration bends the path to fit control, but it cannot invent information that was never collected. A trajectory computed from good observations, with the right antenna model and a sensible base station, is a dataset you can work with. One computed from a weak solution is a dataset you will fight for the rest of the project.

What can go wrong. Three things, and all three are silent. The antenna model is read automatically from the RINEX and can be read wrongly — the MX60 wants **Trimble 112735**, and a wrong entry puts a height bias into everything that no later check will attribute to its real cause. The output filename quietly tells you whether POSPac understood your coordinate system: `sbet_mission.out` means yes, `sbet_mission_frame.out` means it worked in ITRF00 and then transformed, and nothing else will mention it. And the DMI's 5 % default accuracy is only true if somebody actually measured the wheel.

What good looks like. After the computation, switch the trajectory to RMS colouring and look at it in plan. A good job is mostly one colour, with the degraded stretches where you expected them — under the overpass, through the tree cover — and short. That picture, available before any point cloud exists, tells you where to put control, where registration will struggle, and whether you are going to need one of the remedies in §20. It is five seconds of work and it is the best early warning the software gives you.

18 Scan Generation

18.1 What it does

Generate Scans applies the trajectory to the raw scanner data and produces the point cloud.

TMX Generate Scans RWCX

polar scan data → point cloud
 ranges + angles + the trajectory XYZ, intensity, colour, normals
 sensor-relative georeferenced

This is where the trajectory meets the measurements. Before it, the scanner data is a set of ranges and angles relative to a sensor that was moving. After it, every return has a coordinate. Change the trajectory and the same raw data produces a different cloud — which is the whole basis of registration (§21) and of Update Scans (§19).

The MX60 has no MTA stage

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 22503)

MX50 and MX60 convert **TMX** → **RWCX in one step**. MX9 and MX90 go RXP → TMX → RWCX in two, and the intermediate stage requires **MTA** (Multiple Times Around) range-ambiguity correction.

The MX60 workflow has no MTA configuration and no MTA failures. If you encounter TBC documentation about configuring a GPU driver for MTA correction (TBC 23856), it does not apply to this system. Mentioned because it is prominent in the TBC help and causes confusion.

18.2 Running it

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 22499)

Select a run or a mission in **Project Explorer** and choose **Generate Scans** from the context menu. Scans appear beneath the trajectory node they were computed from.

Generating at mission level processes all runs. Generating at run level processes one — useful when a single run has been re-collected or when testing filter settings before committing to a full mission.

18.3 Filters

The Filters pane is where most of the judgement in this command lives, and where most of the untested defaults are.

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 22499)

FILTER	WHAT TRIMBLE SAYS IT DOES
Range Min / Max	Discards returns outside the distance window
Isolated Points	Removes points with too few neighbours
Fog	Removes returns caused by fog
Sun	Removes returns caused by direct sunlight on the sensor
Reflective Panels	"Removes the noise before and after a target"
Dust	Removes airborne dust returns (<i>Product Bulletin, January 2025</i>)

Two presets are offered — **Default** and **High Quality** — where High Quality enables Fog, Sun and Reflective Panels.

NO PUBLISHED FIGURE — · —

The filter defaults are the largest block of untested settings in the workflow. Each removes real returns under conditions that may or may not have occurred.

— **Default vs High Quality.** Trimble states what each preset contains and gives no selection criteria. High Quality enables three filters unconditionally, including on data collected in conditions where none of them applies.

— **Isolated Points.** Trimble's own text contradicts itself: the prose says the filter is on, the Restore Default Values behaviour says off.

— **Reflective Panels.** "Removes the noise before and after a target." **Does it also remove legitimate retro-reflective returns from signs and line marking?** This bears directly on sign inventory and retroreflectivity work, where those returns are the deliverable.

— **Range Max.** The MX60 default matches the scanner's maximum range at the lower pulse rate. The User Guide separately warns that real-world range is shorter in bright sunlight and at oblique incidence (*MX60 UG Rev B*), so points may be retained well beyond useful range.

— **Fog and Sun.** Both remove real returns under defined conditions. Applying them when those conditions did not occur removes valid data.

CAUTION

Filtering is not reversible within a scan set. A filtered return is not flagged, it is absent. Recovering it means regenerating the scans with different settings — which is cheap in effort and expensive in time on a large mission, and impossible once the raw data has been archived and the project cleaned up (§28).

Generate one representative run with the intended settings and look at the result before committing a whole mission.

18.4 Colorization

Scans can be generated with colour from the imagery, or without.

TRIMBLE METHOD

Colour is exported "if the scans have been generated with the color option set to on" (*TBC 23339, 22501*) — so the decision made here propagates all the way to the deliverable.

NO PUBLISHED FIGURE

The colouriser offers a forward versus backward camera preference with no stated selection rule.

Set by the project:. Stated and tracked in the **SOP §13**; see also the master register.

18.5 The Results record

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 22499)

A **Results of Scan Generation** dialog records, per run: the **filters applied**, the **range**, and whether **colorization** was on.

This manual states no Parametrix procedure. A practice covering this is proposed in the **SOP §13** ; it is not decided here.

18.6 Recovering failed scans

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 28155)

Recover Mobile Mapping Scans exists for scan generation that failed or was interrupted. Treated as a recovery procedure in §26.

18.7 A hazard that lives in §29 but starts here

CAUTION — · CROSS-REFERENCE TO §29.3

Some TBC export paths do **not** export the scans this command produced.

Trimble states, identically in two export topics: with **Export timestamps = No**, "the exported scans are the ones processed with the Generate Scans feature"; with **Export timestamps = Yes**, "the exported scans are **reprocessed from the raw data** and directly written to the LAS format files" (*TBC 23339, 22501*).

Which trajectory that reprocessing uses is not stated by Trimble. Both readings are consistent with the text.

The consequence for this section: the filters you chose here, the colorization decision you made, and — critically — the registration you applied through Update Scans may or may not be present in an export made with timestamps enabled.

NO PUBLISHED FIGURE · — the highest-priority test in this document.
See §29.3 and .

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

What we just did. We combined the vehicle's computed path with the raw scanner measurements to produce an actual point cloud — the first time in the workflow that the data has coordinates. We also chose which returns to keep and whether to colour them from the imagery.

Why it matters. Up to now the project has been an index and a line on a map. This is the data. It is also the first point at which the job becomes expensive to redo: regenerating a large mission with different filters is hours of processing, and on a corridor job it can be overnight.

What can go wrong. The filters are the quiet problem. Several of them remove genuine returns under conditions that may not have applied on the day — a fog filter on a clear morning is throwing away data to solve a problem you did not have. And there is a specific worry for anyone doing sign or line-marking work: the Reflective Panels filter is described as removing noise around a target, and nobody has established whether it also removes the retro-reflective returns that *are* the deliverable. Nothing warns you; the points are simply not there.

The bigger trap is sequencing, and it comes later in the job. Registering a mission does not change the point cloud. It produces a better path and leaves the cloud where it was. If nobody runs Update Scans, the project contains a perfectly good registration with good residuals, and the data you export is the unregistered version. It looks identical. It is centimetres out.

What good looks like. Generate one run first, look at it, and only then commit the mission. A good result has the noise you expected removed and the features you care about still present — check the signs, check the line marking, check a wall at range. And when a registration is applied later, the scans sitting under the registered trajectory carry a `_reg_` suffix. If you cannot see that suffix, the adjustment has not reached the data.

19 Update Scans

Registration produces a **new trajectory**. The point cloud is untouched until this command is run. That separation is the single most consequential sequencing fact in the office workflow, and it is why Update Scans has a section of its own.

19.1 What it does

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 22638)

Update Scans regenerates scans against a different trajectory. It is how a registration (§21) reaches the point cloud.

	GENERATE SCANS	UPDATE SCANS
Purpose	Create scans from raw data	Switch existing scans to a different trajectory
Filters pane	Yes	No
Trajectory choice	The run's current trajectory	Switches between the imported trajectory and an adjusted one

Updated scan stations carry a `_reg_####` suffix — for example `Run_14_Laser Right_reg_0001 (S3)`.

CAUTION

Registration does not modify the point cloud until Update Scans is performed.

An operator can complete a registration, obtain good residuals, accept the result, and then export point cloud data that still reflects the pre-registration trajectory. **The export succeeds. The file is valid. The data is unregistered.**

This is the most consequential sequencing fact in the office workflow, and the mistake it guards against is invisible: the project contains a registration, the residuals were good, the processor moved on — and the delivered cloud never received the adjustment.

Update Scans works in **both directions**: it switches between imported and adjusted, so it is also the mechanism for reverting.

The exception.Register Run to Run has an **Update Scans** checkbox inside the command, which regenerates the Run to Adjust's scans inline TBC 25096; §21.14. That is the only place where the two steps merge.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

What we just did. We took a point cloud that had been built on one version of the vehicle's path and rebuilt it on a better one. Nothing else in the software does this, and nothing does it automatically.

Why it matters. Registering a mission improves the *path*. It leaves the points exactly where they were. If you stop after registering, the project contains a perfectly good adjustment and a point cloud that never received it — and the two look identical in every view.

What can go wrong. The failure is silent and it is common: register, read good residuals, accept the result, export. The file opens, the extents are right, the residuals in your notes were fine, and the client has the version from before the adjustment. Nothing warns you at any point in that sequence.

What good looks like. After Update Scans the scans sit beneath the registered trajectory in Project Explorer and their stations carry a `_reg_####` suffix. If you cannot see that suffix, the adjustment has not reached the data. **For the required check before export, see SOP §19; for how to verify it, see Office How To §21.**

20 Calibration

20.1 Why this section sits here

Calibration is **periodic, not per-project**. It belongs to the system, not to the job, and most missions will not involve it at all.

It appears here, between scan generation and registration, for two reasons: TBC's calibration procedures **consume generated scans** as their input, so it cannot be explained before §18; and a reader meeting registration in §21 needs to already know what a boresight angle is.

Calibration and registration are different things and are easy to confuse.

Calibration determines the fixed angular relationship **between sensors on the vehicle**, and is valid for months. Registration ties a **particular mission's trajectory** to surveyed control, and is valid for that mission only. A current calibration does not reduce the control requirement, and a good registration does not indicate the calibration is sound.

20.2 What is calibrated, and what is not

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 24886, 24868)

"A system calibration describes the estimation of the exact translation and orientation of each sensor referring to an internal virtual reference point of the sensor head. For a Trimble MX series mobile mapping system, each sensor has its individual set of:

- **Lever arms** (offsets in translation — X, Y and Z): X-axis in the driving direction to the front, Y-axis in the driving direction to the right, Z-axis in the down direction
- **Boresight angles** (offsets in orientation around the X, Y and Z axes, respectively Roll, Pitch and Heading)"

And the key sentence:

"In a calibration process, the offsets in translation are known for all sensors and do not need to be estimated while the offsets in rotation need to be."

Calibration estimates angles only. Lever arms are fixed by manufacture and are known. That is why a calibration can be computed from scan agreement without any surveyed control — the unknowns are three rotations per sensor, and they show up as systematic disagreement between overlapping scans.

Why boresight error is the error that grows with range

An error in the boresight angle of a scanner is an error in **which direction it thinks it is pointing**, and it displaces points **in proportion to range** — exactly as described in §3.

That proportionality is geometry, not a system specification. Multiplying any small angular error by any distance gives the lateral displacement at that distance, and the arithmetic is the reader's to do for the ranges and tolerances of a particular job. **No Trimble source in the set states a boresight error budget for the MX60**, and none is asserted here.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Boresight error is systematic, not random. It does not average out with more data — collecting twice as much produces twice as much consistently displaced cloud. And because it scales with range, it appears as a dataset that is excellent near the vehicle and progressively wrong further out, which reads as "the scanner is noisy at range" rather than as a calibration problem.

20.3 Calibrating the laser scanners

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 24886; ALSO DOCUMENTED AT TBC 20716)

Where it runs

"In TBC, up to the 5.21 version, laser scanners are calibrated out of the application and the calibration values are imported into TBC from a JSON format file. The **Calibrate Laser Scanners** feature allows you to calibrate the laser scanners of the MX series mobile mapping systems in TBC."

Version 5.21 predates 5.70, the oldest release Trimble still publishes notes for (§10.2). **Any recent TBC calibrates in the application.** The JSON import path (§20.5) remains available and is how a calibration moves between projects.

The acquisition geometry

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 24886 / 20716)

The mission must contain **four runs: two in one direction (forward and backward), and two orthogonal (forward and backward as well)** — in practice, two roads crossing.

Run | Direction

---|---

Run_0 / Run_1 | Along the first road, forward and backward

Run_2 / Run_3 | Along the crossing road, forward and backward

Site requirements:

Requirement | Value

---|---

Crossing angle | As close to **90°** as possible, tolerance **± 30°**

Minimum run length | **At least 20 m from each side** of the crossing

Ideal run length | **80 m long — 40 m from each side** of the crossing, "for an efficient calibration"

Overlap | Enough overlap between runs

Façades | Present in **each direction**, in sufficient quantity

Vegetation | A few or none, ideally

WHY THIS MATTERS

Façades are the measurement. A boresight error shows up as the same flat vertical surface appearing in two places when scanned from opposing directions. No façades, no signal. **Vegetation is the opposite** — soft, non-repeating returns that add noise to exactly the run-to-run comparison the calibration depends on.

Compare with the LiDAR QC pattern TBC 28972; §11:

	LASER SCANNER CALIBRATION (TBC 24886)	LIDAR QC (TBC 28972)
Runs	Four — two orthogonal pairs, both directions	Four — two perpendicular strips, both directions
Crossing angle	90°, ± 30°	Perpendicular

	LASER SCANNER CALIBRATION (TBC 24886)	LIDAR QC (TBC 28972)
Length	≥ 20 m each side; ideally 80 m total	250–300 m per strip
Scene	Façades in each direction; little or no vegetation	Structured — "a residential area with detached houses and objects within the LiDAR sensor's maximum range"
Sky	Not stated	Open sky for good GNSS satellite visibility

The two are compatible, and LiDAR QC is the stricter on length. A site of two roads crossing near 90°, with 125–150 m of façade-lined street available on each arm, satisfies both.

⚠ **One assumption is being made and should be stated.** Trimble specifies the laser scanner pattern as two roads **crossing**, and specifies the LiDAR QC pattern as two **perpendicular strips** without saying the strips intersect. Treating a LiDAR QC strip as centred on the crossing — and therefore needing half its length on each arm — is this document's reading, not Trimble's statement. It is the conservative reading: a site meeting it also meets any non-intersecting arrangement of the same total length.

This manual states no Parametrix procedure. A practice covering this is proposed in the **SOP §15** ; it is not decided here.

The result, and how to read it

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 24886)

The calibration reports:

- **Overall Overlap** — the percentage of points used against those generated
- **Overall RMS** — the average of the RMS between the scans used
- **Per-pair RMS, in Tangential, Orthogonal and Vertical**

The same three-axis convention as run-to-run registration (§21.15), and it diagnoses the same way: a large tangential component points at along-track scale or timing, a large orthogonal component at heading, a large vertical component at pitch or height.

The rule that governs acceptance

TRIMBLE METHOD

"Good RMS values do not mean that the calibration succeeded. A visual check is needed. On the other side, bad RMS values mean that the calibration failed." (TBC 24886)

This is the origin of the principle that governs §21, §23 and §25, and of the QC requirements in the **SOP §16**. Trimble states it here and repeats it verbatim in the run-to-run registration topic. It is not a hedge — it follows from what a residual measures. **A number can prove failure. A number cannot prove success.**

The visual check

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 24886)

Check **Cutting Plane View**. A plane named **Mobile Mapping Cutting Plane** is created, visible as a yellow plane in 3D View at the beginning of the first run pair (Run_0 <-> Run_1).

- Change rendering to **Scan Color** — one colour per scan
- Increase **Point Size**
- Adjust **cutting plane thickness**
- Drag the slider along the run pair, looking at the gap between the two clouds
- Then **choose** Run_2 <-> Run_3 **in the Calibrate Laser Scanners dialog and check that pair too**

Only then **Apply**.

IMPORTANT

Both run pairs must be checked. The dialog presents one pair at a time and the second is easy to skip. The orthogonal pair is the one that constrains heading — the component a single direction of travel cannot resolve.

NO PUBLISHED FIGURE

Cutting plane thickness: Trimble's screenshots show 0.030 in the calibration topic and 5.000 in the run-to-run topic, with no stated basis. Too thin shows nothing; too thick buries a real offset in a band of points.

20.4 Calibrating the cameras

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 24868, 20728)

The camera frames on an MX-series vehicle are the **360° camera frame**, the **vehicle frame**, the **oblique camera frame (1/2)** and the **down-looking camera frame**.

As with the scanners, "up to the 5.21 version, cameras are calibrated out of the application and the calibration values are imported into TBC from a JSON format file. The **Manual Camera Calibration** feature allows you to calibrate the cameras of the MX series mobile mapping systems in TBC **by entering the calibration values directly.**"

The procedure

1. Create a VCE project, import the `.mxd`, apply the SBET
2. **Generate scans from at least one run**
3. In Project Explorer select a camera under **Capture Devices**
4. **Manual Camera Calibration** from the context menu
5. Pick a position on a run's trajectory in Plan View. The camera view displays at that location
6. Enter a value in **Heading**, **Pitch** or **Roll** and press Enter — **the camera view updates immediately**

INPUT	STEP
Arrow up / down	$\pm 0.001^\circ$
Ctrl + arrow, Page Up / Page Down	$\pm 0.01^\circ$
Mouse wheel	$\pm 0.001^\circ$
Ctrl + mouse wheel	$\pm 0.01^\circ$

This is a visual, iterative alignment, not a computed adjustment. The operator nudges the orientation until the imagery lines up with the point cloud, watching it move. It is closer to collimating an instrument than to running a least-squares solution — and like collimation, the quality depends on the care taken and is not captured by any residual.

Where the values end up

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 24868)

In the camera properties, as **Boresight refinement** — distinct from **Boresight installation**, which is the as-built value. Lever arm installation and lever arm refinement appear alongside, and are equal, because lever arms are not estimated (§20.2).

20.5 The calibration file

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 22920)

"In TBC, a **JSON** format file contains the parameters **before** calibration (**Installation Matrix**) and the parameters **after** calibration (**Refinement Matrix**), of **each sensor** of the mobile mapping system."

- **Import Calibration** — mission node context menu. Applies refined parameters to the project
- **Export Calibration** — mission node context menu. Writes the refined parameters computed in TBC

The MX60 also accepts a boresight JSON in the field through TMI's **Calibration Import**, via USB1 TMI UG Rev L, p.18.

This manual states no Parametrix procedure. A practice covering this is proposed in the **SOP §15** ; it is not decided here.

20.6 The calibration record — and the date

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 24868)

The **Mission Report** contains a **Capture devices** table carrying, per sensor:

Column

Boresight installation

Boresight calibration

Lever arm installation

Lever arm calibration

Date of calibration

This is the only record found anywhere in the workflow that states when the system was last calibrated, and it is attached to the mission rather than to the system. Every mission carries a statement of the calibration state it was processed under. That is a genuinely useful audit property and it costs one report to capture (§30).

20.7 When to recalibrate

SET BY THE PROJECT — :,. ON WHAT INTERVAL, AND AFTER WHAT EVENTS, IS THE MX60 RECALIBRATED? STATED AND TRACKED IN THE SOP §15; SEE ALSO THE MASTER REGISTER.

NOT DOCUMENTED BY TRIMBLE

Does removing and refitting the Sensor Unit disturb the calibration? And what symptoms indicate a calibration has drifted?

20.8 Calibration is not validated by control

A warning against a natural but wrong inference.

TBC's laser scanner calibration derives boresight angles from **scan-to-scan agreement**. No surveyed control participates. A calibration can therefore be internally excellent and carry a systematic error common to all four runs.

The independent check on calibration is the periodic target verification in §31 — retro- reflective targets previously surveyed by total station — which is a different activity with a different geometry, and one Parametrix has not yet scheduled.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

What we just did. We worked out the exact angles at which each sensor is bolted to the vehicle relative to the inertial unit. Not where they are — those distances are known from manufacture — but which way they point, to a hundredth of a degree. For the scanners TBC solves it by driving a specific four-run pattern and making the overlapping clouds agree. For the cameras the operator nudges the orientation by hand and watches the image line up with the points.

Why it matters. A boresight error is an aiming error, and aiming errors get worse with distance. A hundredth of a degree is nothing at the kerb beside the vehicle and over a centimetre at a building face 60 m away — on every point, always in the same direction. It does not look like noise and it does not average out. It looks like a dataset that is crisp up close and untrustworthy further out.

What can go wrong. The big one is believing the numbers. TBC reports an overall RMS and per-pair residuals, and Trimble says plainly — twice, in two different topics — that good numbers do not prove the calibration worked, though bad numbers prove it failed. You have to look. And you have to look at **both** run pairs: the dialog shows one at a time, and the orthogonal pair is the one that pins down heading, which driving in a single direction cannot resolve at all.

The other failure is confusing this with registration. A current calibration does not reduce your control requirement by one point. It is the difference between an instrument that is properly collimated and an instrument that is properly oriented on a known station — you need both, and one does not substitute for the other.

What good looks like. Drag the cutting plane along the run pair and see one wall, not two — on both pairs. Residuals of similar size in all three directions, rather than one much larger than the others, which would be telling you something specific about which axis is off. And the whole thing recorded: export the JSON, keep it with the serial number and the date, and know that every mission report afterwards will say which calibration it was processed under.

21 Registration

This is the section the rest of the office workflow exists to support. Read §2 and §18 first.

21.1 What registration is, in this system

Registration adjusts the trajectory. It does not move points.

TBC takes surveyed ground control points, pairs each with a point the operator picks in the point cloud, and computes a correction to the trajectory that reduces the difference between the pairs. The output is a **new trajectory**, stored beside the imported one. The existing point cloud is untouched until you deliberately recompute it (§19).

This is the single most important structural fact about TBC registration, and it surprises people from a static scanning background. In static work, registration moves scans. Here it produces a better path, and the points follow only when you ask them to.

The three commands

They are **not interchangeable**. Each solves a different problem with a different kind of observation.

COMMAND	WHAT CONSTRAINS IT	SCOPE	SECTION
Register a Run	Surveyed GCPs ↔ targets picked in the cloud	One run	§21.3
Register a Mission	The same, with each GCP reusable across runs and passes	A set of runs at once	§21.4
Register Run to Run	Cloud-to-cloud overlap against a fixed reference run	Pairs, batched	§21.10

IMPORTANT

Register Run to Run uses **no surveyed control at all**. It makes two runs agree with each other. Two runs can agree perfectly and both be in the wrong place. It is a relative tool, and §21.10 explains where it belongs in a controlled workflow.

21.2 What TBC means by "target"

TRIMBLE METHOD

A **ground control point (GCP)** is "an accurately surveyed coordinate location for a physical feature that can be identified on the ground, e.g., a corner on the pavement markings."

A **target** is "a point extracted from the acquired scan data." (TBC 22905)

The target is **not** a physical panel. It is a point the operator picks in the point cloud, which TBC then pairs with a surveyed GCP. A painted road-marking corner is as legitimate a GCP as a checkerboard panel — and in corridor work, far more common.

FIELD TIP

This shapes control design (§22.5). A GCP for mobile mapping registration has to be something you can *find in a point cloud* at the density and incidence angle the vehicle produced — which is a different requirement from something you can occupy with a prism. A painted stop-bar corner is excellent. A survey nail in asphalt is nearly useless: it is a few millimetres across, and the cloud will not resolve it.

21.3 Register a Run

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 22905)

Prerequisites

- **At least one generated scan on the run.** The command is dimmed otherwise
- **A GCP file imported into the project** — Shape, ASCII or CSV. Imported points appear in Plan View and under the **Points** node

The sequence

1. In **Project Explorer**, select a run
2. Generate its scans if not already done (§18)
3. Import the GCP file
4. **Mobile Mapping ► Processing ► Register a Run**
5. Accept the default **Registration Name** (*RunName Trajectory*) or enter one. **This name is given to the computed trajectory** — it is what you will be identifying months later (§30)

6. Choose a **Registration Type** (§21.5)
7. Select a GCP under the **Points** node and click **Add Selection to Control Points**
8. Set **Use XY, Use Z, As Check** for that point (§22)
9. Optionally enable **Activate Limit Box** — a flat box in Plan View or a 3D box in 3D View that hides everything outside it, "to remove potential parasitic points over the target"
10. Optionally set **Activate Target-Bundle Adjustment** (§21.7)
11. Select the point in the **Control Points** list. It centres in Plan View and **Point Cloud Smart Picking** opens
12. Pick the target, read the residuals, and **Validate** (§21.6)
13. Repeat for further points, or adjust an existing pick
14. **Compute**. The adjusted trajectory draws in **blue**; the original stays **green**
15. Add or modify pairs and recompute as needed
16. **Apply**

What Apply produces

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 22905)

- An **adjusted trajectory node** nested beneath the run, beside `Sbet`
- A new **SBET file on disk**: `sbet_<date>_reg_####.out`, in the project folder, **incrementing** with each registration — `_reg_0001`, `_reg_0002`, and so on
- Picked targets renamed *RunName TrajectoryGCPName*; the updated targets carry a trailing `*`
- Trajectory properties carrying `Origin: Registration result`, `Input trajectory: Imported trajectory`, and `Registration type: the method used`

Those four properties and the numbered SBET file are your provenance record. They are the strongest evidence available that a given point cloud was built on a given adjustment. §30 is about how far that evidence travels — and it does not travel as far as you would like.

A note for single-scanner acquisition

TRIMBLE METHOD

"In case of a single head configuration (one high-end laser scanner acquisition), it does not matter which scan is used (left or right) for the registration." (TBC 22905)

21.4 Register a Mission

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 26473)

Register a Mission registers "a set of runs at the same time" rather than sequentially, and — this is the point of it — **lets every GCP be used more than once**, with different run point clouds or different passes of the same run.

How it differs from Register a Run

	REGISTER A RUN	REGISTER A MISSION
Scope	One run	A set of runs
GCP reuse	Once	Every GCP, as many times as it appears
Control list	One row per GCP	One row per GCP <code>instance</code>
Instances	—	TBC creates one per 250 m scan section whose bounding box contains the GCP
Side	—	An instance binds to the left, right, or both sides of the scan section
Default name	<i>RunName</i> Trajectory	Reg
Target naming	<code>RunName</code> <code>TrajectoryGCPName</code>	<code>RegistrationName_GCPName_RunName</code>
Output node	<code>Reg. Trajectory</code> under the run	<code>RegTrajectory</code> under each involved run
Unused instances	—	"All unused instances are removed from the Control Points list"

Why this is probably the normal case

Consider an ordinary corridor: driven in both directions, perhaps twice, with control set along it. A single painted mark is visible in four passes. Under Register a Run it constrains one of them. Under Register a Mission it constrains all four **simultaneously**, and the four runs come out mutually consistent because they were adjusted against the same observation.

This manual states no Parametrix procedure. A practice covering this is proposed in the **SOP §13** ; it is not decided here.

21.5 Registration Type — and the one that does not extrapolate

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 22905, 26473)

METHOD	WHAT IT DOES	TRIMBLE'S STATED USE
Global	A shift of the whole trajectory, without rotation . No local adjustment near control	"situations where there are consistent differences between the laser data and the ground control points. A situation in which the data can be corrected with a simple shift"
Local	Local adjustment with interpolation between control points	"suitable for a local adjustment of a run, not for systematic error along the run or for adjusting outside the ground control points set "
Global, and then Local	Global first, then Local	<i>No separate guidance given</i>

CAUTION

Local does not extrapolate. Trimble says so directly: it is not for "adjusting outside the ground control points set."

Beyond the first and last control point along a run, a Local adjustment does not correct the trajectory. The cloud at the ends of the corridor is left on the imported trajectory while the middle is adjusted — and there is no visual indication of where the adjustment stopped.

The practical consequence for control design: control must bracket the extent you intend to deliver, not merely fall within it. A GCP 200 m inside each end of a 3 km corridor leaves 400 m unadjusted at the tails. §22.6 and §22 return to this.

NO PUBLISHED FIGURE

Which registration type, when? Trimble describes the mechanism of each and gives no selection rule beyond "consistent differences." **Global, and then Local** receives no guidance at all, and is the method shown in every screenshot Trimble publishes.

Do not adopt a default from the screenshots. Test the three methods on a representative corridor with independent check points and compare.

21.6 Target picking, and reading residuals before you commit

This is where the operator's judgement enters the adjustment, and TBC gives real help.

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 22905)

Picking types

TYPE	USE
Default	Snap to a cloud point near the GCP. Not for road marks or plane intersections
Intersected Plane	Fits a plane near the rough pick and projects the pick onto it
Road Mark	Picks a point on a pavement marking edge line

Within **Intersected Plane**, a target template may be applied:

TEMPLATE	PREDEFINED DIMENSION
Single Pick	—
Checkerboard	0.500 m middle line
Diamond	0.400 m edge length
Rectangular	0.500 × 0.500 m
GV Target (L-shape)	0.080 m bolt

The Validate Picking window

Each pick opens **Validate Picking**, which shows:

- An overhead view of the projected point
- A **side view perpendicular to the trajectory**
- The 3D coordinates of the pick
- The **RMS of the fitted plane**
- **Direct residuals to the GCP**, updating live as the template is adjusted

IMPORTANT

The residuals are shown before you commit the pick, and they update as you nudge it.

That changes the working method. This is not "pick everything, compute, then discover the problem." It is *pick, read the residual, adjust, then validate* — and the operator should be forming a judgement about each observation as they make it, exactly as they would reject a bad total station shot at the instrument rather than in the office.

Live residuals update when the target centre moves (by picking a new centre, or with the keyboard arrows, including fine adjustment with **Shift**) or when the GV Target bolt size changes (*TBC 22905; TBC RN 2026.10*).

Rendering can be changed to **Gray-Scale Intensity**, **Color-Coded Intensity** or **Color By Distance to Plane**, and for Intersected Plane an **Intensity** slider reduces contrast on targets with reflective parts.

Two warnings TBC raises

TRIMBLE METHOD

One icon means "the picked point is not a 3D point (no Z coordinate) and/or does not belong to the scan of the run to register."

The other means "the picked point **does not belong to the most recent scan** of the run to register."

"In both cases, pick again a new target." (*TBC 22905*)

The second warning deserves attention. It means the pick landed on a superseded scan — an earlier generation, or one built on a different trajectory. Registering against it would be adjusting a trajectory to fit a cloud produced by a different trajectory. TBC catches it. It is a good illustration of why superseded scan sets are a hazard worth managing (§28, §30).

The 30 m rule

TRIMBLE METHOD

"The distance in a pair of points cannot exceed the allowed maximum distance of **30 meters (or 100 feet)**." (*TBC 22905, 26473*)

A pair exceeding it is rejected. In practice this is a sanity limit, not a working tolerance — a GCP and its picked target should be a few centimetres apart, not tens of metres. Hitting this limit means the wrong feature was picked.

Minimum observations

TRIMBLE METHOD

"A pair of a ground control point (GCP) and a picked target is **enough to perform the registration.**" (TBC 22905)

CAUTION

One pair is enough for TBC. It is nowhere near enough for survey work.

A single pair gives a shift with no redundancy, no residual to inspect and nothing to check it against. TBC will compute it, apply it, and report residuals of zero — because with one observation and three unknowns the fit is exact and meaningless.

How many pairs are required, at what spacing, is SET BY THE PROJECT and is treated in §17. Do not infer a Parametrix minimum from Trimble's software minimum.

CAUTION

If Registration Auto-Saving is on, picked targets are written to `Targets.csv`. Reopening the command prompts to reload them, and *"if you choose 'No', they will be emptied from the Targets.csv file and you will not be able to retrieve them"* (TBC 22905).

`Targets.csv` holds the registration's observations. **Answering "No" discards the field book.**

NO PUBLISHED FIGURE

Is Registration Auto-Saving on by default? The consequence of the reload prompt depends on it, and the answer is a glance at the dialog.

21.7 Target-Bundle Adjustment — the option whose name reads backwards

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 22905, 26473)

BUNDLE ADJUSTMENT INTERVAL	TRIMBLE'S STATED FIT
250 m acquisition intervals	"few GCPs... accuracy of the GCPs is moderate... precision in target picking is less stringent"
70 m acquisition intervals	"more GCPs available... accuracy of the GCPs is high and precise target picking is necessary"

IMPORTANT

Checking the box makes the adjustment coarser, not finer. The name implies you are turning something on that will improve the result. What you are turning on is a longer averaging interval, appropriate when you have few or moderate-quality control points.

For survey-grade work with dense, well-surveyed control and careful picking, **unchecked** is what Trimble's own description points to. This document does not adopt that as a rule.

NO PUBLISHED FIGURE

Trimble ties the choice to three conditions at once — GCP density, GCP accuracy, and picking precision — which will rarely all point the same way. The default state is not stated.

Test both states on a representative dataset with independent check points.

21.8 Editing a registration — not the same as registering again

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 25362, 26578)

Edit a Run and **Edit a Mission** reopen an existing registration and improve it "not by incrementing each time the adjusted trajectory but by **editing the same (imported) trajectory**."

Re-running Register on an already-registered run stacks a new adjustment and creates a new numbered trajectory. **Edit** reloads the original registration's parameters — registration type, each GCP's Use XY / Use Z / As Check choices, and the paired targets — and lets you add, remove or re-pick pairs, then recompute **from the imported trajectory**.

	REGISTER (AGAIN)	EDIT
Starts from	The current trajectory	The imported trajectory

	REGISTER (AGAIN)	EDIT
Output	A further incremented trajectory	<i>RunName_Trajectory2</i>
Reset available?	No — "There is no restoration when you register the trajectory of a run but only when you edit it"	Yes — restores modified targets to their initial picked position, restores deleted pairs, removes added pairs, and restores the original Use XY / Use Z / As Check choices

CAUTION

Getting this wrong stacks adjustments on adjustments. A processor who registers, dislikes the residuals, and registers again has applied a second correction on top of the first. The residuals will look better. The trajectory has been bent twice against the same control.

To improve a registration, use Edit. To start over, edit and Reset.

21.9 Judging the result

Covered fully in §23, but the governing principle belongs here because it is where the temptation to shortcut is greatest.

TRIMBLE METHOD

Trimble's position, in identical wording in two separate topics:

"Good RMS values do not mean that the calibration succeeded. A visual check is needed. On the other side, bad RMS values mean that the calibration failed." (*TBC 24886, 25096*)

The asymmetry is the whole point. A number can prove failure. A number cannot prove success.

That is not a quirk of Trimble's software — it follows from what a residual is. A residual measures the fit between the adjustment and the observations that shaped it. An adjustment with few observations, or with a systematic error common to all of them, will fit beautifully and be wrong. Only observations that took no part in the adjustment (§22) and a direct look at the data (§25) can distinguish the two.

Set by the project:. *What constitutes an acceptable registration at Parametrix?* Stated and tracked in the **SOP §13**; see also the master register.

21.10 Register Run to Run — the cloud-to-cloud path

21.11 What it is, and what it is not

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 25096)

Register Run to Run "provides a way to register a set of runs, two by two in batch mode, from the same mission or from different missions. In a pair of runs, one has to be defined as a **Reference Run**, meaning that its trajectory will not change, and the other as a **Run to Adjust**, its trajectory will be optimized with regards to the Reference Run's trajectory. As a result, a new trajectory will be created and the scan data of the Run to Adjust will be updated with this new trajectory so that the scan data of both runs will match well together."

The help topic is titled *Register Multiple Pairs of Runs*; the command in the ribbon is **Register Run to Run**.

CAUTION

This command uses no surveyed control. It makes two clouds agree with each other.

Two runs can agree perfectly and both be in the wrong place. Run-to-run registration improves **relative** accuracy — the internal consistency of the dataset — and does nothing whatever for **absolute** accuracy. It cannot replace registration to control (§21), and a dataset that has only been run-to-run registered has not been tied to the ground at all.

21.12 Where it belongs

Run-to-run registration solves a specific problem: two passes down the same corridor that are each individually acceptable against control, but that do not sit on top of each other.

That mismatch is real and visible — a doubled curb line, a wall with two faces 4 cm apart — and it is the thing a client notices first in a delivered cloud. It arises because the two passes were collected at different times with different GNSS conditions, and each carries its own trajectory error.

This manual states no Parametrix procedure. A practice covering this is proposed in the **SOP §13** ; it is not decided here.

The choice of which run is the Reference is a survey decision, not a processing convenience. Whatever the Reference Run's absolute error is, the Run to Adjust inherits it.

21.13 Prerequisites

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 25096)

In a pair, the two runs need to have:

- **At least one scan**, whatever the scan (left or right)
- **Enough overlapping scan data** along the trajectories

A useful exception

TRIMBLE METHOD

*"Missing TMX Files for 'Runname_X and Runname_X+1'" in the Status column means that no scan data has been generated... "Missing TMX files" does not prevent you from launching the Register Run to Run directly, and you do not need to generate the scans first, **TMX files will be generated on the fly.** (TBC 25096)*

This is the only registration command that does not require pre-generated scans. Every other one is dimmed without them.

21.14 The sequence

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 25096)

1. Import the missions into the TBC project
2. **Mobile Mapping ► Processing ► Register Run to Run**
3. Enter a **Registration Name**. "This name will be given to all computed trajectories"
4. Select a pair — one as **Run to Adjust**, one as **Reference Run**. They may come from the same mission or from different missions. In the pair selectors, runs are listed as `<mission ID last two digits> - Run <n>`
5. Optionally **Swap Runs** to invert the two
6. Click + to add the pair to the batch
7. In Plan View the **Run to Adjust draws green** and the **Reference Run draws red**
8. Repeat for further pairs. Pairs can be removed with –, or reordered with the up and down buttons — **TBC registers the pairs in the order given**
9. Set the **Update Scans** option (§21.15)
10. Check **Open Cutting Plane View** to inspect visually
11. **Compute**

What Compute produces

- A new trajectory nested beneath the **Run to Adjust**, named `GivenName: Runname_X To Runname_X+1`
- **RMS statistics in the Results tab** (§21.16)
- If **Update Scans** was checked, new Scan nodes beneath the created trajectory
- A cutting plane named `MissionID Last Two Digits - Run to Adjust`, one per pair

21.15 Update Scans is an option inside this command

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 25096)

- **Unchecked** — do not generate the scan data after the registration
- **Checked** — generate the scan data for the **Run to Adjust** on the adjusted trajectory, and enable the **Open Cutting Plane View** option

This is the one place in TBC where Update Scans is not a separate step.

Everywhere else, registration produces a trajectory and the cloud is recomputed later and deliberately (§19). Here it can happen inline.

The consequence for provenance is worth noting: a run-to-run registration with Update Scans checked produces a new scan set immediately, and the previous scan set remains in the project. Which one is delivered becomes a question of which node is selected at export (§29, §30).

21.16 The result — and TBC's most informative QC output

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 25096)

"TBC also computes some statistics and displays them in the **Results** tab. **Timestamps are computed every twenty meters depending on the speed of the vehicle.** For each Timestamp, **three RMS values are computed along three directions (Tangential, Orthogonal and Vertical).**"

DIRECTION	MEANING
Tangential	Along the direction of travel
Orthogonal	Across the direction of travel, horizontally
Vertical	Up and down

Cells read **No overlap** where the two runs do not overlap at that timestamp, and a metric value where they do.

This is the most detailed quality output anywhere in the mobile mapping workflow, and it is worth understanding why the three axes are separated.

An error that is large **tangentially** but small orthogonally and vertically is a *timing* or along-track scale problem. One that is large **orthogonally** is a heading or lateral position problem. One that is large **vertically** is a height or pitch problem. The three-axis breakdown tells you which part of the trajectory solution is struggling — information a single combined RMS would hide.

The same three-axis convention appears in laser scanner calibration (*TBC 24886*), so it is TBC's standard agreement metric for mobile mapping.

The **No overlap rows are information, not noise**

A run pair with many **No overlap** timestamps did not have "enough overlapping scan data along the trajectories" — the prerequisite in §21.13. The registration may still compute, on the few timestamps that did overlap. **A pair that overlaps for 200 m of a 2 km run has been registered on 10 % of its length and extrapolated across the rest.**

NO PUBLISHED FIGURE

How much overlap is enough? Trimble states the requirement qualitatively — "enough overlapping scan data" — and gives no proportion, no minimum length and no distribution rule. The Results tab makes the actual overlap visible after the fact but offers no guidance on reading it.

Test on a representative pair, varying overlap, and observe where the adjustment stops being trustworthy.

21.17 The visual check

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 25096)

Checking **Open Cutting Plane View** creates, per pair, a plane named `MissionID` Last Two Digits - Run to Adjust , appearing as:

- A plane node beneath the parent **Plane** node in Project Explorer
- A **yellow cutting plane** at the beginning of the Run to Adjust, visible in 3D View
- A profile in the **Cutting Plane View** tab, showing the points that intersect the plane

To read it:

- Change rendering to **Scan Color** — one colour per scan, so the two runs are distinguishable
- Increase **Point Size**
- Adjust **Cutting plane thickness** — "a wider thickness will typically result in additional points being displayed"
- Keep only the pair's Scan nodes checked in Project Explorer
- **Drag the slider at the bottom of the tab to move the plane along the Run to Adjust**, looking at the gap between the two clouds

This is the check Trimble says you cannot skip. Good RMS values do not prove success (*TBC 24886, 25096*). What you are looking for in the profile is one wall, one curb, one pole — not two of each, offset.

NO PUBLISHED FIGURE

Cutting plane thickness. Trimble's screenshots show `5.000` in one topic and `0.030` in another, with no stated basis. Thickness determines what the visual check can actually see: too thin and there is nothing in the profile; too thick and a real offset is buried in a band of points from either side of the plane.

21.18 Improving a run-to-run result

TRIMBLE METHOD

"You can use the **Register a Run** command to improve the trajectory resulting from registering two runs together. The improvement can be done by editing the same (run_to_run) trajectory." (*TBC 25362*)

So a run-to-run result can subsequently be adjusted against surveyed control through Edit — which supports the sequencing in §21.12, in reverse order, for situations where the relative fit was addressed first.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

What we just did. We took two passes down the same stretch of road that did not quite line up, held one of them fixed, and bent the other until the two clouds sat on top of each other. No survey control was involved at all. TBC then told us how well they now agree, every 20 m, broken into along-track, across-track and vertical.

Why it matters. A doubled curb line is the most visible defect in a delivered mobile mapping dataset. A client who cannot evaluate absolute accuracy can see two of something that should be one, immediately. Reconciling overlapping passes is what makes a dataset look — and be — internally coherent.

What can go wrong. The trap is mistaking this for registration. It is not. Making two runs agree tells you nothing about whether either is in the right place, and it is entirely possible to take a well-controlled run and drag it off position by registering it to a poorly controlled reference. Whatever error the reference run carries, the adjusted run inherits. The second trap is overlap: the software will happily register a pair that only overlaps for a short stretch, and quietly extrapolate that correction along the whole run. The **No overlap** rows in the Results tab are how you catch it, and they are easy to scroll past.

What good looks like. You choose as reference the pass with the better GNSS and the better residuals against control — deliberately, not by whichever was listed first. The Results tab shows real numbers across most of the run's length rather than a column of **No overlap**. The three axes are of similar size; one axis much larger than the other two is telling you something specific about which part of the solution is struggling. And when you drag the cutting plane along the corridor, you see one building face rather than two. Then you go back and re-check the run you moved against your independent control points, because you just moved it.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

What we just did. We took surveyed control points, found each one in the point cloud by eye, and told TBC to bend the vehicle's computed path so the cloud lands where the control says it should. The output is a new path — a new trajectory — sitting next to the original one. The point cloud has not moved yet.

Why it matters. This is the step that ties a mobile mapping dataset to the ground. Before it, the cloud is an internally consistent shape floating on whatever the GNSS and inertial solution managed on the day. After it, the shape has been fitted to points a surveyor actually occupied. Everything a client relies on — that a curb is where you say it is, that a clearance is what you measured — rests on this and on the control network underneath it.

What can go wrong. Three things, in order of how often they bite.

First, **too little control and too much confidence.** TBC computes a registration from one pair and reports a residual of zero. That zero means the arithmetic worked, not that the data is good. Second, **registering twice instead of editing** — the residuals improve each time while the trajectory gets bent further against the same handful of points. Third, and least visible: **choosing Local and expecting it to fix the ends of the corridor.** It does not extrapolate. The last 400 m sit on the unadjusted trajectory and look identical to the rest.

What good looks like. Control distributed along the whole extent you intend to deliver, bracketing both ends rather than sitting inside them. Enough pairs that removing any one would not change the answer much. Residuals that do not grow systematically as you move away from control. Some points deliberately held out of the adjustment, with residuals on them in the same range as the ones that were used. And a cutting plane through two overlapping passes showing the same wall in the same place. A small RMS on its own is not a result — it is one of four things you need, and it is the only one the software hands you for free.

22 GCPs, Check Points and Residuals

22.1 Why this section is separate

Every accuracy claim Parametrix makes about a mobile mapping deliverable rests on this section.

Registration (§21) is the mechanism. This section is about the **survey decision** underneath it: which surveyed points participate in the adjustment, which are held back to measure it, and who decides. TBC reduces that decision to three checkboxes, which makes it easy to make inadvertently.

A surveyor needs no explanation of why check points matter. What needs explaining is how TBC expresses the idea, and where its expression differs from the conventional one.

22.2 How control participates — three independent choices per point

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 22905, 26473)

In the **Control Points** list, each point carries three checkboxes:

Column | Effect

---|---

Use XY | The **horizontal** coordinates of this point are used to optimise the trajectory

Use Z | The **vertical** coordinate is used

As Check | The point is a **validation point**. Its residuals are computed and reported but **are not taken into account in the registration**

"For the selected ground control point (GCP), choose to optimize only the XY coordinates (Use XY), or only the Z coordinate (Use Z), or both by checking the corresponding check box(es)."

The validation point definition, in full

TRIMBLE METHOD

"A validation point (VP) (As Check) is a ground control point (GCP) that is used **only for measuring the quality of the registration**. In the same manner as a normal ground control point (GCP), **you need to pair a validation point (VP) with a picked target**. The resulting XYZ residual values **will not be taken into account in the registration**, which is why all the selected ground control points (GCPs) cannot be set as validation points (VPs). If you set all the selected ground control points (GCPs) as validation points (VPs), **an error will pop-up** and will prompt you to have at least one ground control point (GCP) for the calculation." (TBC 22905, 26473)

Three consequences worth stating plainly:

1. **A check point still has to be picked.** Holding a point out of the adjustment does not save the operator any work — the target must be identified in the cloud exactly as for a control point, and picked with the same care. A carelessly picked check point produces a bad residual that says nothing about the data.
2. **TBC does not permit every point to be a check point**, because the adjustment still requires control. The software enforces a minimum of one. **That is a mathematical floor, not a survey standard.**
3. **The split is per component.** A point can be horizontal control and vertical check, or the reverse, by combining the checkboxes. This is genuinely useful where the horizontal control is strong and the vertical is the question — or where a feature is well defined in plan and poorly defined in height, which describes most painted road markings.

22.3 Horizontal and vertical are separable, and usually should be considered separately

WHY THIS MATTERS

A painted stop-bar corner is an excellent horizontal target — a crisp intensity edge the cloud resolves well. It is a poor vertical one: it lies in the road surface, the scan hits it at a grazing angle, and the height of the picked point depends on exactly which return the operator snapped to.

Checking **Use XY** and leaving **Use Z** unchecked on such a point uses it for what it is good at and keeps it out of the vertical solution. TBC supports this directly. A processor who checks both boxes on every point because that is the default has made a survey decision without noticing.

IMPORTANT · control cannot be added afterwards

A point can be surveyed at any time. It can only be *used* if the feature it marks is visible in data that was already collected — at the density and incidence angle the vehicle produced, on the pass that was driven. **You cannot go back and occupy a new point to strengthen a registration.**

That reverses the usual order of work: on a corridor job the control design has to be right before the vehicle drives, not after the office has seen the residuals.

NO PUBLISHED FIGURE

Which feature types are fit for horizontal control, vertical control, or both, at MX60 point density and incidence angle? This is answerable empirically on a test site with a variety of features surveyed conventionally, and the answer will shape control design (§22.6) far more than any software setting.

22.4 The independence requirement

This is the part the software cannot enforce.

IMPORTANT

A check point is only meaningful if it was designated before the adjustment and did not change.

Residuals on points that took part in the adjustment measure how well the adjustment fits the observations that shaped it. They are a measure of internal consistency. They tend to look good and they are not evidence of accuracy.

Residuals on points held out of the adjustment measure something entirely different: whether the adjusted trajectory predicts a position it was never told about. **That is the only numerical evidence of accuracy this workflow produces.**

The failure mode to design against

A conscientious processor registers a mission, inspects the residuals, finds one check point with a residual larger than they expected, and adds it to the adjustment to bring it in. Every step is well intentioned. The result is an adjustment with no independent check at all, and a set of residuals that now measure nothing.

This manual states no Parametrix procedure. A practice covering this is proposed in the **SOP §7** ; it is not decided here.

22.5 What makes a feature usable as a mobile mapping GCP

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 22905)

A **GCP** is "an accurately surveyed coordinate location for a physical feature that can be identified on the ground, e.g., **a corner on the pavement markings**." A **target** is "a point extracted from the acquired scan data."

IMPORTANT · this changes control design

A mobile mapping GCP must be **findable in a point cloud** at the density and incidence angle the vehicle produced. That is a different requirement from *occupiable with a prism*, and it is the requirement that governs.

Works well | Works poorly

---|---

Painted stop-bar and lane-line corners — crisp intensity edges | A survey nail in asphalt — a few millimetres across, below cloud resolution

Checkerboard, diamond, rectangular and L-shape (GV) target panels, for which TBC has templates (*TBC 22905*) | Small features at grazing incidence (§21.12)

Painted arrow and legend corners | Anything that moves, is repainted, or is worn

A painted stop-bar corner is an excellent **horizontal** target and a poor **vertical** one: it lies in the road surface, the scan hits it at a grazing angle, and the picked height depends on which return the operator snapped to. TBC's per-component control (§22.2) exists precisely so that a feature can be used for what it is good at.

NO PUBLISHED FIGURE

Which feature types are fit for horizontal control, vertical control, or both, at MX60 point density and incidence angle? Answerable on a test site with features surveyed conventionally, and the answer will shape control design more than any software setting.

22.6 How much control, and where

No Trimble source states a minimum, a spacing, or a ratio. TBC's software minimum is one control pair — a mathematical floor with no bearing on survey adequacy (§28.6). What Trimble does give is two indications of the **scale** at which control matters, and one hard constraint.

The constraint: Local does not extrapolate

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 22905)

A **Local** registration is "suitable for a local adjustment of a run, **not for systematic error along the run or for adjusting outside the ground control points set.**"

CAUTION

Local does not extrapolate. Beyond the outermost control point the trajectory is not adjusted, and nothing in the software indicates where the adjustment stopped. **Control must bracket the extent you intend to deliver, not merely fall within it.**

The trajectory RMS colouring makes the boundary visible after the fact — adjusted segments render as *Undefined RMS* (§24) — but that is a check, not a substitute for designing the control layout correctly.

The scale indication

Target-Bundle Adjustment operates at **250 m** intervals when checked and **70 m** when unchecked TBC 22905; §28.7. That is Trimble's own indication of the scale at which control density matters, and the two figures differ by more than a factor of three.

The second indication is §20.4: the ends of a mission are where the smoother had one anchor rather than two, so control and checks at the ends are worth more than control in the middle.

SET BY THE PROJECT — ∴ HOW MANY CONTROL POINTS, AT WHAT SPACING, AND HOW MANY HELD

as independent checks?* Stated and tracked in the **SOP §7**; see also the master register.

This manual states no Parametrix procedure. A practice covering this is proposed in the **SOP §7** ; it is not decided here.

EXTERNAL REFERENCE — NOT PARAMETRIX PROCEDURE

The Queensland TMR *Mobile Laser Scanning Technical Guideline* (March 2023, CC BY 4.0) is a published transport-agency specification in the source set. It defines survey-grade, engineering-grade and asset-grade tiers, and for its higher tiers specifies control adjacent to the start and end of the project and at intersections of controlled roads TMR §11.

It is cited as an example of how another agency has answered — not as a Parametrix standard and not as a Trimble requirement. Parametrix's own accuracy tiers, if it sets any, are.

22.7 What TBC reports, and what it does not

TRIMBLE METHOD

Per pick, live in the **Validate Picking** window and in the **Targets** pane: **Easting residual, Northing residual, Elevation residual**, "with their corresponding directional signs" (*TBC 22905*).

From TBC 2025.21: those residuals "are now **signed** and included in **the report**" (*TBC RN 2025.21*).

NOT DOCUMENTED BY TRIMBLE

Which report? The 2025.21 release note says the signed residuals are included in "the report" without naming it. The only mobile mapping report topic — *Run a Mission Report (TBC 23991_1)* — describes the report as showing "capture devices, runs, trajectories and generated scans" and **does not mention residuals at all**.

This matters because the residuals on check points are the primary numerical evidence in the accuracy statement, and whether they can be produced as a report — rather than transcribed by hand from a dialog — determines how the record is kept (§30, and the **SOP §21**).

NO PUBLISHED FIGURE

Register a mission, run a Mission Report, and look. This is answerable in ten minutes with the software in front of you.

What TBC does not report

✗ TBC does not produce, in any captured topic, a statement of **which points were used as control and which as checks** in a registration that has already been applied. The Use XY / Use Z / As Check state is visible while the command is open and reloaded by **Edit** (*TBC 25362, 26578*) — but no report of it has been found.

This manual states no Parametrix procedure. A practice covering this is proposed in the **SOP §7** ; it is not decided here.

22.8 Control for calibration is a different thing

A brief warning against a natural confusion.

The calibration procedures in §20 use a specific **run geometry** — four runs, two orthogonal pairs, each driven in both directions, 250–300 m per strip (*TBC 24886, 28972*) — and derive boresight angles from **scan-to-scan agreement**, not from

control. Surveyed control plays no part in TBC's laser scanner calibration.

Control and check points are for registration. They do not validate a calibration, and a calibration does not substitute for them.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

What we just did. We separated the surveyed points into two groups: ones the adjustment is allowed to use, and ones it is not allowed to see. TBC does this with three checkboxes per point — horizontal, vertical, and *hold this one back as a check* — and it lets you split a single point between the groups, using it horizontally while holding its height back.

Why it matters. This is the difference between an accuracy statement and an opinion. If every surveyed point went into the adjustment, then the residuals you report are just telling you how well the maths fitted the numbers you gave it. Of course it fitted. The only figure that means anything to a client is the residual on a point the adjustment never saw — that is the one that says "the system predicted a position it was not told about, and it was right to within this much."

What can go wrong. The dangerous failure is not carelessness, it is diligence pointed the wrong way. A processor sees a check point with a residual bigger than they hoped, ticks it into the adjustment, and re-runs. The number improves. The check has been destroyed, and nothing in the software records that it ever existed. This is why the designation should be made by somebody other than the person doing the adjustment, and why it should be written down outside TBC — because TBC does not appear to report it afterwards.

What good looks like. Points held out of the adjustment, chosen before it ran, spread along the corridor rather than clustered, with at least one in each kind of GNSS environment and one near each end. Their residuals in the same range as the control points that were used — not much worse, which would mean the adjustment is only fitting locally, and not suspiciously better either. And a written record of which was which, because in two years the project file will not tell you.

23 RMS and What It Can Prove

23.1 The governing principle

TRIMBLE METHOD

"Good RMS values do not mean that the calibration succeeded. A visual check is needed. On the other side, bad RMS values mean that the calibration failed." (TBC 24886, 25096)

Stated by Trimble in identical wording in two separate topics — the laser scanner calibration topic and the run-to-run registration topic. It is the single most important sentence in the office workflow, and the whole of this section is built on it.

Why the asymmetry is real and not a hedge

A residual measures the fit between an adjustment and **the observations that shaped it**.

An adjustment with few observations fits them exactly — with three unknowns and three observations there is no redundancy and the residuals are zero by construction. An adjustment whose observations all share a systematic error fits them beautifully and carries the error through untouched. In both cases the numbers are excellent and the data is wrong.

The reverse does not hold. If an adjustment *cannot* fit its own observations, something is genuinely broken — bad control coordinates, misidentified targets, a trajectory too poor to correct, a calibration that has drifted.

A number can prove failure. A number cannot prove success.

Only two things can suggest success: **observations that took no part in the adjustment** (§22), and **looking at the data** (§25.1).

23.2 What TBC gives you, at four levels

LEVEL	INDICATOR	WHERE	SOURCE
Per pick, live	Easting, Northing, Elevation residual to the GCP, signed; RMS of the fitted plane	Validate Picking, Targets pane	(TBC 22905)
Per run pair, every 20 m	RMS in Tangential, Orthogonal, Vertical ; No over lap where absent	Results tab, Register Run to Run	(TBC 25096)

LEVEL	INDICATOR	WHERE	SOURCE
Whole calibration	Overall Overlap %, Overall RMS, per-pair RMS in three axes	Calibrate Laser Scanners	(TBC 24886)
Trajectory-wide	Position, orientation and velocity RMS after smoothing, from <code>smrmsg_xxx.out</code> — rendered as trajectory colour	Plan View	(TBC 25943, 27248)

Plus the visual check (§25.1) and the records in the **SOP §20**.

Note what is missing from that table: a single number that describes the quality of a registration. There is no registration report equivalent to a least-squares adjustment summary. The evidence is distributed across a dialog, a results tab, a trajectory colour and the operator's eyes — which is why §30, the provenance problem, matters more here than it would in a conventional adjustment, and why the records the **SOP §20** requires are not a formality.

23.3 Reading the three axes

Tangential, orthogonal and vertical appear in both calibration and run-to-run registration. They diagnose, not just describe.

DOMINANT COMPONENT	WHAT IT POINTS AT
Tangential — along travel	Timing, or along-track scale. Check the DMI scale factor (§17.3) and the time synchronisation
Orthogonal — across travel, horizontal	Heading. The hardest attitude component, and the one a single direction of travel cannot resolve (§20.3)
Vertical	Pitch, or the height component of the trajectory. Check the antenna model (§17.3) and the geoid

WHY THIS MATTERS

A combined RMS hides this. Three numbers of similar size mean random disagreement, which is what good data looks like. One number much larger than the other two means a specific, identifiable part of the solution is struggling — and tells you where to look rather than leaving you to regenerate everything and hope.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

What we just did. We looked at what a residual actually measures, and why Trimble says — twice, in two unrelated parts of its documentation — that a good RMS does not prove the work succeeded although a bad one proves it failed.

Why it matters. A residual tells you how well the adjustment fitted the numbers you handed it. That is a narrower question than the one you care about. Hand it three points and it fits them perfectly, because with three observations and three unknowns there is nothing left over to disagree. Hand it three points that share a common error — a mis-keyed coordinate, a control network with a systematic bias — and it fits those perfectly too, and passes the error straight through into the deliverable. The arithmetic is not lying. It is answering the question it was asked.

What can go wrong. Reporting a small residual as evidence of accuracy. It is evidence that the adjustment is internally consistent, which is a different claim and a much weaker one. The failure is most likely on a job with sparse control, because that is exactly where the residuals look best.

What good looks like. Two things the numbers cannot give you on their own: residuals on points the adjustment never saw (§22), and a direct look at the data (§25). Where the three-axis breakdown is available, three components of similar size means random disagreement — which is what good data looks like. One component much larger than the other two is the solution telling you which part of itself is struggling.

24 Trajectory RMS Colouring

Set at **Mobile Mapping ► Trajectory Settings ► Rendering Settings ► RMS values**, with user-definable ranges and colours. Settings persist between projects (*TBC 27248*).

This is the highest-value, lowest-effort QC view in the workflow, and it is available before any point cloud exists (§17.4).

What to read from it:

- **Where the solution degraded** — and therefore where control is most valuable (§22) and where registration will struggle
- **How long each degraded stretch was.** A short gap bracketed by good data is bridged well by the smoother. A long one is not (§8)
- **Whether the degradation is at the ends of the mission**, where the smoother has data on one side only — the reason the closing sequence in §14 exists

OBSERVED IN THE SOFTWARE

"If the mission contains some registrations then the modified segments will be colorized with the '**Undefined RMS' color**" (*TBC 27248*). A registered trajectory no longer matches the `smrmsg` file, so adjusted stretches lose their RMS colour.

Incidentally useful: this makes the extent of a registration visible in plan. A **Local** registration that stopped adjusting beyond the outermost control point (§21.5) shows the boundary directly.

25 Visual QC

25.1 The visual check

Trimble requires it and does not describe how to do it thoroughly. What follows assembles the mechanics Trimble does give (*TBC 24886, 25096*) into a method.

Cutting Plane View — checking agreement between overlapping data

The tool for the question *do two passes of the same feature land in the same place?*

1. **Point Clouds ► View ► Cutting Plane View** (it opens automatically after calibration or run-to-run registration if the option was checked)
2. Set rendering to **Scan Color** — one colour per scan, so the two data sets are distinguishable. **This is the step that makes the check possible**; in a single colour, two offset surfaces read as one thick surface
3. Increase **Point Size**
4. Set **Cutting plane thickness** (§25.2)
5. In Project Explorer, **check only the scans in the pair** and uncheck everything else
6. **Drag the slider along the run**, watching the gap
7. Optionally **Show surface-plane intersection** where a surface exists

What you are looking for: **one wall, one kerb, one pole**. Two of anything is a disagreement, and its size in the profile is its size in the data.

FIELD TIP

Drag the slider through the **whole** run, not a representative sample. Trajectory error is correlated in time (§3), so disagreement is concentrated in stretches rather than scattered. A pass that is perfect for 2 km and 5 cm out for 300 m will look perfect at every point you spot-check and be unacceptable where it matters.

What else to look at, and what nothing automates

This manual states no Parametrix procedure. A practice covering this is proposed in the **SOP §13** ; it is not decided here.

25.2 Cutting plane thickness

NO PUBLISHED FIGURE

Trimble's screenshots show **0.030** in the calibration topic (*TBC 24886*) and **5.000** in the run-to-run topic (*TBC 25096*), with no stated basis for either.

The value determines what the check can see. Too thin and the profile is empty. Too thick and a real 3 cm offset is buried inside a 5 m band of points collected from either side of the plane.

Establish working values for the checks in §25.1 and record them.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

What we just did. We went and looked at the point cloud — specifically at places where two passes should agree — using a profile view with one colour per scan, dragged along the whole corridor rather than sampled at a few spots.

Why it matters. This is the half of QC that no number can do. Trimble requires it and does not describe how to do it thoroughly, which is why this section assembles the mechanics into a method. What you are looking for is simple: one wall, one kerb, one pole. Two of anything is a disagreement, and its size in the profile is its size in the data.

What can go wrong. Two things, and both are about how you set the view up rather than what you are looking at. If the rendering is left in a single colour, **two surfaces four centimetres apart look exactly like one surface four centimetres thick** — you will stare straight at the defect and not see it. And if the cutting plane is too thick, a real offset is buried inside a band of points collected from either side of the plane.

The third failure is sampling. Mobile mapping error arrives in stretches, not speckles, because it is driven by a filter that changes smoothly over minutes. A corridor that is flawless for two kilometres and five centimetres out for three hundred metres will pass every spot check you take.

What good looks like. Scan Color on, point size up, a sensible plane thickness, and the slider dragged the full length of every overlap — showing one of everything. Flat surfaces that are as thin at fifty metres as at ten. And the ends of the corridor checked specifically, because that is where a Local adjustment stops working and where the trajectory smoother had data on one side only.

26 Imagery

26.1 What the MX60 imagery is for

CAMERA	OUTPUT	TYPICAL USE
360° spherical	Panoramic images along the corridor	Feature identification, asset attribution, virtual site visits, client review
Rear-downward	Pavement-facing imagery	Pavement condition, orthomosaics, line-marking work

Imagery is positioned from the trajectory, exactly as the point cloud is. It inherits the same errors and improves — or does not — in the same way.

OBSERVED IN THE SOFTWARE — · UNVERIFIED

Whether imagery positions inherit a registration is not documented.

Registration produces a new trajectory and Update Scans recomputes the point cloud from it (§19). No captured Trimble topic states whether station positions and panorama orientations are recomputed too.

It is plausible that they are, since imagery is positioned from the trajectory. **It is not stated, and must not be assumed.**

NO PUBLISHED FIGURE — compare a station's position before and after a registration. This is answerable in minutes and nobody has done it.

26.2 Resolution depends on the configuration

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 22501, 23888)

IMAGE	MX60 CORE	MX60 PRO / PREMIUM
Panoramic	8192 × 4096 px	12288 × 6144 px
Side / planar	4096 × 3008 px	4096 × 3008 px

IMPORTANT

Core delivers a quarter of the panoramic pixels of Pro and Premium. Any commitment to a client about imagery deliverable quality — legibility of sign text, identification of small assets, orthomosaic ground sample distance — depends on which configuration is on the roof, and Parametrix does not currently know which that is (§7.1).

A configuration note about side cameras

OBSERVED IN THE SOFTWARE

Trimble's export folder-structure examples show the MX60 tree containing **Camera 3 Back Down** and **Camera 4 360°**, with per-face `.cal` files for the 360° camera (Front, Rear, Left, Right, Top, Bottom). The MX9 and MX50 trees additionally show **Planar 1** and **Planar 2** side cameras; **the MX60 tree does not** (TBC 23339, 22501).

This suggests the **Export side images** option has nothing to export on an MX60. **Trimble does not state this**, and the option remains present in the dialog.

NOT ESTABLISHED — what imagery streams actually exist on the MX60, and which are exposed through TBC export? Run an export with side images enabled and see what appears; confirm with the vendor what the MX60 camera complement is.

Do not write MX9 or MX90 camera behaviour into MX60 procedure on the strength of a shared dialog. The option's presence in the export pane is not evidence that the sensor exists.

26.3 What to check

This manual states no Parametrix procedure. A practice covering this is proposed in the **SOP §16** ; it is not decided here.

26.4 Corrupted side camera images are exported as black

TRIMBLE METHOD

"Corrupted side camera images are exported as black images." (TBC 23339, 22501)

CAUTION

This is a silent failure. The export completes. The file count is right. The images are there. Some of them are black.

Nothing in TBC reports it, and a deliverable can pass every automated check with a proportion of its imagery blank. **The only detection is looking at the imagery**, which on a corridor job means sampling systematically rather than opening the first few.

SCREENING METHOD — NOT VALIDATED

This is not a Trimble procedure. It is a screening method proposed by this document and not yet validated.

Include a **file-size scan** of the exported imagery in the delivery check (the **SOP §19**). The logic: a uniformly black JPEG typically compresses far smaller than a valid image, so **anomalously small files are a useful screening flag** and a sorted file listing surfaces candidates without opening a single image.

File size alone cannot establish image validity. It is a screening method, not proof. A small file may be a legitimately low-detail frame — a plain sky, a blank wall, an unlit tunnel — and a corrupted image is not guaranteed to be small. Anything the scan flags must be opened and looked at; anything it does not flag is not thereby verified.

Validation required before it is relied on: run it against a known-good export and a known-bad one and establish whether a usable threshold exists for MX60 imagery.

26.5 Colorized point clouds

Colour on the point cloud comes from the imagery, at scan generation (§18.4).

TRIMBLE METHOD

Colour is exported "if the scans have been generated with the color option set to on" (TBC 23339, 22501).

Two failure modes worth checking specifically:

Colour fringing at feature edges — points on a kerb taking the colour of the road, or points on a pole taking the colour of the sky behind it. Small amounts are inherent: the camera and the scanner are at different positions and see slightly different things. Large or systematic fringing indicates a **camera boresight problem** (§20.4), and is one of the few places where a calibration issue is directly visible.

Colour from the wrong exposure — a stretch of cloud markedly darker or lighter than its neighbours, where the camera's automatic exposure changed between passes.

NO PUBLISHED FIGURE

The colouriser offers a forward versus backward camera preference with no stated selection rule (§18.4). Its effect on fringing is untested.

26.6 Privacy and blurring

TRIMBLE METHOD

Blur people and **Blur vehicles** options exist on the **Publish to TRCPS** command (*TBC 29527*), and the export commands cross-reference a **Blur Exported Images** topic (*TBC 23339, 23888, 22501, 20927_1, 21713_1*).

On Publish to TRCPS, the blur options are **greyed out until an images option is selected**, and blurring prompts to use **GPU (if compatible) or CPU** (*TBC 29527*).

The Blur Exported Images topic has not been captured. It is the one remaining Trimble topic identified as worth collecting, and it should be captured before imagery privacy becomes a requirement on a live job. It is not a gap in the technical workflow — blurring is a delivery option, not a processing stage.

Set by the project:. *What is Parametrix's position on imagery privacy?* Stated and tracked in the **SOP §16**; see also the master register.

26.7 Imagery in the delivered dataset

Where imagery travels, and what travels with it:

PATH	IMAGERY	GPS ATTRIBUTES IN THE IMAGE FILE
Export to TMX	Panoramic, side, back-facing	Optional — latitude, longitude, altitude, acquisition time

PATH	IMAGERY	GPS ATTRIBUTES IN THE IMAGE FILE
Export to TopoDot	Panoramic, side, back-facing, as cubical images	Optional
Export to Solv3D	Panoramic	Optional
Publish to TRCPS	Panoramic, side, back-facing — each optional	—

(TBC 22501, 23339, 23888, 29527)

OBSERVED IN THE SOFTWARE

An exported panoramic image's file properties show `Program name: Trimble Business Center` (TBC 21713_1). Software provenance does reach the imagery, in EXIF. **It names the software, not the trajectory (§30).**

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

What we just did. We checked the photographs: that they cover the whole route, that they are properly exposed and sharp, that nothing is blocking the lens, and that where the imagery has been draped onto the point cloud the colours land on the right points.

Why it matters. Imagery is often what the client actually looks at. A project manager who will never open a point cloud will click through panoramas, and an asset inventory job may depend entirely on being able to read a sign face. It is also the part of the deliverable where defects are most obvious to a non-specialist, which cuts both ways — easy to catch, and embarrassing if you do not.

What can go wrong. Two things stand out. First, resolution is not a property of the MX60; it is a property of *which* MX60. Core panoramas are a quarter of the pixels of Pro and Premium, which is the difference between reading a sign at 20 m and guessing at it. Promising imagery quality without knowing which unit is on the roof is promising blind.

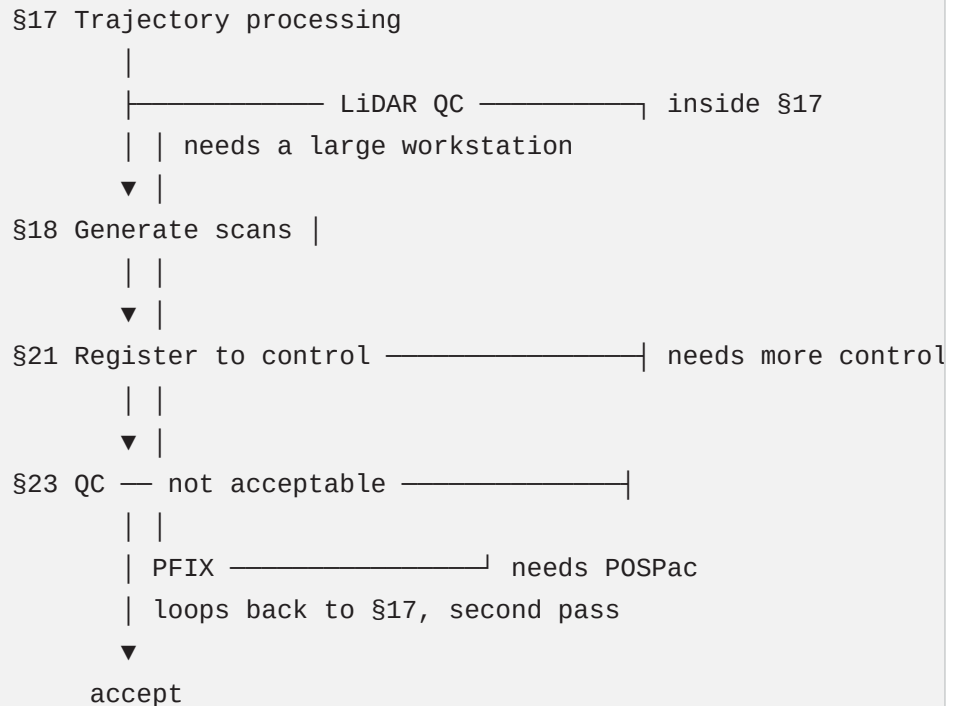
Second, Trimble states that corrupted side camera images are exported as black. Not flagged, not reported, not missing — present, and black. The export succeeds, the file count is right, and a client opens image 4,712 to find nothing there. Sorting the exported files by size takes two minutes and finds every one of them, because a black JPEG is tiny.

What good looks like. Continuous coverage with no unexplained gaps. Exposure that holds through the shaded stretches as well as the open ones. Colour on the point cloud that lands cleanly on feature edges — a kerb coloured like a kerb, not like the road beside it, because that fringing is the visible symptom of a camera boresight problem. And a systematic sample of the imagery actually opened and looked at, not just counted.

27 Degraded GNSS

27.1 This section is a branch, not a stage

Everything from §17 to §26 describes one path through the workflow. This section describes what to do when that path does not produce an acceptable trajectory — and **two of its three remedies loop backwards** into earlier stages.



Read it after the normal path is understood. Placing it in sequence would imply it happens after QC, which is true only in the sense that QC is where you discover you need it.

27.2 Why GNSS degradation is the dominant risk

From §3: the point cloud inherits the trajectory's error, attitude error multiplies with range, and **error is correlated in time rather than scattered**. GNSS degradation is the principal cause of all three.

When GNSS is obstructed, the inertial solution carries on alone and drifts. The drift is smooth, so the cloud stays crisp and internally consistent — it simply moves. Under tree cover, in an urban canyon, beneath a structure, the data looks exactly as good as the rest of the corridor and is not.

The environments that degrade GNSS are also the environments clients most often want surveyed: downtown corridors, treed arterials, under-bridge inspections, tunnel approaches. This is not an edge case.

Seeing it before it costs you

The trajectory RMS colouring (§17.4, §24) shows degraded stretches **in plan, before any point cloud exists**. That is the earliest and cheapest warning available, and it should be looked at on every mission.

27.3 The three remedies

	MORE CONTROL	PFIX	LIDAR QC
What it is	Register to additional surveyed GCPs	POSPac position fixes from GCP/target offsets	Scan data as an aiding sensor in the solution
Where it acts	After the navigation solution	Inside the navigation solution	Inside the navigation solution
Needs POSPac	No	Yes	Not stated
Needs extra field control	Yes	Yes	No
Needs a large workstation	No	No	Yes — 128–256 GB RAM (§11.1)
Passes	One	Two	One
Section	§15, §17	§27.5	§27.6

Without a POSPac licence, Parametrix has two remedies, not three: place more control, or buy a much larger workstation. That is a procurement consequence of a licensing decision, and it is worth knowing before quoting a job through a difficult corridor. (§10.3)

27.4 Remedy one — more control

The conventional answer, and the one that needs no software Parametrix may not have.

Registration to surveyed GCPs (§21) corrects the trajectory **after** the navigation solution. Where GNSS was poor, the trajectory has drifted, and control in that stretch pulls it back.

Two constraints from §21 govern how control must be placed for this to work:

- **A Local adjustment does not extrapolate** beyond the outermost control point (TBC 22905). Control must **bracket** the degraded stretch, not sit in the middle of it
- **Target-Bundle Adjustment** operates at 250 m or 70 m intervals (§21.7), which is Trimble's own indication of the scale at which control density matters

The difficulty is practical rather than technical. The stretches that most need control are the ones where conventional survey is hardest — under the canopy, between the buildings, where the GNSS you would use to establish the control is as obstructed as the vehicle's was. Control there has to be carried in by traverse or total station, which is the real cost of this remedy.

Set by the project:. Stated and tracked in the **SOP §8**; see also the master register.

27.5 Remedy two — Generate POSPac Position Fixes (PFIx)

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 24460)

"**Generate POSPac Position Fixes** is a method that lets you improve the trajectories of a mission in the Applanix's POSPac MMS software **where there is no GNSS coverage or the coverage is extremely poor**. At these locations, trajectories are corrected by measuring the distance between ground control points (GCPs) collected in the field and targets extracted from the acquired scan data. The results of these measurements are **Offset values that are projected back to the trajectories**. New positions of the modified trajectories are then exported to a text file, which is used by the POSPac MMS software to do a **second-pass on the trajectory data**."

The distinction from registration — and why it matters

Registration corrects **the answer**. PFIX corrects **the computation**.

Registration takes a finished trajectory and bends it to fit control. PFIX takes the same control observations and feeds them back into the navigation solver as position fixes, so the filter re-solves with that information available. The difference is that PFIX's corrections are propagated by the filter's own model of how the system behaves, rather than by interpolation between control points.

△ *That framing is this document's, inferred from Trimble's descriptions of the two commands. Trimble never states the contrast directly. **NOT***

DOCUMENTED BY TRIMBLE — when should PFIX be preferred over registration?

Prerequisites

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 24460)

- **POSPac MMS installed, with a valid licence** for the IN-Fusion processing methods
- An SBET processed in POSPac, or the real-time NAV trajectory "in case of POSPac processing not possible"
- A VCE project whose coordinate system matches the data
- The `.mxd` imported with that trajectory applied
- **Scan data generated from at least one run**
- A GCP file imported in the project coordinate system

The procedure

1. Right-click the **Mission** node ► **Generate Pospac Position Fixes**. *The command does not open if the mission has no generated scan*
2. Select a GCP under **Points** ► **Add Selection to Control Points**
3. Pick the target in the cloud — **the same Point Cloud Smart Picking tool as registration** (§21.6), with the same live residuals and the same **30 m** maximum pair separation
4. **Validate**. Easting, Northing and Elevation residuals display
5. Add further pairs — one pair is sufficient for TBC, and §21.6's caution applies equally
6. **Compute**. "The computation consists in reducing the global error between the ground control point(s) (GCPs) and their corresponding targets" - Updated targets are named `Mission_Name-PFIX-GCP_Name` - **A `custom_events.txt` file is generated in a `PFIX` folder under the TBC project folder**
7. Close the dialog

The second pass, in POSPac

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 24460)

1. Start POSPac MMS, create and save a project
2. Import the POS logged files from `POS_1/raw`
3. **Copy the `custom_events.txt` from TBC into the `Extract` folder of the POSPac project**
4. Open the **GNSS-Inertial Processor**
5. Optionally open **Position Fixes and Satellite Events** to inspect the fixes
6. Select the IN-Fusion processing mode
7. **All Processings**. A new SBET appears in the `Proc` folder

Bringing it back

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 24460)

1. Select the mission in Project Explorer and display its properties
2. **Replace the initial trajectory file with the new SBET** computed with PFIxes
3. **Update the scan data with the Update Scans command** (§19)

IMPORTANT

Step 3 is the one that is skipped. A PFIx pass that produces a better SBET but never reaches the point cloud has cost a day and changed nothing in the deliverable (§19).

27.6 Remedy three — LiDAR QC

Covered in §11, because it runs **inside** trajectory processing rather than after it.

In summary: it uses the scan data as an aiding sensor, generating 3D voxels matched in overlap regions, solving the constant IMU boresight angles and correcting the post-processed trajectory in position and orientation (*TBC 28972*).

What makes it distinctive: it is the only remedy that needs **no additional field control**. The information comes from the overlap in the data already collected.

What makes it expensive: 128 GB RAM minimum, 256 GB recommended, dedicated SSDs, a paging file at six times installed RAM, and the MATLAB Runtime (§11.1).

It requires overlap. "Select the runs from the Project Tree **with overlap** (parallel runs, or crossing runs)" (*TBC 28972*). A single pass down a difficult corridor gives it nothing to work with — which is a **planning** consequence (§15), not a processing one. If a corridor is known to be GNSS-hostile and LiDAR QC is a possible remedy, the overlap has to be collected on the day.

CAUTION

If a GNSS-hostile stretch planned for two passes receives one, **both LiDAR QC and run-to-run registration become unavailable** for that stretch. There is no software warning, and no way to tell afterwards except by looking at what is there.

27.7 Choosing

SET BY THE PROJECT — ∴ WHAT IS THE DECISION RULE WHEN A CORRIDOR PRODUCES AN UNACCEPTABLE TRAJECTORY? STATED AND TRACKED IN THE SOP §8; SEE ALSO THE MASTER REGISTER.

This manual states no Parametrix procedure. A practice covering this is proposed in the **SOP §8** ; it is not decided here.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

What we just did. We set out what to do when the satellites were not visible enough for long enough, and the computed path drifted. There are three fixes: put in more surveyed control and pull the path back onto it; feed the control measurements back into the navigation solver and re-solve from scratch; or let the software use the overlapping scan data itself as a substitute for satellites.

Why it matters. The places where GNSS fails are the places clients most want surveyed — downtown streets, tree-lined arterials, under bridges. This is not an unusual case to plan for; on many corridors it is most of the job. And because the failure is invisible in the data, the only thing standing between a drifted stretch and a delivered deliverable is somebody having looked.

What can go wrong. Two of the three fixes have to be set up *before* you drive. More control means surveying points in exactly the places where conventional survey is hardest, because the sky is just as obstructed for your control crew as it was for the vehicle. LiDAR QC needs overlapping passes, which means driving the corridor more than once — and if you did not, the remedy is not available in the office no matter how large the workstation. Discovering at QC that you needed overlap you did not collect means going back.

The third failure is subtler: doing a PFIX pass properly, producing a genuinely better path, and then forgetting to run Update Scans. The trajectory improves, the point cloud does not, and the file you deliver is the one you started with.

What good looks like. The hostile stretches were identified from a desk review before anyone drove, the mitigation was chosen then, and the field work was planned around it. After processing, the trajectory RMS picture shows short degraded stretches where you expected them. Independent check points in those stretches — and there should be some, specifically there — come back in the same range as the ones in the open. And if none of that could be arranged, somebody said so early enough that the client could choose a different approach for that 400 m rather than receiving it quietly mixed in with the rest.

28 Cleanup Mobile Mapping Mission

CAUTION

Cleanup Mobile Mapping Mission is destructive and cannot be undone.

It permanently removes registrations, trajectories and scan sets from the project, keeping only the most recent. Trimble states: *"Please, have a backup copy of your project prior performing the operation, it cannot be undone."* (TBC 26466)

Do not run this command until §28.4 has been decided by Parametrix.

28.1 What it does

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 26466)

"The feature enables you to cleanup your project by **keeping the most recent registration (and related scans), and trajectory consistent with the latest version of navigation and trajectory information file (SBET or NAV)**. This feature can be run at the end of the data preparation process (registration, colorization, etc.), it allows you to **share a light project**, before moving on to a feature extraction phase. Please, have a backup copy of your project prior performing the operation, it cannot be undone."

Run from the **Mission** node context menu. That is the entire published procedure — the topic is four sentences long.

28.2 Why the command exists, and why it is genuinely useful

A mission that has been through several registration attempts accumulates layers. Each registration produces a trajectory node and a numbered SBET on disk; each Update Scans produces a scan set beneath it (§19, §21.3). A project with four registration attempts holds four trajectories and up to four full scan sets of the same data.

That is large, slow to open, and confusing to hand to someone else. Cleanup reduces it to one answer.

There is a real quality argument for it, not just a disk-space one. After Cleanup, the project contains exactly one trajectory and one set of scans, so **the question "which trajectory produced this cloud?" has only one possible answer.** Before Cleanup, a person exporting from the project can select the wrong node and never know (§29, §30).

Cleanup makes the deliverable unambiguous. It does so by destroying the alternatives.

28.3 What it removes, and why that matters

The command keeps the most recent registration and removes the rest. What is removed:

REMOVED	WHY IT MATTERED
Earlier registration trajectories	The record that earlier attempts existed, and what they produced
Their scan sets	The data those attempts produced
The sequence itself	That there were three attempts before this one

IMPORTANT

The evidence destroyed is the audit trail, not the deliverable.

Consider a reviewer, or an expert in a dispute, asking a reasonable question: *was this result arrived at directly, or was it the fourth attempt, and what did the first three produce?*

Before Cleanup, the project answers that: the numbered `sbt_<date>_reg_####.out` files are still on disk, the trajectory nodes still carry `Origin: Registration result` and their input trajectory and registration type (§21.3), and the sequence is legible.

After Cleanup, the project shows one registration and no history. **Nothing indicates that anything was removed.**

This is not an accusation of bad practice — iterating a registration is normal and proper work. It is an observation that Cleanup removes the ability to demonstrate what was done, at exactly the moment the project is being prepared to hand to someone else.

On the numbered SBET files

OBSERVED IN THE SOFTWARE

The registered SBETs are written **to the project folder on disk**, not inside the TBC database (*TBC 22905, 26473*). Trimble does not state whether Cleanup deletes them or only removes the project's references to them.

NO PUBLISHED FIGURE — list the project folder before and after Cleanup and compare. If the files survive, they are a partial audit trail that outlives the operation; if they do not, the record is gone entirely. **This materially changes what must be archived first.**

28.4 The Parametrix decision

SET BY THE PROJECT — :,. STATED AND TRACKED IN THE SOP §18; SEE ALSO THE MASTER REGISTER.

28.5 What Trimble recommends, precisely

Stated carefully, because the gap matters.

TRIMBLE METHOD

Trimble recommends **one** thing before Cleanup: **"have a backup copy of your project."** (*TBC 26466*)

No captured Trimble topic recommends exporting, reporting, archiving or otherwise recording registration information before Cleanup. No topic links Cleanup to the Mission Report, to `Targets.csv`, to the numbered SBET files, or to any export.

No vendor-prescribed preservation step was found beyond the project backup.

That recommendation is adequate **on its own terms** — a full project backup preserves everything, including the history. It is not a records requirement, it does not survive being skipped, and it says nothing about where the backup lives, how long it is kept, or whether anyone can find it in three years.

28.6 A recordkeeping framework, offered for decision

This manual states no Parametrix procedure. A practice covering this is proposed in the **SOP §18** ; it is not decided here.

28.7 The relationship to provenance

Cleanup is the sharpest instance of the problem §30 is about.

The provenance evidence inside a TBC project is genuinely good — trajectory properties naming the origin, the input trajectory and the registration type; numbered SBET files; scans nested beneath the trajectory that produced them; a `_reg_####` station suffix (§21.3, §19).

IMPORTANT PROVENANCE LIMITATION. Exported mobile mapping data may retain coordinate, timing, and in some formats trajectory information, but **the captured Trimble documentation does not establish that the output uniquely identifies the adjusted trajectory or registration result used to create it (§30).**

The two findings compound. Cleanup reduces the registration history available in the project; export is not documented as providing unique registration lineage. **A LAS point cloud exported after Cleanup may retain spatial and point-level metadata, but the captured Trimble documentation does not establish that it preserves sufficient registration and trajectory lineage to reconstruct how the final cloud was produced.**

The practical concern is therefore not literally "no history." It is that **the deliverable may not contain enough documented provenance to reconstruct its processing history independently of the TBC project and Parametrix records.**

That is not an argument against Cleanup. It is the reason §28.4 remains a Parametrix decision, and the reason §28.6 steps 2–6 are proposed to happen first.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

What we just did. We looked at a command that tidies a finished project by throwing away every registration attempt except the last one, along with the point clouds those attempts produced. It cannot be undone. Trimble's entire published guidance on it is four sentences, one of which says to back up first.

Why it matters. Working on a difficult corridor, you will register, look at the result, change something, and register again. That is normal, careful work — it is what an adjustment looks like when you are paying attention. By the end, the project holds several versions of the same data, it is enormous, and it is genuinely confusing for whoever picks it up next. Cleanup is the obvious answer, and it is a reasonable one.

What can go wrong. What it removes is not the deliverable. It is the ability to show how you got there. Before Cleanup, anyone can open the project and see that there were four attempts, what each produced, and which one was kept. After it, there is one result and no indication that anything else ever existed. Nobody has done anything wrong — but if a reviewer asks how the number was arrived at, the honest answer is now "from memory."

This matters more than it would elsewhere because of §30: almost none of that history leaves the project when you export anyway. So the project file is where the evidence lives, and Cleanup is the thing that thins it, at the exact moment the job is being wrapped up and handed on.

What good looks like. Cleanup is not the enemy. Running it blind is. A sound sequence is: finish QC, get the result accepted, run the Mission Report and keep it, write down which points were control and which were checks and what the residuals were, keep the small files — the picked targets, the numbered trajectory files, the calibration — take the backup Trimble asks for and put it somewhere the company can find it in three years, get whoever is supposed to authorise it to authorise it, and then run the command. Ten minutes and a few megabytes, and the deliverable can still account for itself.

29 Export

29.1 Export is a QA/QC step, not a file conversion

By the time a processor reaches this section the analytical work is done. It is tempting to treat what follows as mechanical.

It is not. Export is the last point at which the project and the deliverable can diverge, and several documented ways exist for them to do so silently:

- The scans exported may not be the registered ones (§29.2)
- The scans exported may not be the scans TBC generated at all (§29.3)
- Coordinates may be grid or ground, and one of those does not tell you its own scale factor (§29.5)
- Imagery may be present and black (§26.4)
- A selection drawn in a view may span scans built on different trajectories (§29.4)

Every one of those produces a file that opens correctly, looks right, and is wrong.

29.2 QC CHECK — CONFIRM SCANS WERE UPDATED AFTER REGISTRATION BEFORE EXPORT

CAUTION — · THE MOST CONSEQUENTIAL CHECK IN THIS SECTION

Registration does not modify the point cloud until Update Scans is performed (§19, §21).

An operator can complete a registration, obtain good residuals, accept the result, and then **export point cloud data that still reflects the pre-registration trajectory**. The export succeeds. The file is valid. The data is unregistered.

Nothing in the export dialog references the registration state.

How to verify, using documented evidence

TRIMBLE METHOD

Evidence | What it shows | Source

---|---|---

Scans are nested beneath the trajectory they were computed from in Project Explorer | Scans under `Reg. Trajectory` / `RegTrajectory` were computed against it; scans under `Sbet` were not | (TBC 22638, 22905, 26473)

Updated scan stations carry a `_reg_####` suffix — e.g. `Run_14_Laser Right_reg_0001 (S3)` | That station was produced by Update Scans against a registered trajectory | (TBC 22638)

The adjusted trajectory's properties — `Origin: Registration result`, `Input trajectory`, `Registration type` | Which trajectory is the registered one | (TBC 22905, 26473)

Registered segments render in the "Undefined RMS" colour | Which stretches of trajectory an adjustment actually affected | (TBC 27248)

This manual states no Parametrix procedure. A practice covering this is proposed in the **SOP §19** ; it is not decided here.

NO PUBLISHED FIGURE

Establish the reliable verification method for each export path. Tree position and the station suffix are evidence *inside the project*. What is **not** established is how an export dialog resolves its selection — in particular:

- Whether the **Mobile Mapping tab** exporters, which select by run, take the currently active trajectory or a specific one
- Whether the **Point Cloud tab** exporters, which select by region or by a rectangle drawn in a view (§29.4), can be made to respect a trajectory at all

Until tested, the only defensible verification is the project-side one above, performed immediately before export and recorded.

29.3 Export timestamps — an unresolved question about what is exported

TRIMBLE METHOD

Stated in identical wording in two export topics (*TBC 23339, 22501*):

"If the **TIMESTAMP** option has been set to **No**, the exported scans are **the ones processed with the Generate Scans feature**, and the color information will be exported if the generated scans have been processed with the color option set to on.

If the **TIMESTAMP** option has been set to **Yes**, the exported scans are **reprocessed from the raw data** and directly written to the LAS format files, the color information will be exported in the LAS format files."

NOT DOCUMENTED BY TRIMBLE

When Export timestamps causes TBC to reprocess from the raw source data, which trajectory is used for that reprocessing?

The captured documentation does not establish this. Trimble states that reprocessing occurs and does not state what it reprocesses against. Both readings — the mission's currently applied trajectory, or the originally imported one — are consistent with the wording.

No speculation is offered here.

NO PUBLISHED FIGURE · — the highest-priority test in this document

Export the same registered run twice, once with timestamps off and once on, and compare the point geometry.

Why it is the highest priority: every quality step in the workflow — registration, Update Scans, filtering, colorization — acts on the **generated** scans. If reprocessing does not reflect the registered trajectory, then a documented, innocuous-sounding export option can deliver data that was never the data that was checked.

Until and the vendor question are resolved:

SET BY THE PROJECT — ∴ MAY EXPORTS BE MADE WITH EXPORT TIMESTAMPS ENABLED BEFORE THIS BEHAVIOUR IS ESTABLISHED? STATED AND TRACKED IN THE SOP §19; SEE ALSO THE MASTER REGISTER.

29.4 Two export tabs that behave differently

TRIMBLE METHOD

Mobile mapping exporters: **Home ► Data Exchange ► Export ► Mobile Mapping tab**. "A list of available exporters displays" (*TBC 23339, 23888, 22501*).

Generic point cloud exporters: **Home ► Data Exchange ► Export ► Point Cloud tab** (*TBC 11769*).

	MOBILE MAPPING TAB	POINT CLOUD TAB
Selection	By run, from Project Explorer or Plan View	By point cloud region, or a Rectangle / Polygon Select drawn in a graphic view
Run-aware	Yes	No
Imagery	Yes, per exporter	No

IMPORTANT

The Point Cloud tab exporters do not select by run or by trajectory. Trimble's step is to "select the region(s) you want to export in the Project Explorer or graphic view", or draw a rectangle or polygon (*TBC 11769*).

⚠ **OBSERVED IN THE SOFTWARE — assessment, flagged** · Nothing in the command ties the export to a trajectory. A rectangle drawn across a view could, in principle, span scans generated from different trajectories. **Whether TBC prevents, warns about, or silently permits this is not stated.**

NO PUBLISHED FIGURE — draw a selection across scans from two trajectories and observe.

29.5 Coordinate handling — common to the point cloud exporters

TRIMBLE METHOD — (TBC 11769, 27279)

Identical wording appears in both the generic exporter and the classified-regions exporter, so this is TBC's standard point-cloud export behaviour rather than a mobile mapping special case.

SETTING	BEHAVIOUR
Scaling: Grid	Points expressed in the current projected coordinate system, with the current combined scale factor. "An associated.txt file is also created to specify the coordinate system and scale factor used." Trimble warns: <i>"re-importing this file into TBC may cause some inconsistencies due to a double-scaling effect"</i>
Scaling: Ground	Points exported as ground coordinates "as they were measured in the field, independent of the coordinate system used", scaled from the 0,0 origin by the average combined scale factor. "The scale factor is not exposed during export when this option is selected" — recoverable only by exporting to grid and reading the <code>.txt</code>
Applicability	Selectable for e57, LAS, LAZ, POD, PTS, RCP. TDX and PTX are always ground-based
ECEF export	LAS or LAZ in ground-based scaling "that includes the project's global coordinate system information"

IMPORTANT

A ground-scaled export does not carry a record of the scale factor it used. For a surveyor this is a familiar grid-versus-ground question with an unfamiliar wrinkle: the file cannot tell the recipient which it is, and one of the two options actively withholds the number needed to convert.

The grid-scaled `.txt` sidecar and the ECEF option are the two documented ways to make an exported cloud self-describing about its coordinate frame.

Neither says anything about the trajectory (§30).

29.6 The MX60 export paths

Six documented paths. **No preference between them is expressed or implied here — the choice of deliverable format is a project and client matter that Parametrix has not decided.**

SET BY THE PROJECT — ∴ STATED AND TRACKED IN THE SOP §19; SEE ALSO THE MASTER REGISTER.

29.6.1 Export to LAS (Trajectory Split) — classified point cloud regions

(TBC 27279) **Mobile Mapping tab** Prerequisite: run **Extract Classified Point Cloud** in *Point Clouds* ► *Regions* first.

What leaves TBC	Classified point cloud regions of one run, as LAS. "The classification code is added to the exported points"
------------------------	--

Trajectory geometry	No
Specific trajectory identified	No
Coordinate system	Grid or ground per §29.5; <code>.txt</code> sidecar on grid
Timing	LAS point records per §29.7
Imagery	None
Sidecars	The scaling <code>.txt</code>

Settings (TBC 27279):

SETTING	BEHAVIOUR
Splitting distance	"a value in meter multiple of 250"
Export both lasers in the same file	Yes merges left and right. "You need to select at least one laser to export"
Export laser left / right	Independent Yes/No
Split into files	Splits the LAS per the Splitting Distance
Sample points	"random sampling be performed on the exported point cloud regions", with a target Number of points
Format	LAS 1.2 or 1.4
Export unit	Unit of distance in the file
Use inspection colors	Exports Scan Inspection heat-map colours instead of true colour

NO PUBLISHED FIGURE

Sample points performs *random* sampling to a fixed point count. On a survey deliverable that is a destructive thinning with no documented spatial rule — no minimum spacing, no preservation of edges or breaklines. Its default state is not stated.

Provenance implication: the exporter is named *Trajectory Split*, and splits by distance along the trajectory. Despite the name, **no trajectory information is documented as accompanying the output.**

29.6.2 Export to TMX

(TBC 22501)Mobile Mapping tab

What leaves TBC	Panoramic images, side camera images, laser point clouds and trajectory
Trajectory geometry	YES — "The trajectory file is created once for all devices . It resides in a folder under the Mission folder"
Specific trajectory identified	Not documented
Coordinate system	Per §29.5. " For the MX9 Export to TMX, the user must use a coordinate system without Geoid " — <i>stated for the MX9 only; whether it applies to the MX60 is not stated</i>
Timing	Export timestamps option — see §29.3
Imagery	Panoramic (Pano), side (Sideview, Planar 1/2), back-facing (Planar 3); optional GPS attributes in the image files
Sidecars	<code>reference.csv</code>

Output structure: a **Mission folder** plus one folder per device, with `laser`, `panorama`, `planar*` and `trajectory` sub-folders. The MX60 example is illustrated in Trimble's topic.

Provenance implication: this is one of two paths on which **trajectory geometry accompanies the deliverable**. A run carrying both an imported `Sbet` and a registered trajectory has two candidates, and **the topic does not state which is written**.

NOT DOCUMENTED BY TRIMBLE — which trajectory does the TMX export write when several exist under a run?**NO PUBLISHED FIGURE**

29.6.3 Export to TopoDot

(TBC 23339)Mobile Mapping tab

What leaves TBC	Panoramic images, side camera images, laser point clouds — as a <i>Raw Project Data</i> folder with <i>Image Project</i> and <i>LAS Files</i> sub-folders
Trajectory geometry	No
Specific trajectory identified	No

Coordinate system	Per §29.5
Timing	Export timestamps option — see §29.3
Imagery	Cubical images from the panoramic and side cameras, one set per camera per run
Sidecars	<code>.iprj</code> image project, <code>.lst</code> containing all image position and orientation, <code>.cal</code> camera models — one per camera

Prerequisites (*TBC 23339*): "You need to first generate scans from the raw data before exporting them to the TopoDot software. Otherwise, nothing will be exported."

And: **"You must close all run views prior to export. Otherwise, a warning message will pop up."****LAS files:** "a couple of 1.4 LAS format files, one couple per run."

Provenance implication: the `.lst` file carries **image position and orientation**, which is trajectory-derived information at the station level. **It is not documented as identifying the trajectory it came from.**

29.6.4 Export to Solv3D

(*TBC 23888*)**Mobile Mapping tab**

What leaves TBC	Panoramic images and laser point clouds
Trajectory geometry	No
Specific trajectory identified	No
Coordinate system	Per §29.5
Timing	Trimble recommends No — "Solv3D does not need the Timestamps information. Trimble recommends turning this option to No"
Imagery	Panoramic only, in a <code>Panorama</code> folder; a <code>reference.csv</code> alongside "which contains Roll, Pitch and Yaw information and X, Y, Z as well"
Sidecars	<code>reference.csv</code>

Output: a folder named for the mission, with `Lasers` and `Panorama` sub-folders. LAS 1.4, "one couple per run in case of a single scanner system and two when a double laser system is used."

Note the interaction. Trimble's recommendation to disable timestamps here has a second effect it does not mention: per §29.3, timestamps off means the **generated** scans are exported rather than reprocessed ones. On this path the recommended setting is also the one that preserves the processing you performed.

29.6.5 Generic Point Cloud Export

(TBC 11769)Point Cloud tab

What leaves TBC	Point cloud only, in <code>.e57</code> (plain or structured), <code>.las</code> , <code>.laz</code> , <code>.pod</code> , <code>.pts</code> , <code>.ptx</code> , <code>.rcp</code> , <code>.tdx</code>
Trajectory geometry	No
Specific trajectory identified	No
Coordinate system	Per §29.5, including the ECEF option
Timing	LAS point records per §29.7
Imagery	None
Sidecars	The scaling <code>.txt</code>
Split	<i>By station</i> — a separate LAS per scan station; <i>None</i> — a single LAS from all stations

This is the path most likely to be used for an ordinary LAS or E57 deliverable, and it is the one with the least documented provenance and no run awareness (§29.4).

29.6.6 Publish to TRCPS

(TBC 29527)Home ► Data Exchange ► Publish to TRCPS, then the **Mobile Mapping** tab

Uploads to a **Trimble Connect** project via the **Trimble Desktop Utility (TDU)**, installed with TBC. Requires a **Trimble ID**; uploads consume the account's Trimble Connect storage quota.

What leaves TBC	Point cloud, trajectories , and optionally imagery
Trajectory geometry	YES, MANDATORY — "By default, mobile mapping point cloud and trajectories will be automatically exported "
Specific trajectory identified	Not documented
Selection	Run-aware — an individual run, multiple runs (Shift/Ctrl+Click), or the entire mission (Ctrl+A). The selection must include scan data; if not, Trimble says run Generate Scans first
Imagery	Publish panoramic / side / back-facing images, each optional
Privacy	Blur people, Blur vehicles — greyed out until an images option is selected; prompts for GPU (if compatible) or CPU
In the delivered dataset	The 3D+ View offers 3D, Map, Image and Panorama modes; in 3D and Panorama, "trajectories and camera markers can be included or hidden as needed"

Provenance implication: the trajectory is **not optional** on this path — the publishing options govern imagery only — and it is a first-class, viewable object in the delivered dataset. **Which trajectory is published when several exist under a run is not documented.**

NOT DOCUMENTED BY TRIMBLENO PUBLISHED FIGURE

OBSERVED IN THE SOFTWARE · Trimble Connect's **UK region** is currently unavailable for Publish to TRCPS and Trimble Mobile Mapping data (*TBC RN 2026.10*). Not applicable to Parametrix, but it confirms Publish to TRCPS is a Connected Workspace function.

29.7 Summary — what is documented as leaving TBC

PATH	TRAJECTORY GEOMETRY TRAVELS?	SPECIFIC TRAJECTORY IDENTIFIED?
Classified LAS, Trajectory Split	No	No
Export to TMX	Yes	Not documented
TopoDot	No	No

PATH	TRAJECTORY GEOMETRY TRAVELS?	SPECIFIC TRAJECTORY IDENTIFIED?
Solv3D	No	No
Generic Point Cloud Export	No	No
Publish to TRCPS	Yes, mandatory	Not documented

Metadata documented as travelling, where applicable

METADATA	WHERE
Coordinate system and scale factor , in a <code>.txt</code> sidecar	Any grid-scaled point cloud export (<i>TBC 11769, 27279</i>)
Project global coordinate system , embedded	ECEF option, LAS/LAZ (<i>TBC 11769</i>)
GPS Time per point	LAS exports with timestamps on. "According to the ASPRS LAS 1.4 specification, the Timestamp information refers to the GPS Time in the point records, i.e., standard GPS Time (satellite GPS Time) minus 1 billion of seconds. The origin of standard GPS Time is defined as midnight of the morning of January 6, 1980" (<i>TBC 23339, 22501</i>)
Image position and orientation	TopoDot <code>.lst</code> ; Solv3D <code>reference.csv</code> (Roll, Pitch, Yaw, X, Y, Z)
Latitude, longitude, altitude, acquisition time in image files	Where GPS attributes are enabled
<code>Program name: Trimble Business Center</code> in image EXIF	(<i>TBC 21713_1</i>)
Trajectory geometry	TMX export; Publish to TRCPS

IMPORTANT — PROVENANCE LIMITATION

Exported mobile mapping data may retain coordinate, timing, and in some formats trajectory information, but the captured Trimble documentation does not establish that the output uniquely identifies the adjusted trajectory or registration result used to create it.

A further limit on that statement: **Trimble's help topics describe dialogs, options and output structures. They do not exhaustively enumerate LAS header fields or VLR content.** Something may be written that the documentation does not mention.

This is therefore a **software-behaviour testing question**, not an unresolved documentation research question. All known MX60 export and publish paths have been reviewed. **NO PUBLISHED FIGURE** — export and inspect the file directly. **NOT DOCUMENTED BY TRIMBLE** — does any TBC export write the source trajectory into a LAS header, VLR or sidecar? (§30)

29.8 Known limitations and silent failures

LIMITATION	PATH	SOURCE
Corrupted side camera images are exported as black images	TopoDot, TMX	(TBC 23339, 22501)
All run views must be closed before export	TopoDot	(TBC 23339)
Scans must be generated first or nothing is exported	TopoDot, Solv3D	(TBC 23339, 23888)
Ground scaling does not expose its scale factor	All point cloud exports	(TBC 11769, 27279)
Grid-scaled re-import may double-scale	All point cloud exports	(TBC 11769, 27279)
MX9 Export to TMX requires a coordinate system without Geoid	TMX — MX60 applicability not stated	(TBC 22501)
Random sampling with no spatial rule	Classified LAS	(TBC 27279)

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

What we just did. We wrote the finished data out of TBC in whatever format the client needs — a LAS file, a package for TopoDot or Solv3D, or a publication to Trimble Connect — and we looked carefully at what each of those paths actually carries with it.

Why it matters. This is the last moment the project and the deliverable are the same thing. Everything after this, the client has; everything before this, you can still fix. And there are several documented ways for the two to quietly diverge here.

What can go wrong. The one to burn into memory: **registering a mission does not change the point cloud.** If nobody ran Update Scans, the file you export is the unregistered data. It opens fine, it looks identical, the residuals in your notes were good — and the client has the version from before the adjustment. Check that the scans you are exporting sit under the registered trajectory and carry the `_reg_` suffix, every time.

Two more. There is an innocuous-looking option called **Export timestamps** that, when switched on, makes TBC rebuild the cloud from the raw data instead of exporting the scans you processed. Trimble does not say what trajectory that rebuild uses. Until somebody tests it, treat that switch as a decision rather than a convenience. And if you export in ground coordinates, the file does not record the scale factor it used — the grid option writes a small text file beside the cloud that does.

What good looks like. Before exporting: the scan nodes you have selected sit beneath the trajectory you intended, the stations carry the registration suffix, and you know whether you are writing grid or ground. After exporting: the file opens, the extents match the corridor, the point count is plausible, the sidecar is present if you expected one, and somebody has opened a sample of the imagery rather than counting it. That is ten minutes, and it is the difference between a delivery and a re-delivery.

30 Provenance

30.1 The question this section answers

A client, a reviewer, or opposing counsel is looking at a point cloud Parametrix delivered three years ago. They ask: how do we know this is the adjusted version, and which adjustment was it?

That question is ordinary in survey work. A conventional adjustment produces a report naming its observations, its constraints and its residuals, and the report travels with the deliverable. Mobile mapping does not work that way, and this section sets out precisely what can and cannot be demonstrated.

30.2 Four things that are related and not interchangeable

Conflating these is the most common error in discussing mobile mapping provenance, and it leads people to believe a question has been answered when it has not.

	WHAT IT ESTABLISHES	WHAT IT DOES NOT ESTABLISH
Spatial reference metadata	Which coordinate system and scale the coordinates belong to	Which trajectory produced them
Trajectory information	The sensor path through space and time	Which <i>version</i> of that path this is
Registration history	What adjustments were applied after the original trajectory solution	—
Data provenance	Where the data came from and how it was processed, end to end	—

Stated as plainly as possible:

A coordinate system does not prove which trajectory produced the points.

GPS Time does not prove which registration was applied.

Trajectory geometry without trajectory identity does not necessarily reconstruct the processing lineage.

That last one deserves a sentence of its own, because it is the subtlest. The TMX export and Publish to TRCPS both carry **trajectory geometry** out of TBC (§29). A recipient therefore holds a path through space. What they do not hold is a statement of **which** path it is — the imported one, the first registration, or the fourth — and on a project where several existed, geometry alone may not distinguish them, particularly where a registration made a small correction.

30.3 The provenance chain

Each transition, with what exists at that point, what Cleanup can remove, and what survives export.

Legend

In TBC = a project object **On disk** = a file in the project or raw data folder **Cleanup** = may be removed by §28 **Export** = documented as surviving export

1 · Raw MX60 mission → imported mission

In TBC	Mission node; runs; Capture Devices; start/stop, duration, covered distance , active trajectory file (<i>TBC 22499</i>)
On disk	The <code>.mxd</code> , raw POS data, raw scanner and camera data, <code>Extcal.json</code> , mission logs (<i>TBC 25943</i>)
Cleanup	The raw data is outside the project and unaffected
Export	Not applicable
Parametrix record	The field record — conditions, incidents, what was not collected. No software artefact exists (the Field How To)

2 · Imported mission → trajectory

In TBC	The trajectory node under each run; RMS colouring from <code>smrmsg_XXX.out</code> (<i>TBC 27248</i>)
On disk	<code>sbet_[mission].out</code> or <code>sbet_[mission]_[frame].out</code> in <code>NAVPROC/Export/</code> ; the processing report in <code>NAVPROC/Report/</code> ; with Backup SBET Next to MXDB , a copy and a log of the frame and epoch used beside the <code>.mxd</code> (<i>TBC 25943</i>)
Cleanup	Keeps the trajectory "consistent with the latest version of navigation and trajectory information file (SBET or NAV)" (<i>TBC 26466</i>)
Export	Trajectory geometry on TMX and TRCPS; identity not documented

Parametrix record	Which computation mode, which base station, which settings — no single artefact captures these (§17.3)
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The frame-and-epoch log written by Backup SBET Next to MXDB is the only artefact found in the whole workflow that records the frame a trajectory was computed in, and it lives with the raw data rather than inside the project. That is why enabling the option is proposed in §17.4.

3 · Trajectory → generated scans

In TBC	Scan nodes nested beneath the trajectory that produced them (<i>TBC 22638</i>); the Results of Scan Generation dialog recording filters, range and colorization per run (<i>TBC 22499</i>)
On disk	RWCX point cloud data in the project
Cleanup	Scans associated with removed registrations are removed (<i>TBC 26466</i>)
Export	The cloud itself. Filter and colorization settings are not documented as travelling
Parametrix record	Capture the Results of Scan Generation — proposed §18.5

4 · Calibration state

In TBC	Camera and sensor properties: Boresight installation vs Boresight refinement , lever arm installation vs refinement (<i>TBC 24868</i>)
On disk	<code>Extcal.json</code> with the raw data; an exported calibration JSON containing the Installation Matrix and Refinement Matrix for each sensor (<i>TBC 22920</i>)
Cleanup	Not addressed by Trimble's description
Export	Not documented as travelling with any deliverable
Parametrix record	The Mission Report carries per-sensor boresight and lever-arm calibration with a date of calibration (<i>TBC 24868</i>) — the only dated calibration record found

5 · Registration → adjusted trajectory

In TBC	The adjusted trajectory node with properties <code>Origin: Registration result</code> , <code>Input trajectory</code> , <code>Registration type</code> (<i>TBC 22905, 26473</i>); picked and updated targets named for the registration; registered segments rendered in the "Undefined RMS" colour (<i>TBC 27248</i>)
On disk	<code>sbt_<date>_reg_####.out</code> , incrementing per registration, in the project folder (<i>TBC 22905</i>); <code>Targets.csv</code> holding the picked targets, when Registration Auto-Saving is on (<i>TBC 22905</i>)
Cleanup	Keeps only the most recent registration. Earlier trajectories and their scans are removed. Whether the numbered SBET files are deleted from disk is untested
Export	No export path is documented as identifying the registration result (§29.7)
Parametrix record	Which points were control and which were checks, and the residuals on each — TBC is not documented as reporting this after the fact (§22.7)

6 · Update Scans → final point cloud state

In TBC	New scan nodes beneath the adjusted trajectory; stations carrying a <code>_reg_####</code> suffix (<i>TBC 22638</i>)
On disk	RWCX data in the project
Cleanup	Scans of removed registrations are removed
Export	The cloud. The <code>_reg_####</code> suffix is a station name inside TBC and is not documented as appearing in exported filenames
Parametrix record	Confirmation that Update Scans was performed before export (§29.2)

7 · Export → delivered dataset

Travels	Coordinate system and scale factor (<code>.txt</code> , grid); project global CRS (ECEF); GPS Time per point; image position and orientation in some paths; image EXIF naming TBC; trajectory geometry on TMX and TRCPS
Not documented as travelling	Trajectory name or ID; SBET filename; registration result; registration type; <code>_reg_####</code> sequence; source run or mission identifier within the data; calibration identity
Cleanup	Not applicable — but what Cleanup removed is no longer available to be recorded
Parametrix record	The delivery record — what was exported, from which node, on what date, by whom

30.4 The limitation, stated precisely

IMPORTANT — PROVENANCE LIMITATION

Exported mobile mapping data may retain coordinate, timing, and in some formats trajectory information, but the captured Trimble documentation does not establish that the output uniquely identifies the adjusted trajectory or registration result used to create it.

What this does and does not mean

IT DOES NOT MEAN	IT DOES MEAN
That exports carry no metadata	That the metadata they carry answers <i>where are these coordinates</i> , not <i>how were they produced</i>
That the trajectory never leaves TBC	That where it does leave (TMX, TRCPS), which trajectory it is is not documented
That provenance is impossible	That it depends on the TBC project and on Parametrix's own records, not on the deliverable
That Trimble's software lacks the information	That Trimble's documentation does not establish it , and does not enumerate LAS headers or VLR content — so something undocumented may be written

The practical concern is therefore not "no history." It is:

The deliverable may not contain enough documented provenance to reconstruct its processing history independently of the TBC project and Parametrix records.

Classification

PARTLY CONFIRMED.

This no longer represents missing documentation. All known MX60 export and publish paths have been reviewed (§29.6). The remaining uncertainty is about **software behaviour Trimble does not document**, resolvable by test (–), not by further reading.

30.5 Cleanup and provenance, combined

Cleanup reduces the registration history available in the project.

Export is not documented as providing unique registration lineage.

Therefore performing Cleanup before preserving the appropriate project evidence may reduce Parametrix's ability to reconstruct the processing history later.

That is a finding, not a prohibition.

SET BY THE PROJECT — ∴ STATED AND TRACKED IN THE SOP §20; SEE ALSO THE MASTER REGISTER.

— why it is high priority here

NO PUBLISHED FIGURE — ∙ — HIGH PRIORITY

Does Cleanup delete the `sbt_*_reg_####.out` files physically from storage, or only remove the corresponding project objects and references?

Until tested, distinguish two things and do not assume one implies the other:

Project object retention | Underlying file retention

---|---

Whether the trajectory node still appears in Project Explorer | Whether the `.out` file still exists in the project folder

The registered SBETs are written to the project folder on disk, not inside the TBC database (*TBC 22905, 26473*). Removing a project object does not necessarily delete the file it points at, and Trimble does not address this.

The result materially changes what must be archived before Cleanup. If the files survive, they are a partial lineage record that outlives the operation. If they do not, that record must be copied out beforehand or it is gone. (§28.6, §25)

30.6 What Parametrix would need to record

Stated as a gap analysis, not as policy.

SET BY THE PROJECT — ∴ WHAT PROVENANCE RECORD MUST ACCOMPANY A MOBILE MAPPING DELIVERABLE, AND WHERE DOES IT LIVE? STATED AND TRACKED IN THE SOP §20; SEE ALSO THE MASTER REGISTER.

This manual states no Parametrix procedure. A practice covering this is proposed in the **SOP §20** ; it is not decided here.

30.7 Reconstruction paths that do exist

Where a delivered dataset must be tied back after the fact, two routes exist on current evidence. **Both are reconstruction, not provenance, and both depend on Parametrix having retained something.** **Timestamp matching.** LAS point records carry GPS Time (*TBC 23339, 22501*), and a retained SBET is a time series. A point's timestamp can be matched to an epoch in a specific SBET. This identifies a trajectory only if the candidate SBETs differ measurably at that epoch, and it requires the SBETs to have been kept.

Trajectory geometry comparison. A TMX or TRCPS delivery contains trajectory geometry (§29.6.2, §29.6.6), which could be compared against retained `sbet_*_reg_####.out` files. Same caveat: it requires retention, and it distinguishes candidates only where they differ.

NO PUBLISHED FIGURE — ESTABLISH WHETHER EITHER RECONSTRUCTION PATH WORKS IN

practice on a real dataset with two candidate trajectories. Neither has been attempted.

IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

What we just did. We traced the data from the raw mission to the delivered file and asked, at every step, what record exists of what was done — inside TBC, on disk, and in the file the client receives.

Why it matters. In conventional survey work, an adjustment comes with a report. It names the observations, the constraints and the residuals, and it goes out with the job. If somebody queries the result in five years, you open the report. Mobile mapping does not produce that document. The evidence exists — it is genuinely good inside the TBC project — but it is spread across node names, file suffixes, a dialog and a colour, and the documentation does not establish that any of it reaches the delivered file.

What can go wrong. Be careful about what the problem actually is, because it is easy to overstate. The exported file is not empty of information: it knows its coordinate system, it may carry a scale factor sidecar, its points may be timestamped, and on two of the six paths the trajectory itself travels with it. What it does not do, as far as Trimble's documentation establishes, is say *which* trajectory — the original, or the first registration, or the fourth. So a delivered cloud can tell you where its coordinates belong and not how they were arrived at.

The practical failure is a client query three years on, a project file that was cleaned up, and a processor who has left. The data is fine. Nobody can demonstrate that it is fine.

What good looks like. The deliverable is not the record — the project and a short written note are. A page per dataset naming the trajectory, the registration and its number, which points were control and which were checks, what the residuals were, and what was archived before the project was tidied up. Five minutes at the end of a job, and the difference between "we are confident in it" and "here is why."

31 Periodic System Verification

31.1 The check Trimble describes

Distinct from per-project QC. This is the check that the **instrument** is still performing.

TRIMBLE METHOD — MX60 UG REV B, P.7

Scan approximately **eight flat retro-reflecting targets** at varied distances over **more than 180° horizontally**, previously surveyed by total station. The system passes if residuals fall within the specified accuracy.

Trimble recommends doing this "regularly" and "especially before starting an extensive data acquisition campaign" — and **gives no interval**.

NOT DOCUMENTED BY TRIMBLE

Is the retro-reflective target check the recommended periodic verification for the MX60, and at what interval? The User Guide describes the check and says to do it "regularly" without naming a period. Trimble or the dealer can say what interval they expect, and whether any other verification is expected alongside it.

Set by the project: *Is this the periodic verification Parametrix uses, and at what interval?* Stated and tracked in the **SOP §13**; see also the master register.

A Trimble Source Index

Every Trimble source cited in this SOP. `reference/mx60-reference-data.csv` (402 records) is the authority for numbers; this document explains what they mean.

A1 · Manuals and bulletins

DOCUMENT	REVISION	CITED FOR
Trimble MX60 User Guide	Rev B, May 2025 (P/N T001983), 68 pp	Hardware, installation, power, safety, specifications, periodic verification
Trimble MX60 Quick Start Guide	Rev B, March 2025, 16 pp	Field sequence, initialization, capture settings
Trimble Mobile Imaging (TMI) Software User Guide	Rev L, April 2026 (P/N T001242), 56 pp	Field software, status, capture settings, calibration import
Trimble MX60 Spec Sheet	PN 022516-737C (04/25), 4 pp	Specifications
Trimble MX Shock Absorbing Mounting Rack User Guide	Rev B, May 2025 (P/N 37000001), 10 pp	Vehicle installation
Product Bulletin: Enabling the Dust Filter in TMI for MX60	January 2025, 3 pp	Dust filter
TBC Technical Notes: For Mobile Mapping	October 2022, 8 pp	Predates MX60 support — used with caution

A2 · TBC help portal — TBC 2026.10

The captured help documents **TBC 2026.10**, confirmed by cross-reference: a registration feature listed as new in the 2026.10 release notes is present in the captured topic (*TBC RN 2026.10*; *TBC 22905*). URLs follow `https://help.fieldsystems.trimble.com/tbc/<id>.htm`.

Understanding and structure

ID	TOPIC	CITED IN
20717	Understanding Mobile Mapping	2
22503	Mobile Mapping System Data Structure	2.5, 13.1
21243-1	Mobile Mapping Options	15.3

ID	TOPIC	CITED IN
22554	View the Mobile Mapping Data in the Project Explorer	11.3

Import, view and process

ID	TOPIC	CITED IN
20736-1	Import the Mobile Mapping Data	11.3
22499	Generate Mobile Mapping Scans	11.4, 13.2–13.5
22638	Update Mobile Mapping Scans	13.6, 22.2, 23.3
22567	Hide, Display and Center on a Mobile Mapping Trajectory	—
22863	Go to a Mobile Mapping Station Position	—
20727	Navigate a long Mobile Mapping Run	—
24024	Split a Mobile Mapping Run	—
26947	Define a Region of Interest	—
28155	Recover Mobile Mapping Scans	13.7, 26.3
28912	Display Mobile Mapping Rectified Camera Views	19
23856	Configure your Graphic Card Driver When Using the MTA Correction	13.1 — does not apply to MX60
23991_1	Run a Mission Report	14.6, 17.6, 23.3, 25.2

Register Mobile Mapping Trajectories

ID	TOPIC	CITED IN
22905	Register a Run	15.2–15.9, 17.2, 22.2, 23.3
26473	Register a Mission	15.4, 17.2, 22.2, 23.3
25096	Register Multiple Pairs of Runs (Register Run to Run)	16, 18.2–18.3
25362	Edit a Run	15.8, 16.8, 24 L4
26578	Edit a Mission	15.8, 24 L4

Perform Mobile Mapping Calibrations

ID	TOPIC	CITED IN
24886 <i>(also 20716)</i>	Calibrate Mobile Mapping Laser Scanners	14.2–14.3, 18.1
24868	Calibrate Mobile Mapping Cameras	14.4, 14.6
20728	Perform a Manual Camera Calibration	14.4
22920	Import and Export Mobile Mapping Calibration File (.json)	14.5
25943	Process Raw Trajectory Data	5.3, 10.1, 12.2–12.4, 23.3
28972	LiDAR QC Processing	4.5, 12.7, 20.6
24460	Generate POSpac Position Fixes	11.2, 20.5
27248	Change the Real-time or Post-processed Trajectory Color Settings	12.4, 18.4, 22.2
27415	View Trajectory Plots	12.5, 24 L2

Cleanup

ID	TOPIC	CITED IN
26466	Cleanup Mobile Mapping Mission	21, 23.5, 25.4

Export and publish

ID	TOPIC	CITED IN
11769	Export Point Cloud Files (.e57,.las,.laz,.pod,.pts,.ptx,.rcp,.tdx)	22.4–22.6.5
27279	Export Mobile Mapping Classified Point Cloud Regions to LAS	22.5, 22.6.1
22501	Export to Trimble TMX	19.2, 22.3, 22.6.2
23339	Export to TopoDot	19.2, 22.3, 22.6.3
23888	Export to Solv3D	19.2, 22.6.4
29527	Publish Mobile Mapping Point Cloud Data, Trajectories, and Images to Trimble Connect	4.6, 22.6.6

ID	TOPIC	CITED IN
28963	Workflow: Publish Point Cloud Data and Panoramic Images to Trimble Connect	Publish Scan Data — a static-scanner path

MX7-only exporters — do not apply to the MX60

ID	TOPIC	WHY EXCLUDED
20926	Station Positions and Panorama Orientations (.xml)	"MX7 Export to XML Horus" — converts PGR files from an MX7 360° camera
20927_1	Panoramic Images and Trajectory Files (.csv)	"MX7 Export to TMX" — starts from a Trident <code>.tridb</code> ; 8000 × 4000 px panorama
21713_1	Cubical Images and Trajectory Files (.csv)	"MX7 Export to Mapillary" — same panorama size

The MX7 panorama is 8000 × 4000 px; the MX60 is 8192 × 4096 (Core) or 12288 × 6144 (Pro/Premium). Pixel counts are a reliable way to tell which system a TBC topic describes when the title does not say.

Release notes

RELEASE	CITED FOR
2025.21	Signed GCP residuals "in the report"; Publish to TRCPS; Smart Picking window instability; licence eligibility
2026.10	Direct residuals to GCP (the version cross-reference); dynamic datum epoch; two-step verification; dark theme; Rectified Camera Views naming

A3 · Not held, and needed

DOCUMENT	NEEDED FOR	ITEM
Trimble GAMS Antenna Kit Installation & Operation Manual	Lever-arm procedure if GAMS is fitted	
Trimble DMI Installation & Operation Manual	DMI scale factor for the measured wheel diameter	
TBC Help: Blur Exported Images	Imagery privacy procedure	§26.6 — capture when privacy is drafted

A4 · Non-Trimble sources — reference only

These are cited as examples of how others have answered questions Parametrix has not. They are not Parametrix standards and not Trimble requirements.

SOURCE	USED FOR
Queensland TMR, Mobile Laser Scanning Technical Guideline, March 2023, CC BY 4.0	An example of a published agency specification for control layout, accuracy tiers, and wet-weather practice — §22.6, the Field How To
NCHRP Synthesis: Practices for Collecting, Managing, and Using Lidar Data, 2024	Background

Unresolved conflicts between these sources are listed separately in **Appendix D**.

B The Reference Dataset

B1 · What it is

`reference/mx60-reference-data.csv` holds **402 records** extracted from the source documents. It is the **authority for numbers** in this manual: where a figure appears in the body, it was taken from this file, and where the two disagree the CSV is correct and the body is a transcription error to be fixed.

It exists because the same number appears in three or four places in a document set of this size, sometimes in two different forms (per-scanner and system-total; centimetres and millimetres), and because a number in prose has no source attached to it.

B2 · Schema

COLUMN	CONTENTS
<code>id</code>	Prefixed identifier — see B3. Stable; cite it
<code>category</code>	Broad grouping: Scanner, Positioning, TMI, Registration, Export, Safety ...
<code>topic</code>	The narrower subject within the category
<code>item</code>	What the record is about, in words
<code>value</code>	The number, string, or statement
<code>notes</code>	Conditions, caveats, and any conflict with another record
<code>source</code>	The document, by short name
<code>page</code>	Page number where the source has one; - for web help topics
<code>sop_section</code>	Where it is used. Written against the single-document draft — see the note in B5

B3 · What the identifier prefixes mean

PREFIX	COUNT	MEANING
<code>SPEC</code>	56	Manufacturer specification — an instrument or system performance figure
<code>TMI</code>	50	Trimble Mobile Imaging field software behaviour and settings

PREFIX	COUNT	MEANING
QSG	42	From the MX60 Quick Start Guide — mostly field procedure
REG	34	Registration behaviour and parameters
EXP	28	Export paths, options and outputs
INST	27	Installation — lever arms, mounting, offsets
CAL	26	Calibration procedure and geometry
OPS	25	Operating procedure and limits
LIMIT	22	A stated limit: environmental, electrical, operational
TBC	22	Trimble Business Center behaviour, versions and licensing
TRAJ	16	Trajectory processing settings and defaults
SAFE	15	Safety statement from a source document
VEH	9	Vehicle configuration
SUPPORT	9	Support routes and contacts
QC	8	Quality control indicators
CONN	6	External connectors
CONFLICT	4	Two sources disagree. See Appendix D
CLEAN	2	Cleanup behaviour
RESOLVED	1	A conflict that has since been resolved, kept for the record

B4 · Where the records come from

SOURCE	RECORDS
MX60 User Guide Rev B	153
TMI User Guide Rev L	50
MX60 Quick Start Guide Rev B	42
TBC help topics (all)	~120 across 30 topics

SOURCE	RECORDS
TBC release notes 2025.21 and 2026.10	14
MX60 specification sheet	5
Dust filter bulletin	7
Roof rack user guide	1

Full citations are in **Appendix A**.

B5 · How to use it

To check a number in this manual. Search the CSV for the value or the topic. The `source` and `page` columns give the citation; the `notes` column usually explains any condition attached to it.

To answer a question this manual does not address. The CSV contains records that no section needed — connector pinouts, cable lengths, screw torques, support addresses. Search it before assuming the answer is not in the source set.

Before quoting a number to a client. Check whether it carries a `CONFLICT` note. Four figures in the set are contradicted by another source (Appendix D), and two more are quoted in two different forms by Trimble itself — the scanner pulse rate and scan speed, which the specification sheet gives as system totals and the User Guide gives per scanner (§16.1).

IMPORTANT — · THE `SOP_SECTION` COLUMN IS STALE

That column was written against the single 71,800-word draft that preceded the four-deliverable structure. Its numbers do **not** correspond to this manual's sections. It is retained because it records which topic each number was used for, which is still useful, but it should not be used as a cross-reference until it is regenerated.

Regenerating it against the four-deliverable structure is straightforward and is on the project's own task list. It does not affect any value in the file.

C Observed Software Behaviour

OBSERVED IN THE SOFTWARE blocks in the body of this manual. Edit the section; regenerate this.

An entry here is something seen in the software, or stated in a release note, that Trimble does **not** document as procedure. It is weaker evidence than a **TRIMBLE METHOD** block and stronger than an inference. Where behaviour of this kind carries a real consequence, it also appears in the warning register.

§9.3 · The failure mode both share

"If an aiding navigation sensor is not activated in Vehicle Settings its data will **not** be logged — even though all connections may have been made properly."

§10.2 · Trimble Business Center — the office software

From TBC 2026.10, **Trimble ID sign-in requires two-step verification** — a code by email each time (*TBC RN 2026.10*). Anyone signing in to TBC or Trimble Connect needs access to the account's email at that moment. Worth knowing before it stops a session.

§17.4 · Outputs, and a filename that means something

A registered trajectory no longer matches its `smrmsg` file, so adjusted stretches lose their RMS colour and render as **Undefined RMS** (*TBC 27248*). **§24 quotes the behaviour in full and makes a QC technique out of that side effect.**

§24 · Reading Trajectory RMS Colouring

"If the mission contains some registrations then the modified segments will be colored with the '**Undefined RMS**' color" (*TBC 27248*). A registered trajectory no longer matches the `smrmsg` file, so adjusted stretches lose their RMS colour.

Incidentally useful: this makes the extent of a registration visible in plan. A **Local** registration that stopped adjusting beyond the outermost control point (§21.5) shows the boundary directly.

§26.1 · What the MX60 imagery is for

Whether imagery positions inherit a registration is not documented.

Registration produces a new trajectory and Update Scans recomputes the point cloud from it (§19). No captured Trimble topic states whether station positions and panorama orientations are recomputed too.

It is plausible that they are, since imagery is positioned from the trajectory. **It is not stated, and must not be assumed.** **NO PUBLISHED FIGURE** — compare a station's position before and after a registration. This is answerable in minutes and nobody has done it.

§26.2 · Resolution depends on the configuration

Trimble's export folder-structure examples show the MX60 tree containing **Camera 3 Back Down** and **Camera 4 360°**, with per-face `.cal` files for the 360° camera (Front, Rear, Left, Right, Top, Bottom). The MX9 and MX50 trees additionally show **Planar 1** and **Planar 2** side cameras; **the MX60 tree does not** (*TBC 23339, 22501*).

This suggests the **Export side images** option has nothing to export on an MX60. **Trimble does not state this**, and the option remains present in the dialog.

NOT ESTABLISHED — what imagery streams actually exist on the MX60, and which are exposed through TBC export? Run an export with side images enabled and see what appears; confirm with the vendor what the MX60 camera complement is.

Do not write MX9 or MX90 camera behaviour into MX60 procedure on the strength of a shared dialog. The option's presence in the export pane is not evidence that the sensor exists.

§26.7 · Imagery in the delivered dataset

An exported panoramic image's file properties show `Program name: Trimble Business Center` (*TBC 21713_1*). Software provenance does reach the imagery, in EXIF. **It names the software, not the trajectory** (§30).

§28.3 · What it removes, and why that matters

The registered SBETs are written **to the project folder on disk**, not inside the TBC database (*TBC 22905, 26473*). Trimble does not state whether Cleanup deletes them or only removes the project's references to them.

NO PUBLISHED FIGURE — list the project folder before and after Cleanup and compare. If the files survive, they are a partial audit trail that outlives the operation; if they do not, the record is gone entirely. **This materially changes what must be archived first.**

§29.6 · The MX60 export paths

Publish to TRCPS and Trimble Mobile Mapping data (*TBC RN 2026.10*). Not applicable to Parametrix, but it confirms Publish to TRCPS is a Connected Workspace function.

D Source Conflicts and Resolutions

Conflicts between two Trimble sources, or between a Trimble source and observed behaviour. Each is recorded in `reference/mx60-reference-data.csv` under a `CONFLICT-` identifier so that the numbers on both sides remain traceable.

None of these blocks work. Each is a statement that should not be quoted to a client, or put into a specification, until it is resolved.

ID	CONFLICT	STATUS
<code>CONFLICT-002</code>	Scanner FOV — 346° (<i>UG p.54</i>) vs 360° (<i>spec sheet p.2</i>)	
<code>CONFLICT-003</code>	Which mounting rack is fitted	/
<code>CONFLICT-004</code>	Minor numeric discrepancies between sources	Recorded in the CSV
<code>CONFLICT-005</code>	Laser control presentation — QSG vs TMI Rev L	
<code>RESOLVED-001</code>	Spec sheet vs User Guide laser rates — system total vs per-scanner, a factor of 2. QSG confirms TMI uses the User Guide numbering	Resolved

